

# Motionator

User Guide

Animate SVG without code — 4K video, Lottie and animated SVG

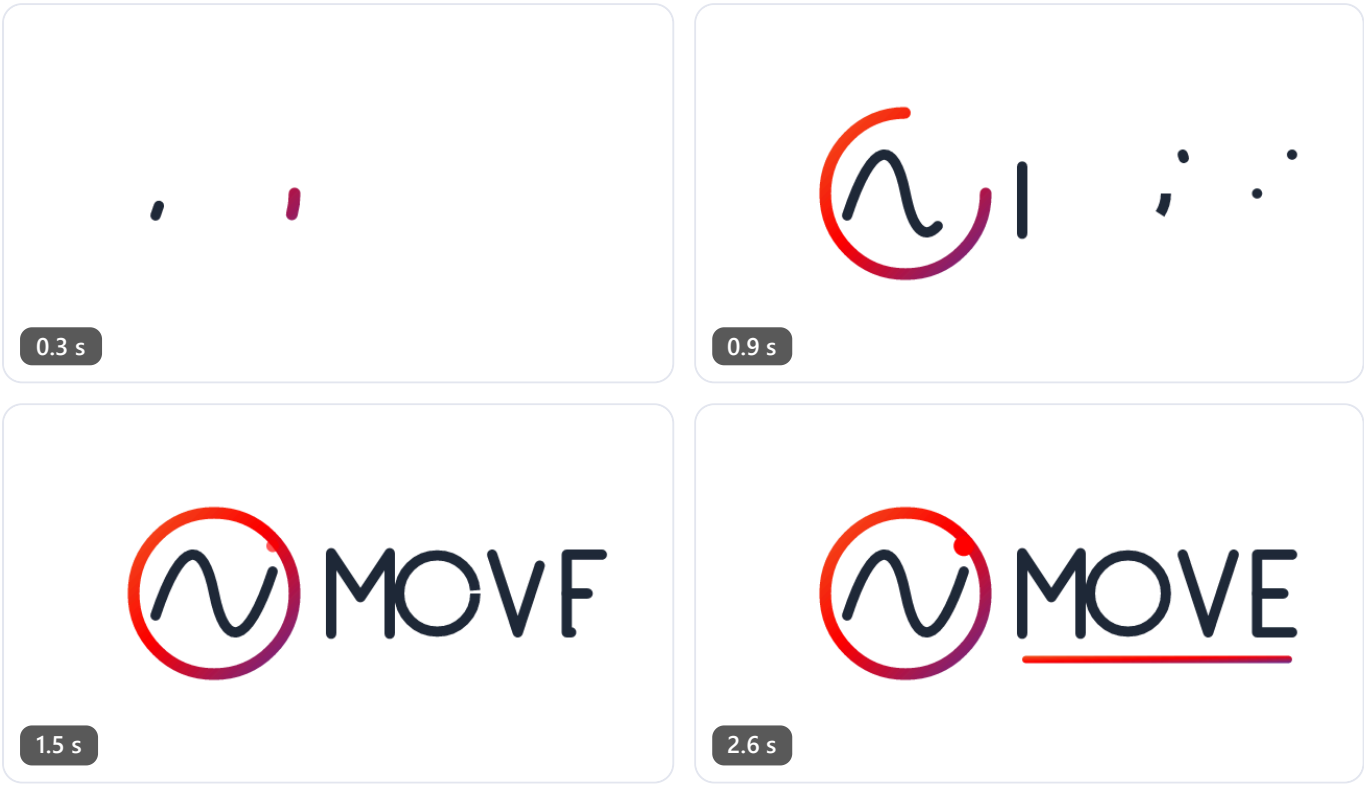
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# Welcome

This guide explains every part of Motionator, from the first import to a finished 4K clip, a Lottie file or an animated SVG for your website. Each chapter has real screenshots, and the tutorials use sample files you can download and follow step by step.




A logo drawn on with Trim Paths, staggered letters and a wipe (sample: logo.motionator).

## What you can make

### Stock footage

Seamless 4K backgrounds in H.264 or ProRes, checked for loops and for the usual stock-site rules.

### Logo animation

Draw-on strokes, pops, wipes and colour flashes, with a soundtrack.

### Web animation

Lottie JSON for lottie-web and apps, or one self-contained animated SVG.

### Your own presets

Turn any keyframed layer into a preset and reuse it in every project.

## How Motionator works

You prepare artwork in Illustrator, Inkscape, Figma or any vector editor and save it as SVG. Every group or path with a name (an `id` in the SVG) becomes a **layer** you can animate. You then animate layers in two ways, which can be combined:

- **Presets**: ready-made motions (Fade In, Bounce, Orbit, Draw On…) applied with a double-click. Ideal for fast, consistent results.
- **Keyframes**: set values at points in time, with easing, a graph editor and curved motion paths, like in After Effects.

The same renderer draws the preview and the exported video, so what you see is what you get. Lottie and animated SVG exports are checked against this renderer and each export shows a compatibility report before saving.

# 01 Installation

Install once, then open SVG files or projects straight from Explorer.

## Requirements

| ITEM | REQUIREMENT |
| --- | --- |
| System | Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit |
| Memory | 8 GB RAM; 16 GB recommended for 4K export with motion blur |
| Display | 1600×900 or larger |
| WebView2 | Included in Windows 11; the installer adds it on Windows 10 if missing |
| FFmpeg | Bundled with the installer (used for video and audio export) |

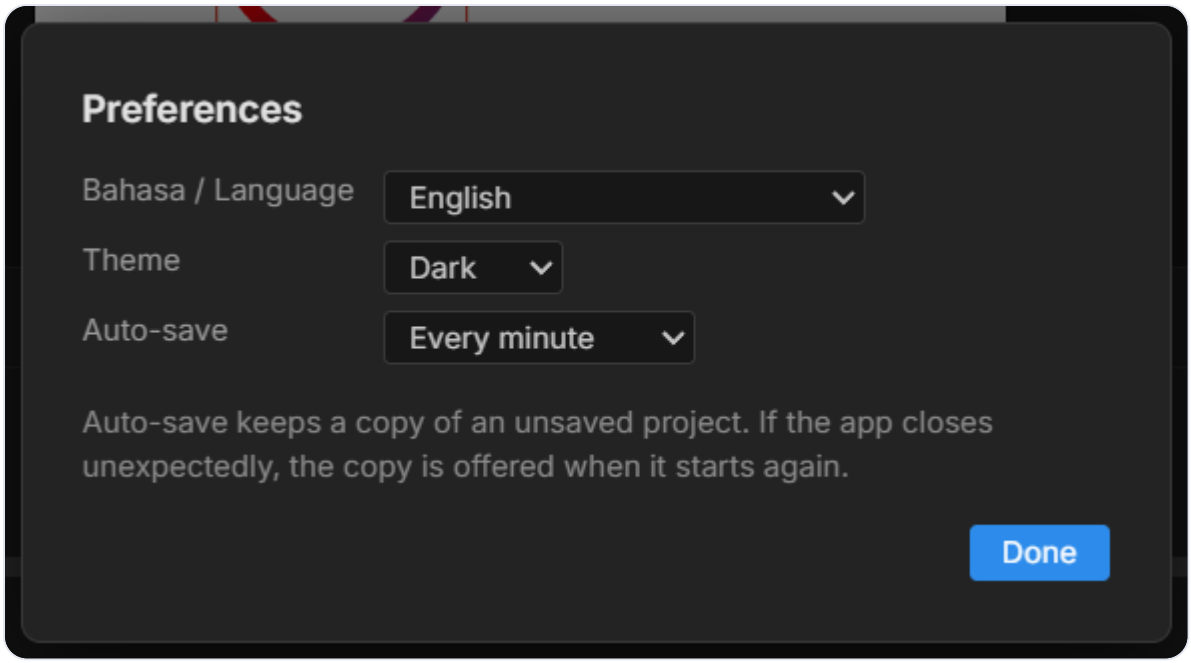
## Installing

1. Run `Motionator_0.1.0_x64-setup.exe`. Choose **English** or **Bahasa Indonesia** for the installer.
2. Follow the pages and click **Install**. Motionator installs for your user account only, so no administrator rights are needed.
3. Optionally create a desktop shortcut, then start Motionator from the last page or the Start menu.

The installer registers `.motionator` project files: double-clicking one in Explorer opens it in Motionator. You can also right-click an `.svg` file and choose **Open with ▸ Motionator** to import it straight away.

## First launch and language

Motionator follows the Windows display language: Indonesian on an Indonesian Windows, English otherwise. Change it any time in **Edit ▸ Preferences** (*Bahasa / Language*); the whole interface switches at once, including preset descriptions and export reports.



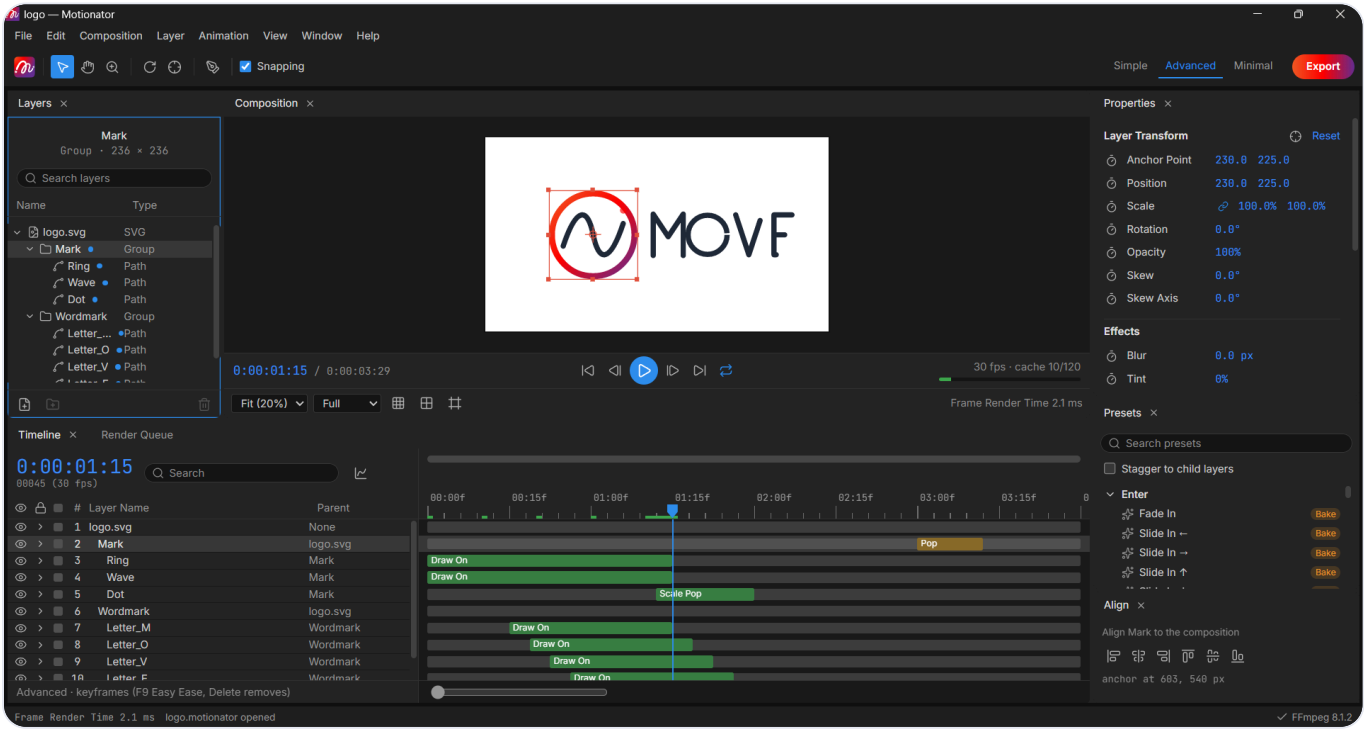

**Preferences**: language, theme (Dark or Darker) and auto-save interval.

> **NOTE**
> The status bar shows **FFmpeg** with a check mark when video export is ready. If it shows a warning, reinstall Motionator; video export needs FFmpeg, everything else works without it.

# 02 Quick start: your first animation

Five minutes from an SVG to a finished MP4.

1. **Import an SVG.** Press `Ctrl` + `I`, choose **File ▸ Import SVG...**, or simply drag an `.svg` file onto the window. Try `samples/logo.svg`.
2. **Select a layer.** Click it in the **Layers** panel or directly on the canvas with the Selection tool `V`.
3. **Apply a preset.** In the **Presets** panel, hover a preset to preview it, then **double-click** it. Enter presets start at the playhead (the blue line in the timeline).
4. **Play it.** Press `Space` or the round play button under the canvas. The green bar on the ruler shows frames already cached for smooth playback.
5. **Adjust timing.** In the **Timeline**, drag a preset bar to move it and drag its right edge to change its duration.
6. **Export.** Click the red **Export** button (or `Ctrl` + `M`), choose a format and size in the Render Queue, pick the output file, then press **Render**.
7. **Save the project** with `Ctrl` + `S`. The `.motionator` file contains your SVG, so it can be moved and shared as one file.




The logo sample at 1.5 s: layers on the left, the canvas in the middle, presets as bars in the timeline.

**TIP**

Everything you do can be undone with `Ctrl` + `Z` and redone with `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`. A whole drag is one undo step.

# 03 Core concepts

Six ideas that explain how everything in Motionator behaves.

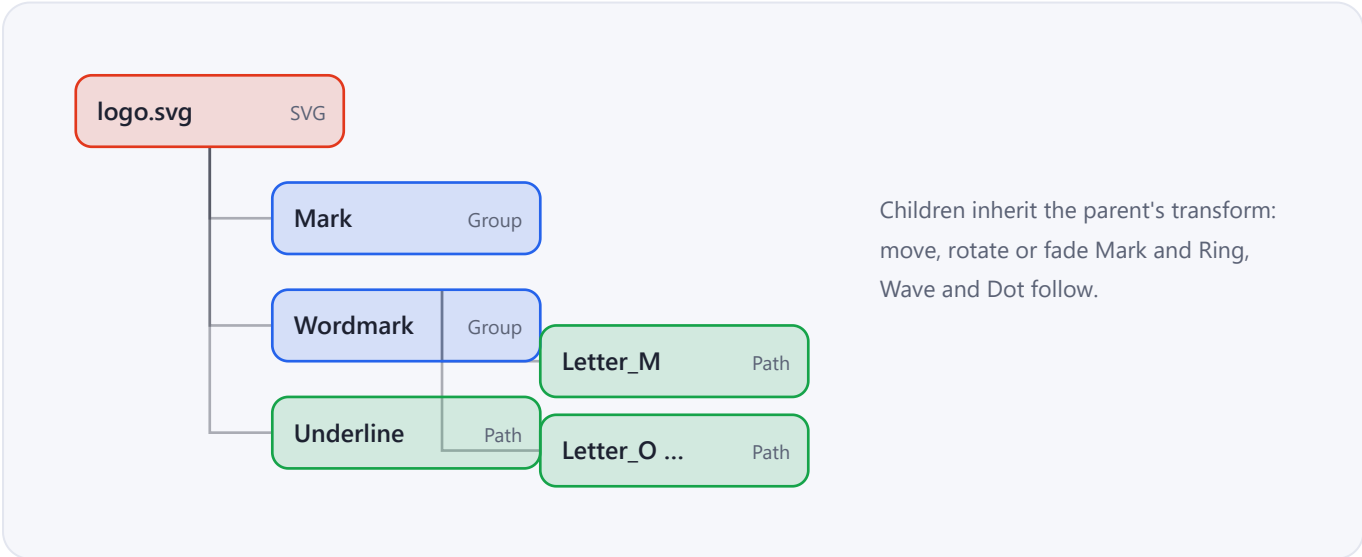
## 1. The composition

A composition is the frame you animate in: a size in pixels, a frame rate, a duration and a background. Everything you export is a render of the composition. A project has one composition; you can import several SVG files into it.

| FRAME RATE | TYPICAL USE |
|---|---|
| 23.976 / 24 fps | Cinematic footage; matches film and most stock clips shot on cameras. |
| 25 / 50 fps | PAL regions (Europe, Indonesia broadcast). |
| 29.97 / 30 fps | Web video, social media, NTSC regions. A safe default. |
| 59.94 / 60 fps | Very smooth motion, UI demos, fast-moving graphics. |

Time is shown as a **timecode** `0:00:02:15` = hours : minutes : seconds : frames, so at 30 fps `0:00:02:15` is 2.5 seconds. Below it the timeline shows the absolute frame number. Internally Motionator counts time in very fine ticks, so changing the frame rate never shifts your animation.

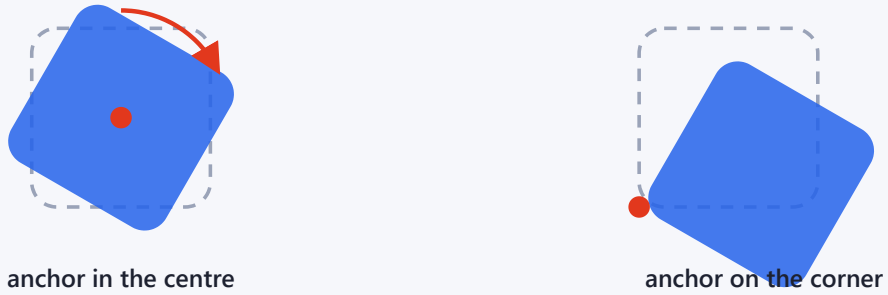
## 2. Layers and the hierarchy



Layers form a tree that mirrors the groups in your SVG. A child's transform is relative to its parent: if `Wordmark` moves 100 px right, every letter inside moves with it, and each letter can still have its own animation on top. This is why good grouping in your design tool matters so much: animate a group to move parts together, animate the children for detail.

Opacity multiplies down the tree (a child at 50 % inside a parent at 50 % shows at 25 %). Effects such as Blur, Tint and Reveal apply to the layer and everything inside it.

## 3. The anchor point




Rotation, scale and skew happen around the anchor point (the red crosshair on the canvas). The same 30° rotation looks completely different with the anchor in the centre or on a corner. Position moves the anchor point, so a layer's Position is where its anchor sits in the parent.

- A door or a pendulum (Swing): anchor on the hinge or the top.
- A clock hand (Tick, Spin): anchor at the end that stays fixed.
- A bouncing ball with squash: anchor at the bottom so it squashes onto the ground.
- A logo popping in: anchor in the centre.

## 4. Transform order



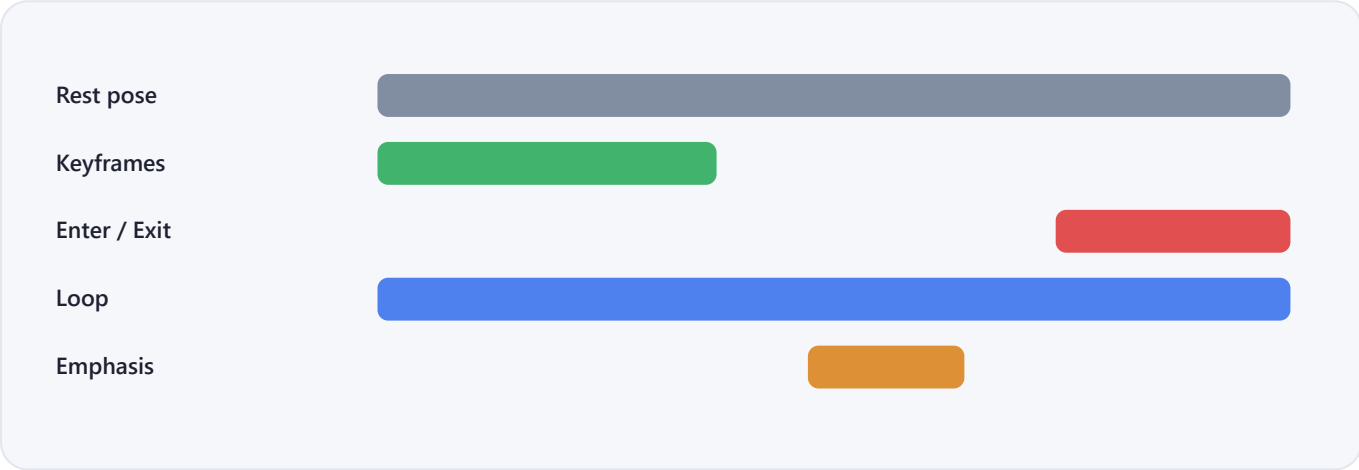

Every frame, each layer is placed in this order: the shape is offset so its anchor point is at the origin, then scaled, skewed and rotated around it, then moved to Position, and finally put inside its

parent. You never have to think about this while working, but it explains why scaling never moves the anchor point and why rotating a parent swings its children around the parent's anchor.

## 5. The rest pose

The **rest pose** is how the layer looks in your SVG file: its original position, size and rotation. Presets are relative to it: *Slide In* ← always ends exactly at the rest pose, wherever that is. **Reset Transform** brings a layer back to it, and **Save as Preset** stores motion as changes from it, which is why your presets work on other layers.

## 6. How a frame is calculated




1. Start from the rest pose (or the keyframed value, if the property has keyframes).
2. Enter and Exit presets that are active at this time replace the value; the one that starts last wins.
3. Loop and Emphasis presets add their motion on top.
4. The parent's result is applied, then the layer is drawn with its effects.

Because of this order you can freely mix methods: keyframe a logo's position across the screen, add *Fade In* at the start and *Float* for the whole clip, and all three work together.

> **TIP**
> Everything is non-destructive: presets are calculated live and never baked into your project unless you choose Bake to Keyframes. Delete a preset and the layer is exactly as before.

# 04 Preparing SVG files

Good layer names in your design tool make animation easy.

## Named elements become layers

Motionator makes a layer for every group and path that has an `id`. Elements without an id stay part of their parent layer, so they move together. Nesting is kept: a named group inside another named group becomes a child layer, and moving the parent moves the child.

| TOOL | HOW TO GIVE ELEMENTS IDS |
|---|---|
| Adobe Illustrator | Name layers and sub-layers in the Layers panel. Export with **File ▸ Export ▸ Export As... ▸ SVG** and *Object IDs: Layer Names*. Illustrator writes spaces as `_x20_`; Motionator shows them as spaces again. |
| Inkscape | Set the **ID** in Object Properties ( `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `O` ), or rename layers. Save as *Plain SVG* or *Inkscape SVG*. |
| Figma | Layer names become ids when you export a frame as SVG with *Include "id" attribute* turned on. |
| Any editor | Add `id="Name"` to the `<g>` or `<path>` elements in a text editor. |

## Checklist before importing

- **Outline text** (Create Outlines / Object to Path). Live text is not drawn; for animated titles, make the text in Motionator with **Layer ▸ New Text** instead.
- **Use strokes for line art** you want to draw on with Trim Paths. Filled shapes cannot be drawn on.
- **Group what moves together** and name the group, e.g. a wheel with its spokes.
- **Avoid filters and raster images** if you also need Lottie: they render in video but cannot be exported to Lottie.
- **Keep ids unique.** Duplicate ids are reported; only the first becomes a layer.

## Import warnings

After an import the status bar shows how many layers were found. If something needs attention, a warning appears there; click it to see the list. Warnings never stop the import.

| WARNING | WHAT TO DO |
| --- | --- |
| Text not outlined | Convert text to outlines and import again, or make the text with Layer ▸ New Text to animate it letter by letter. |
| Filters (blur, shadow…) | Fine for video; slows 4K rendering and is left out of Lottie. |
| Patterns / blend modes | Shown in video; Lottie support is limited. |
| Raster images | Blurry when scaled up; makes Lottie files larger. |
| Duplicate ids | Rename them in your editor so each part can be animated. |
| No ids | The whole SVG becomes one layer; name your layers. |

A newly imported SVG is centred in the composition at its own size, scaled down only if it is larger than the composition. Each layer's anchor point starts at the centre of its box.

## A well-structured SVG

This is the structure of `samples/logo.svg`. Groups with ids become layers that can move as a unit; paths with ids inside them can be animated on their own. Strokes are used where the line should draw on.

```
<svg xmlns="http://www.w3.org/2000/svg" viewBox="0 0 600 220">
 <g id="Mark">                    <!— layer: the symbol —>
   <circle id="Ring" … fill="none" stroke="#e2381d" stroke-width="14"/>
   <path   id="Wave" … fill="none" stroke="#7c3aed" stroke-width="12"/>
   <circle id="Dot"  … fill="#111827"/>
 </g>
 <g id="Wordmark">                <!— layer: the name —>
   <path id="Letter_M" …/>  <path id="Letter_O" …/>
   <path id="Letter_V" …/>  <path id="Letter_E" …/>
 </g>
 <path id="Underline" … stroke="#e2381d"/>
</svg>
```

## Step by step: Adobe Illustrator

1. Put each part you want to animate on its own layer or sub-layer, and name it in the Layers panel (double-click the name).
2. Select text and choose **Type** ▸ **Create Outlines** `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `O`. Keep a copy of the editable file.
3. Expand appearances and brushes you want as plain shapes (**Object** ▸ **Expand Appearance**), but keep strokes as strokes for Trim Paths.
4. Set the artboard to the area of the artwork (**Object** ▸ **Artboards** ▸ **Fit to Artwork Bounds**).
5. **File** ▸ **Export** ▸ **Export As…**, format SVG, tick *Use Artboards*. In the options: Styling *Presentation Attributes*, Font *Convert to Outlines*, Images *Embed*, Object IDs *Layer Names*, Decimal *2*, untick *Minify*.

## Step by step: Figma

1. Build the artwork inside a frame. Name layers and groups in the layers list.
2. Select text and use **Outline stroke**/**Flatten** only where needed; Figma exports text as paths when *Outline text* is on.
3. Select the frame, add an export setting **SVG**, open its options and tick *Include "id" attribute* and *Outline text*.
4. Export. Auto-layout frames become plain groups, which is fine.

## Step by step: Inkscape

1. Group parts with `Ctrl` + `G` and set each group's **ID** in **Object** ▸ **Object Properties**, then click *Set*.
2. Convert text with **Path** ▸ **Object to Path** `Shift` + `Ctrl` + `C`.
3. **Document Properties** ▸ *Resize to content*, then **Save As** ▸ **Plain SVG**.

## Size and resolution

SVG is resolution-independent: a 600 px wide logo renders razor-sharp in a 4K composition, because every frame is drawn from the vectors. The `viewBox` of the file only sets the starting size. Scale the SVG root layer up in Motionator rather than exporting a bigger SVG.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Very complex files (tens of thousands of paths, heavy blur filters, large embedded photos) render slowly at 4K. Simplify paths (Illustrator: *Object ▸ Path ▸ Simplify*) and avoid unnecessary filters.

# 05 The workspace at a glance

An After Effects–style layout: panels around a central canvas.

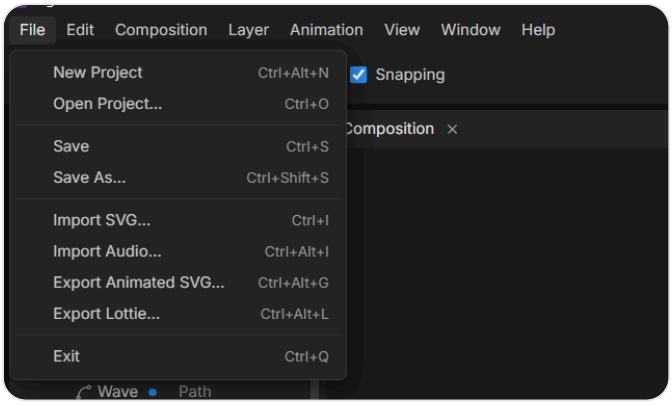



The main window in the Advanced workspace.

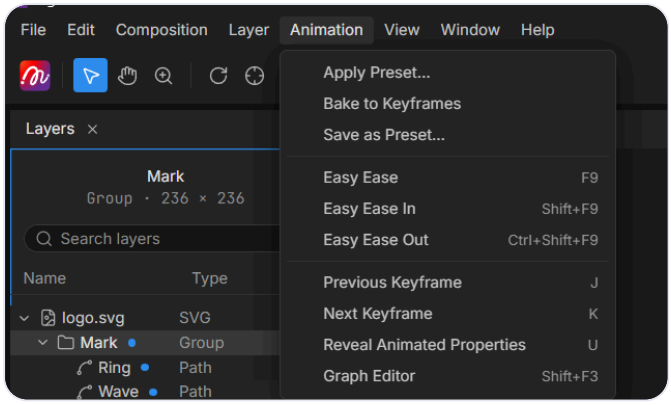
1. **Menu bar**: every command, with its shortcut.
2. **Toolbar**: Selection, Hand, Zoom, Rotation, Anchor Point and Pen tools, and Snapping.
3. **Workspaces**: Simple, Advanced and Minimal.
4. **Export**: adds the composition to the Render Queue.
5. **Layers**: the layer tree of your SVGs.
6. **Composition**: the canvas, where you select and move layers.
7. **Transport**: play, step, loop, current time and cache.
8. **Properties**: transform, effects, Trim Paths and presets of the selected layer.
9. **Timeline**: preset bars, keyframes and the Graph Editor; the Render Queue is its neighbour tab.
10. **Presets**: the preset library with search and live previews.
11. **Align**: align the selected layer to the composition.
12. **Status bar**: messages, import warnings and the FFmpeg check.

## Menus

The menus list every command with its keyboard shortcut. The File menu holds projects, imports and the web exports; Animation holds preset and keyframe commands; Window shows and arranges panels.




File menu




Animation menu

## Toolbar and tools




The toolbar: logo, tools, Snapping, workspaces and Export.

| TOOL | KEY | USE |
|---|---|---|
| Selection | `V` | Click a layer on the canvas to select it; drag to move it. Hold `Shift` to move only horizontally or vertically; with Snapping on it sticks to edges and centres (`Ctrl` to move freely). |
| Hand | `H` | Drag to pan the canvas. Holding `Space` gives the Hand tool temporarily. |
| Zoom | `Z` | Click to zoom in at that point; `Alt`-click zooms out. |
| Rotation | `W` | Drag around the selected layer to rotate it about its anchor point; `Shift` snaps to 45°. |
| Anchor Point | `Y` | Drag to move the anchor point (the pivot for rotation and scale) without moving the layer. |

| TOOL | KEY | USE |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Pen | `G` | Shows the motion path; click a position keyframe to switch it between a smooth curve and a sharp corner. |

With the mouse wheel over the canvas: scroll pans, `Shift` +scroll pans sideways, and `Ctrl` +scroll or `Alt` +scroll zooms around the pointer.

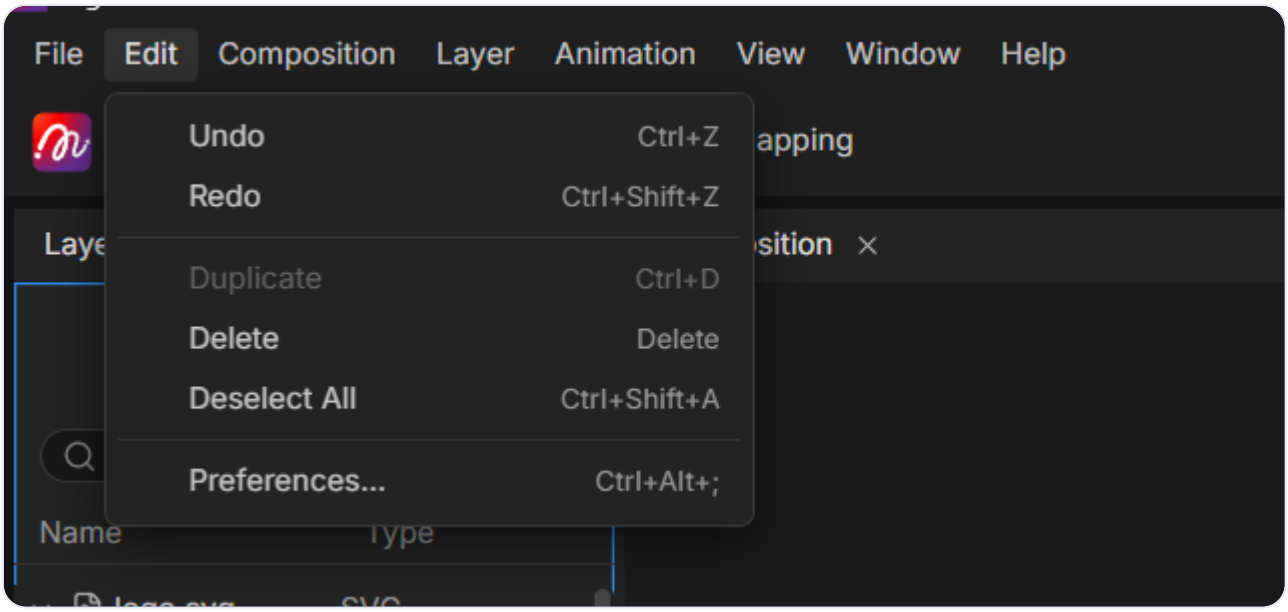
# 06 Menu reference

Every command in every menu, what it does and its shortcut.

## File menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| New Project | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `N` | Starts an empty project (asks to save changes first). |
| Open Project... | `Ctrl` + `O` | Opens a `.motionator` file. |
| Save / Save As... | `Ctrl` + `S` `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S` | Saves the project; Save As picks a new name. |
| Import SVG... | `Ctrl` + `I` | Adds an SVG file to the composition as a new root layer. |
| Import Audio... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `I` | Sets the project's soundtrack (replaces the current one). |
| Export Animated SVG... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `G` | Opens the animated SVG export dialog. |
| Export Lottie... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `L` | Opens the Lottie export dialog. |
| Exit | `Ctrl` + `Q` | Closes Motionator (asks to save changes). |

## Edit menu




The Edit menu.

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| Undo / Redo | `Ctrl` + `Z` `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z` `Ctrl` + `Y` | Steps back and forward through every change, including preset and keyframe edits. |
| Delete | `Delete` | Deletes what is selected: keyframes, a preset bar, the audio track or a whole SVG. |
| Deselect All | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `A` | Clears the selection; the Properties panel then shows the composition. |
| Preferences... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `;` | Language, theme and auto-save. |

## Composition menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| Composition Settings... | `Ctrl` + `K` | Shows the composition settings in the Properties panel. |

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Add to Render Queue | `Ctrl` + `M` | Adds the composition to the Render Queue and shows it. |

## Layer menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Center Anchor Point | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Home` | Moves the anchor to the centre of the layer without moving the layer. |
| Reset Transform | | Returns the selected layer to its rest pose. |

## Animation menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Apply Preset... | | Shows the Presets panel; double-click a preset there. |
| Bake to Keyframes | | Turns the layer's presets into keyframes. |
| Save as Preset... | | Saves the layer's keyframes as your own preset. |
| Easy Ease / In / Out | `F9` `Shift` + `F9` `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `F9` | Eases the selected keyframes. |
| Previous / Next Keyframe | `J` `K` | Moves the playhead to the nearest keyframe of the selected layer. |
| Reveal Animated Properties | `U` | Opens all layers that have keyframes, showing only animated properties. |
| Graph Editor | `Shift` + `F3` | Toggles the Graph Editor in the timeline. |

## View menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| Grid | `Ctrl` + `'` | Shows a grid over the composition. |
| Transparency Grid | | Shows a chequerboard behind transparent compositions. |
| Safe Area | | Shows action-safe and title-safe margins for video. |
| Snapping | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `;` | Turns snapping on or off (also in the toolbar): dragged layers and anchor points stick to the composition and to other layers. See Composition panel ▸ Snapping. |
| Zoom In / Out | `.` `,` | Zooms the canvas. |
| Actual Size / Fit | `/` `Shift` + `/` | 100 % zoom, or fit the composition to the panel. |

## Window menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|---|
| Workspace: Simple / Advanced / Minimal | `Shift` + `F10`<br>`Shift` + `F11`<br>`Shift` + `F12` | Switches workspace. |
| Dark / Darker Theme | | Changes the colour theme. |
| Panels | | Composition, Layers, Timeline, Render Queue, Properties, Presets, Align: shows the panel (opening it again if it was closed). |
| Reset Layout | | Restores the default arrangement of the current workspace. |
| Saved Layouts... | | Saves, applies and deletes named arrangements. |

## Help menu

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT | WHAT IT DOES |
| --- | --- | --- |
| About Motionator | | Version, licences and the open-source components. |

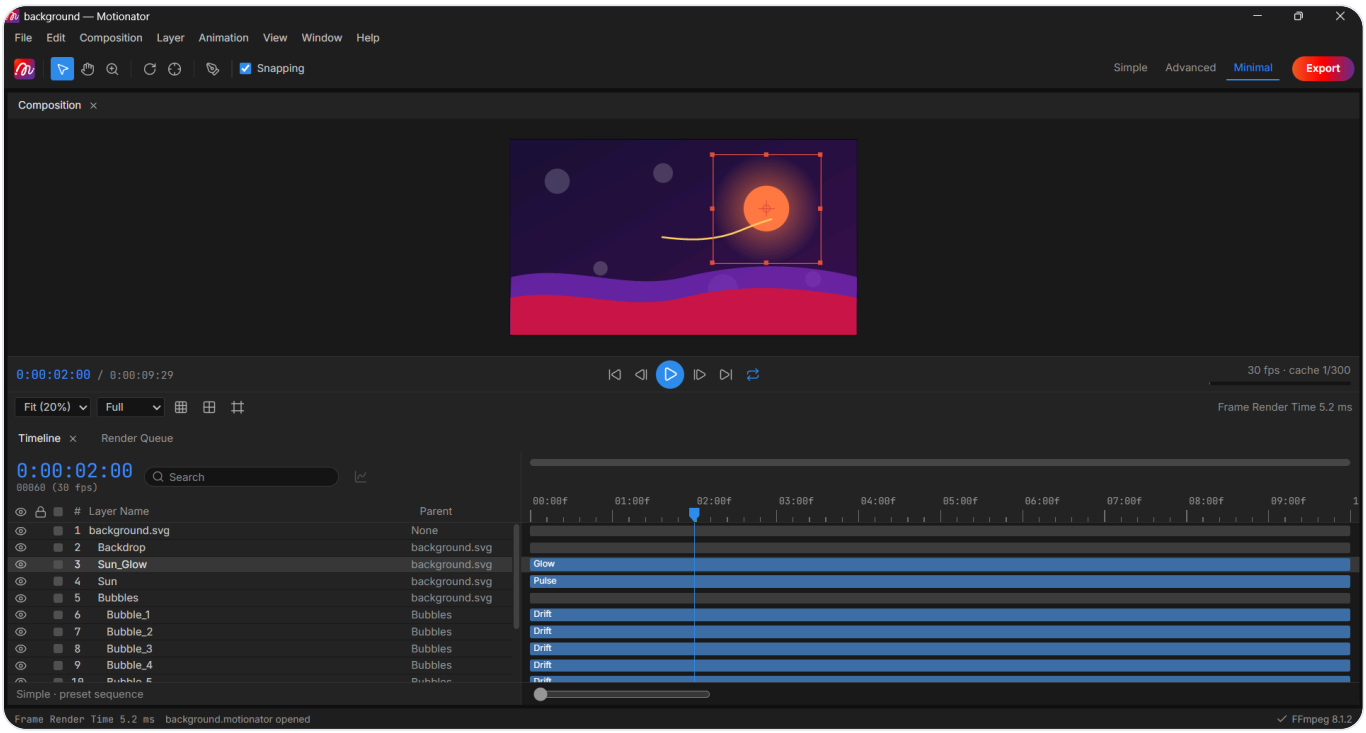
> **NOTE**
> Greyed-out items need a selection first (for example a layer for Bake to Keyframes, or keyframes for Easy Ease).

# 07 Workspaces and docking panels

Arrange panels the way you work, and keep several layouts.

## Simple, Advanced and Minimal

| WORKSPACE | KEY | FOR |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Simple | `Shift` + `F10` | Working with presets: the timeline shows one row per layer with preset bars. |
| Advanced | `Shift` + `F11` | Keyframes: layers twirl open to show every property, keyframes and the Graph Editor. |
| Minimal | `Shift` + `F12` | Reviewing: just the canvas and the timeline. |

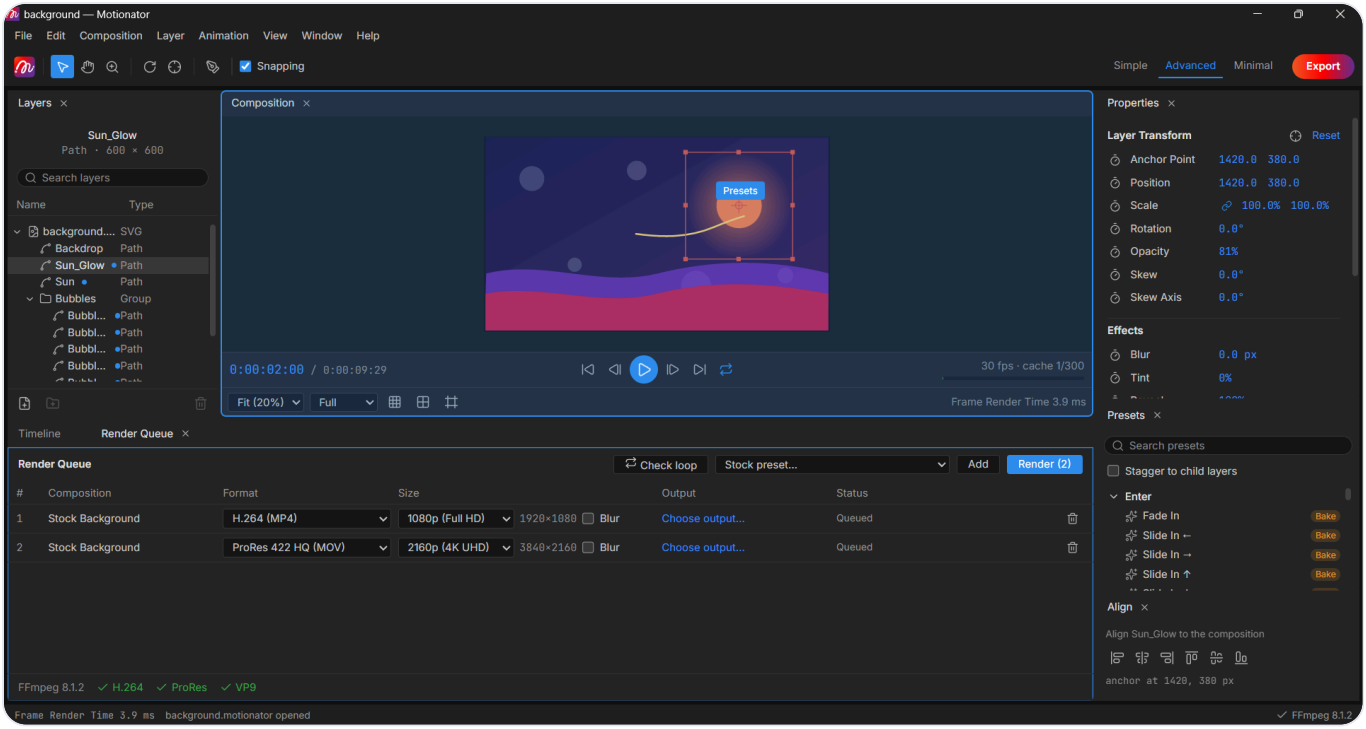



The Minimal workspace: more room for the canvas.

## Moving panels

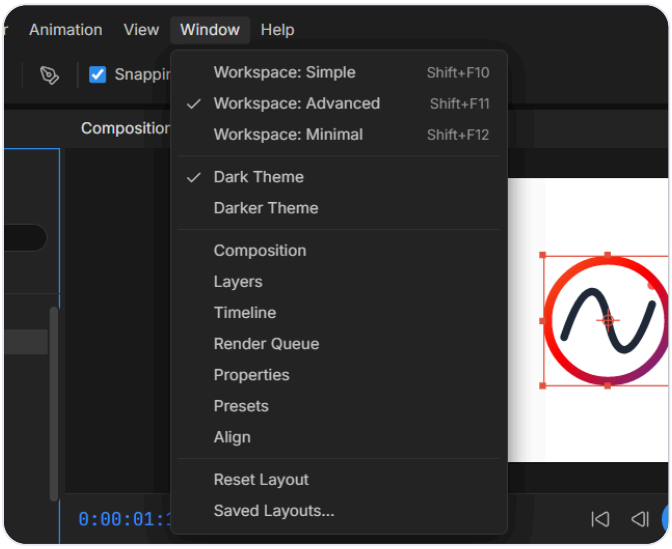
Drag a panel by its tab. A blue overlay shows where it will land: the outer quarter of a panel group docks it on that side, the middle adds it as a tab. Release to drop it there, or press `Esc` to cancel.

Drag the gaps between panels to resize them.

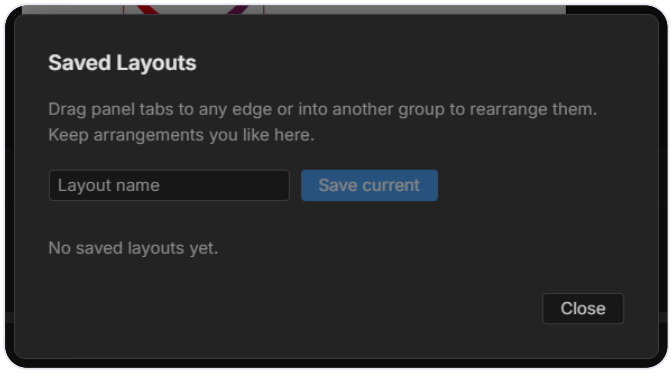



Dragging the Presets tab: the blue overlay marks the drop zone (here the middle of the Composition group, so it would become a tab).

Close a panel with the × on its tab and bring it back from the **Window** menu. Each workspace remembers its own arrangement. **Window ▸ Reset Layout** restores the default, and **Window ▸ Saved Layouts...** keeps arrangements under a name.




The Window menu: workspaces, themes, panels and layouts.

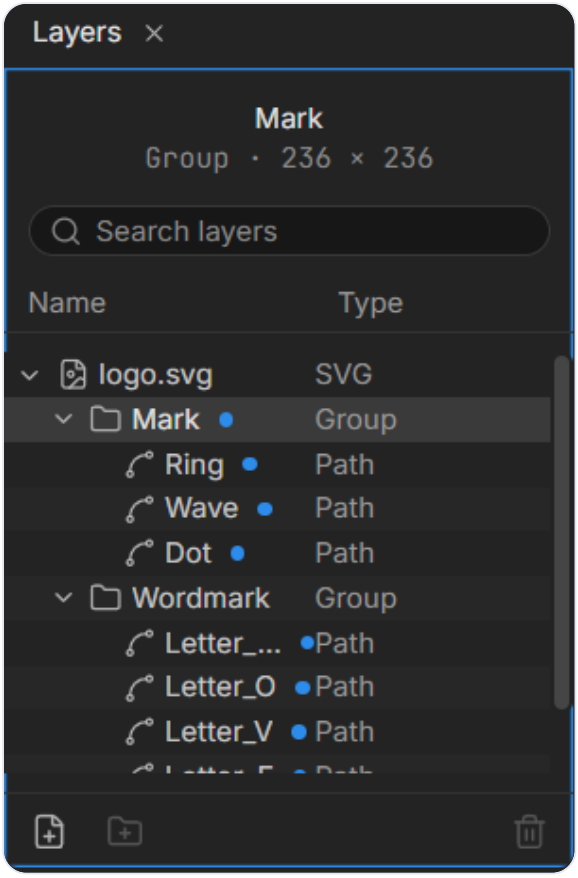



Saved Layouts: save the current arrangement, apply or delete saved ones.

**TIP**

Themes: **Window** ▸ **Dark Theme** or **Darker Theme**. The choice is remembered.

# 08 Layers panel

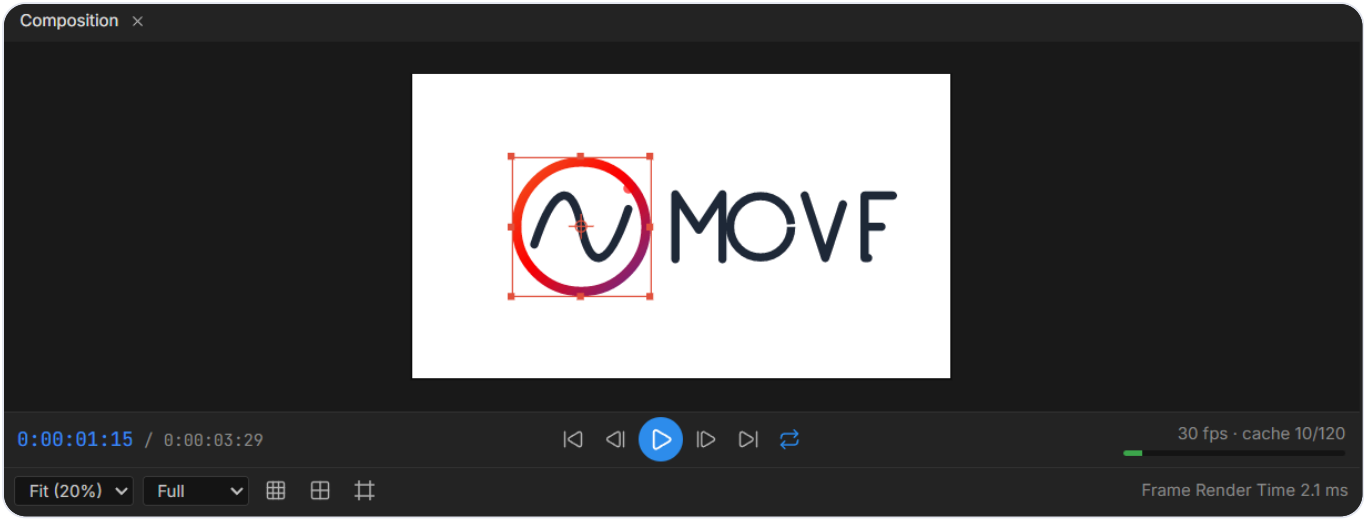



Layers panel with the logo sample: SVG root, groups and paths. A dot marks animated layers.

- **Header**: the selected layer's name, kind, size and SVG id.
- **Search**: type to filter layers by name.
- **Kinds**: *SVG* is the imported file (the root layer), *Group* and *Path* are named elements inside it. Arrows fold groups.
- **Blue dot**: the layer has presets or keyframes.
- **Buttons**: import another SVG, and delete the selected SVG (only whole SVG files can be deleted; their parts belong to the file).

A composition can hold several SVG files; each becomes its own root layer. Later imports appear on top.

# 09 Composition panel




The canvas with the selection box, anchor point (crosshair) and the bar of controls under it.

## Canvas

The composition is the white (or chequered, when transparent) rectangle; the dark area around it is the pasteboard. The selected layer shows a red box that follows its rotation, eight handles and its anchor point. Hovering a layer outlines it in blue.

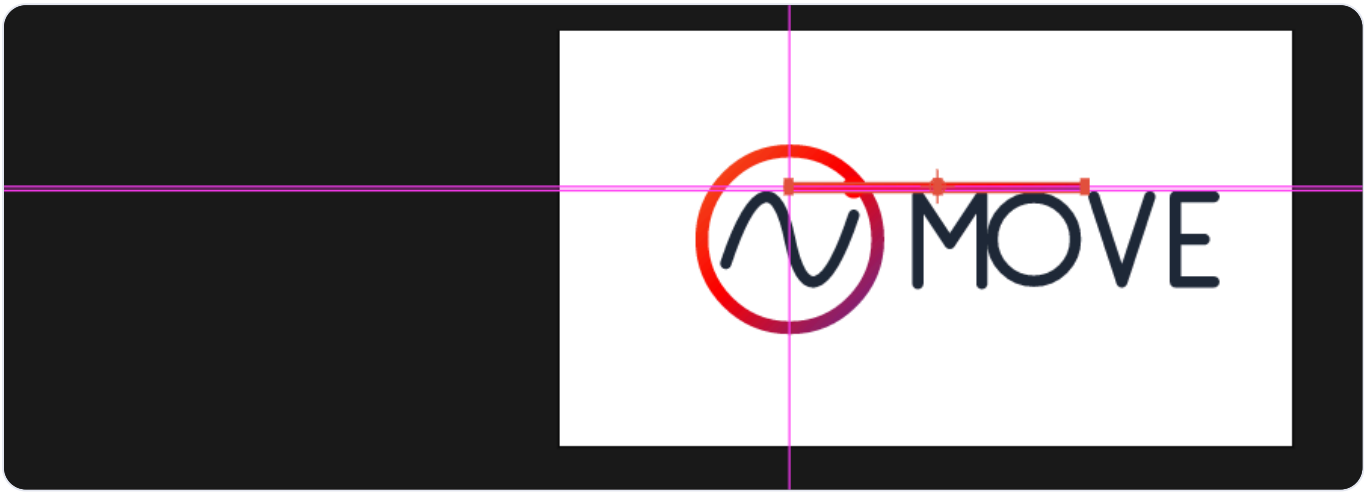
## Playback controls

| CONTROL | KEY | ACTION |
|---|---|---|
| Current time / duration | | Timecode in hours:minutes:seconds:frames. |
| Go to start / end | `Home` `End` | |
| Previous / next frame | `Page Up` `Page Down` | Also the arrow keys; with `Shift` they move 10 frames. |
| Play / Pause | `Space` | Plays in real time with sound (if the project has audio). |
| Loop | | Repeat playback from the start. |
| Cache | | How many frames are ready; cached frames play smoothly. |

## Viewer options

- **Zoom**: Fit, or a fixed percentage. Keys: `.` zoom in, `,` zoom out, `/` 100 %, `Shift`+`/` fit.
- **Resolution**: Full, Half, Third, Quarter. Lower resolutions preview faster on large compositions.
- **Grid** `Ctrl`+`'`, **transparency grid** and **safe areas** (action and title safe).
- **Frame Render Time**: how long the last frame took to draw.

## Snapping




Dragging the underline: magenta guides show that its edge now lines up with the centre of the Mark and the top of the letters.

With **Snapping** ticked in the toolbar (or **View** ▸ **Snapping** `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`;`), a layer you drag with the Selection tool sticks to useful lines as soon as it comes within 8 screen pixels of them. A magenta guide shows each line it snapped to.

| DRAGGING | WHAT SNAPS | SNAPS TO |
|---|---|---|
| A layer (Selection tool `V`) | Its left, centre and right edges, top, middle and bottom, and its anchor point | The composition's edges and centre lines; the edges and centres of every other layer |
| The anchor point (Anchor Point tool `Y`) | The anchor point | The layer's own corners, edges and centre; the composition's edges and centre |

- Layers inside the one you drag, and the groups it sits in, are not used as targets: they move with it.
- Hold `Ctrl` during a drag to invert snapping: move freely when Snapping is on, or snap once when it is off.
- `Shift` still locks the drag to one axis; snapping then only works along that axis.
- Snapping uses the layers' boxes at the current frame, so animated layers snap to where they are now.

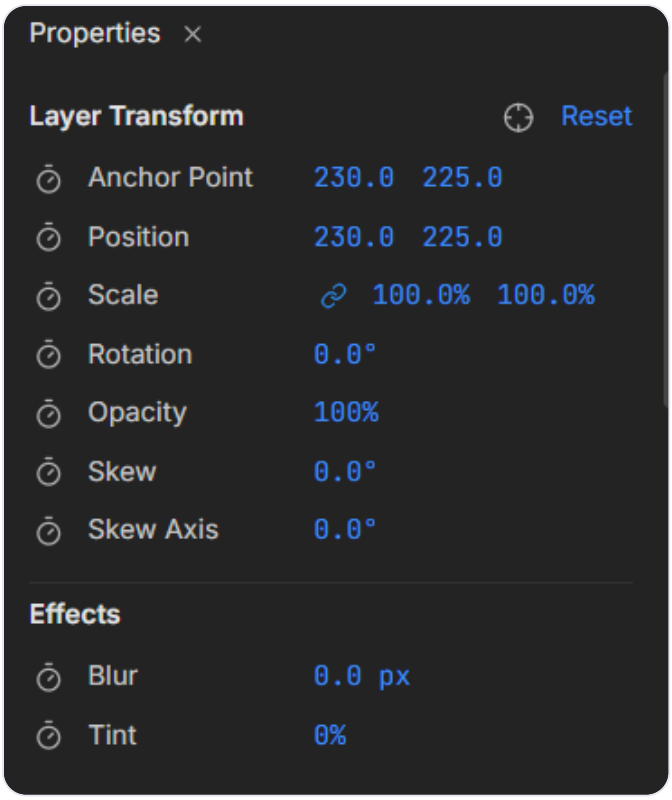



Anchor Point tool with snapping: the anchor sticks to the composition's centre line and to the middle of the underline.

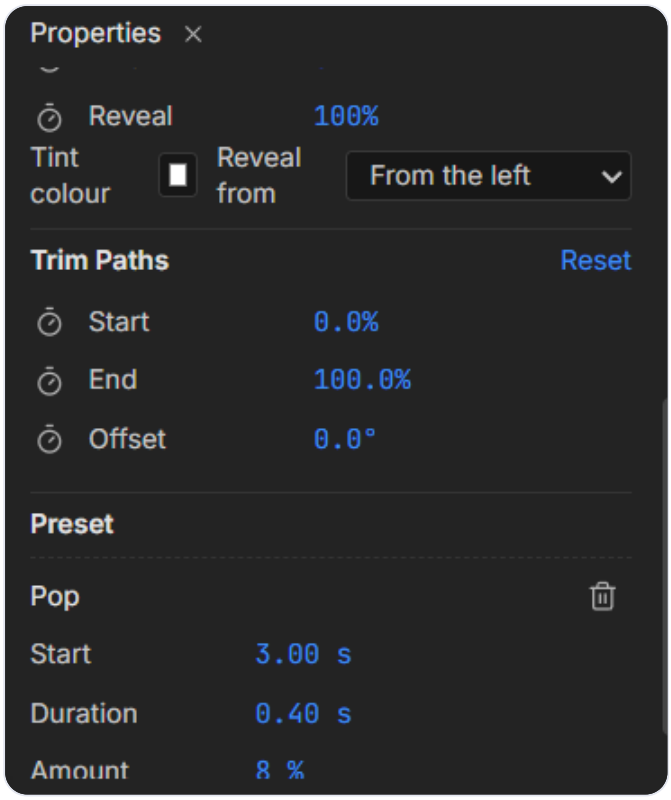
> **TIP**
> To centre a logo exactly, drag it near the middle: its centre snaps to the composition's centre lines. The Align panel does the same with one click.

# 10 Properties panel

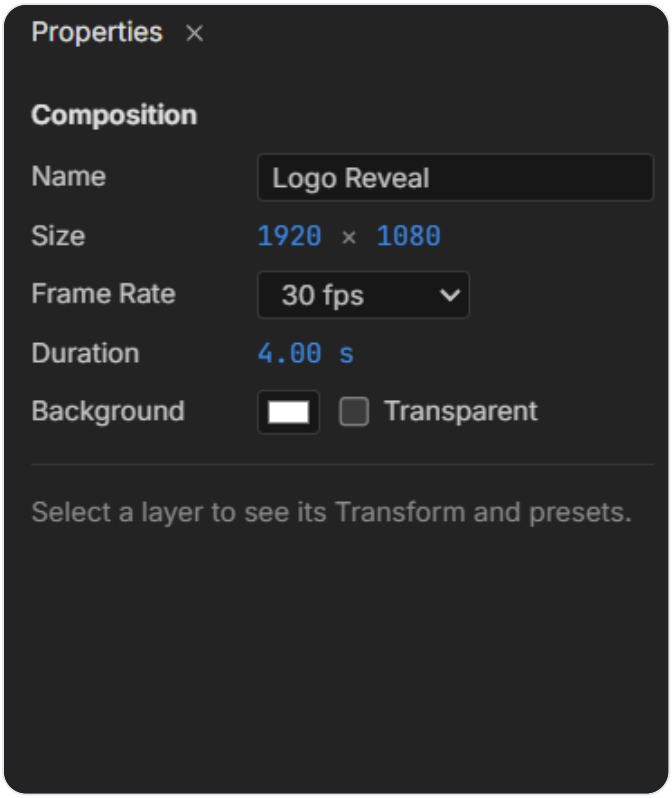
Exact values for the selected layer, or the composition settings when nothing is selected.




Layer Transform and Effects.




Further down: Trim Paths and the presets on this layer.




With nothing selected: the composition settings.

## Editing values

Blue numbers can be **dragged** left and right to scrub the value, or **clicked** to type a number (press `Enter` to confirm, `Esc` to cancel). The clock icon is the **stopwatch**: turn it on to animate the property with keyframes (see Keyframes).

## Layer Transform

| PROPERTY | MEANING |
| --- | --- |
| Anchor Point | The pivot for rotation, scale and skew, in the parent's coordinates. The crosshair button centres it on the layer. |
| Position | Where the anchor point sits (x, y). |
| Scale | Width and height in percent. The chain button keeps the proportions. |
| Rotation | Degrees, clockwise. |
| Opacity | 0–100 %. |

| PROPERTY | MEANING |
| --- | --- |
| Skew / Skew Axis | Slants the layer along an axis (degrees), like in After Effects. |

**Reset** returns the transform to the rest pose of the SVG (effects are kept). **Layer ▸ Center Anchor Point** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Home` and **Layer ▸ Reset Transform** do the same from the menu.

## Effects

| EFFECT | MEANING |
| --- | --- |
| Blur | Gaussian blur radius in the layer's own pixels (it grows with the layer's scale). |
| Tint | How much of the tint colour replaces the layer's colours (0–100 %). Pick the colour with **Tint colour**. |
| Reveal | The visible part of the layer's box (100 % = all), wiping in from the side chosen in **Reveal from**: left, right, top, bottom, iris (circle) or centre. |

## Composition settings

Click an empty part of the canvas (or press `Ctrl` + `K`) to edit the composition: **name**, **size** in pixels, **frame rate** (23.976 to 60 fps), **duration** in seconds and the **background** colour. Tick **Transparent** for a transparent background, needed for ProRes 4444 or VP9 with alpha.

## Align panel

The six buttons align the selected layer's box to the left, centre or right and to the top, middle or bottom of the composition. If Position is keyframed, the change is keyed at the playhead.

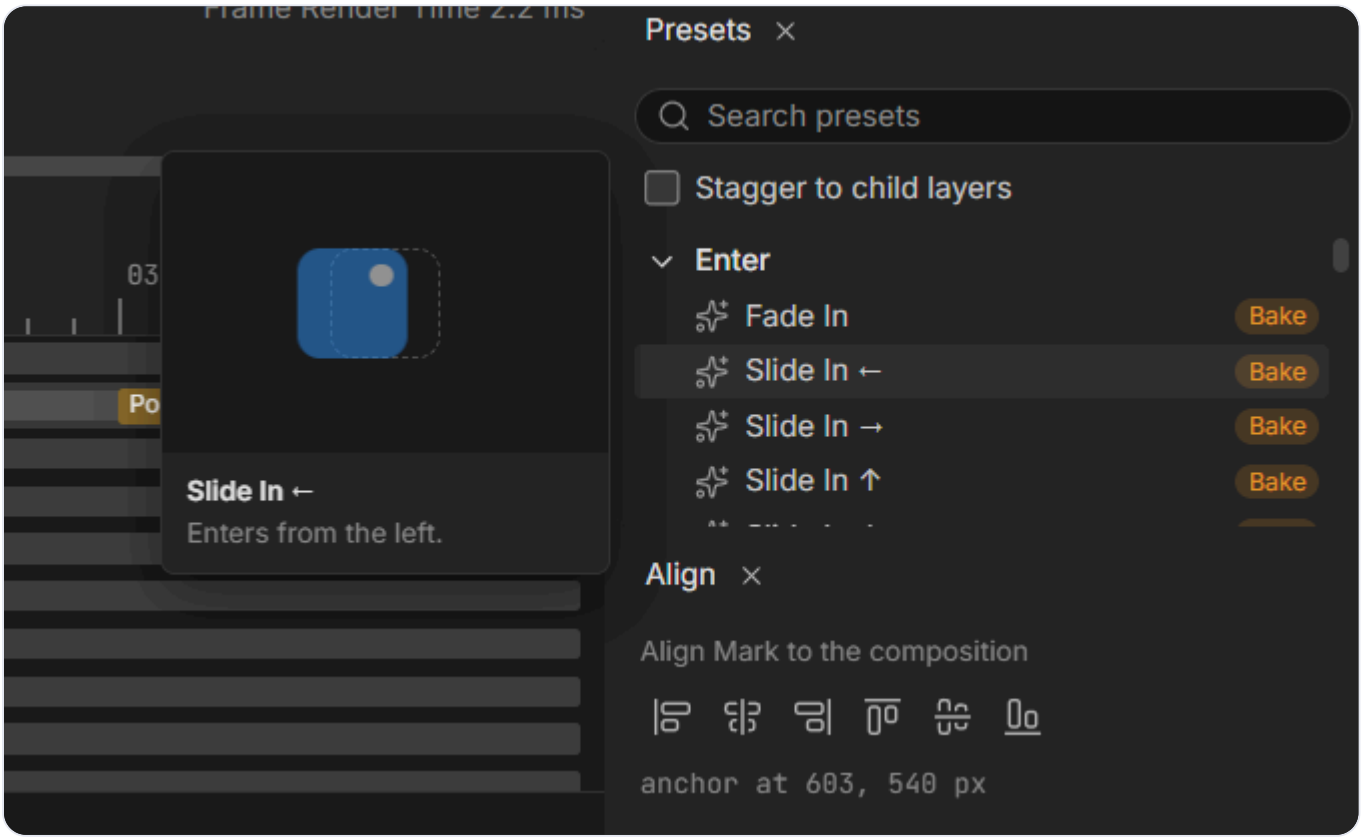
# 11 Presets

99 ready-made motions in four categories, applied with a double-click.

## The four categories

| CATEGORY | WHAT IT DOES | WHERE IT IS PLACED |
|---|---|---|
| Enter | Brings the layer in: it ends in the layer's rest pose. | Starts at the playhead. |
| Exit | Takes the layer out: it starts from the rest pose. | Ends at the end of the composition. |
| Loop | Repeats for as long as the bar lasts and loops seamlessly. | Covers the whole composition. |
| Emphasis | A short accent that returns to where it started. | Starts at the playhead. |

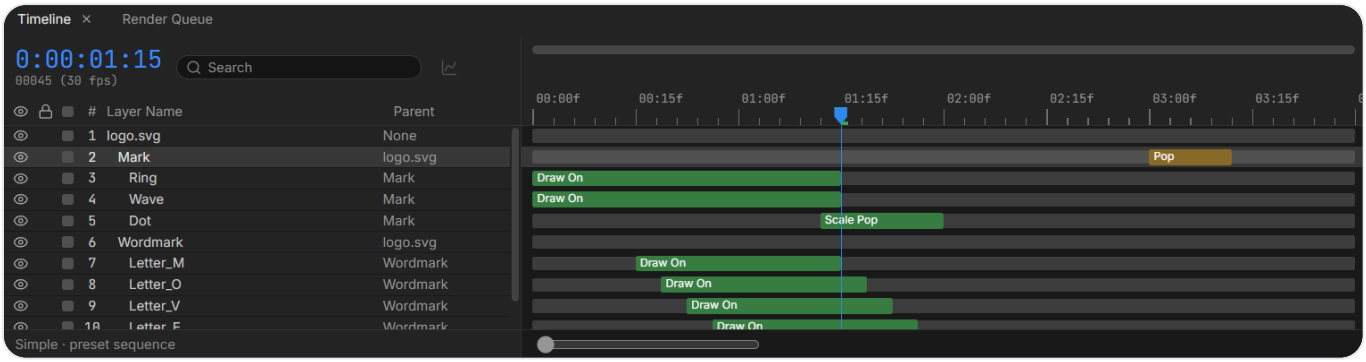
## Applying a preset




Hovering a preset plays a live preview of it on a sample shape.

1. Select a layer (in the Layers panel, the timeline or on the canvas).
2. For Enter and Emphasis presets, move the playhead to where the motion should start.
3. Find the preset: type in **Search presets** or open a category. Hover to preview.
4. Double-click the preset. It appears as a bar in the timeline and in the **Preset** section of the Properties panel.

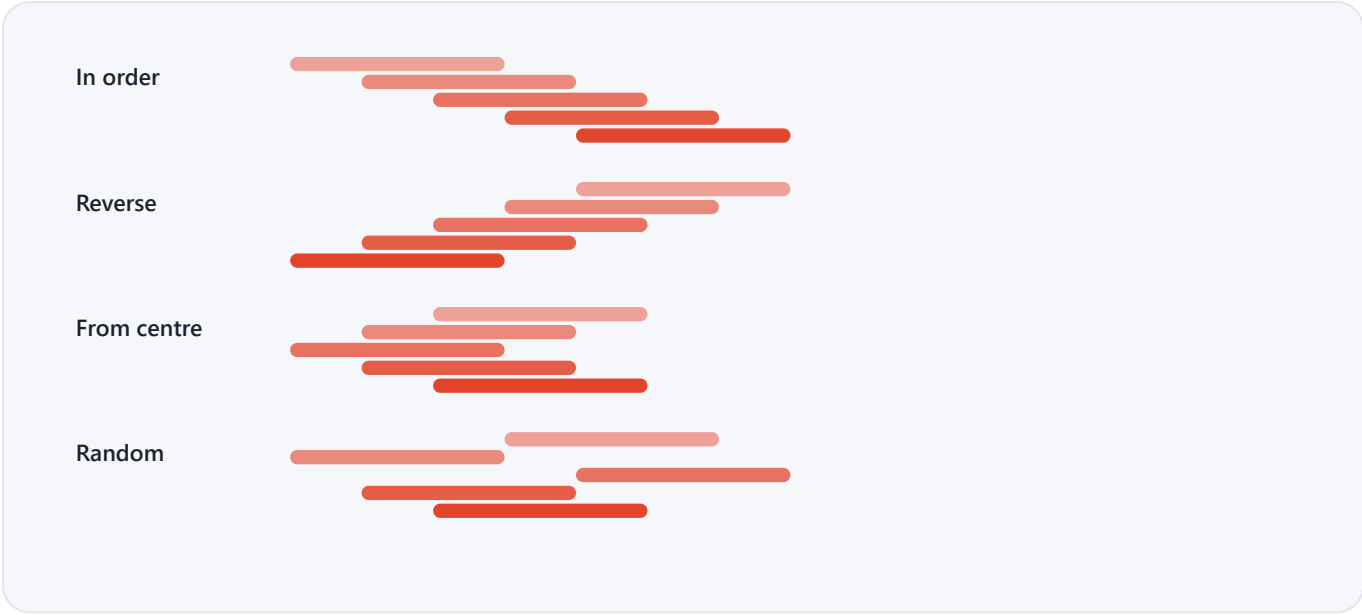
A layer can have any number of presets. Select a bar in the timeline to edit its **Start**, **Duration** and parameters (distance, amount, period, direction…) in the Properties panel, or delete it with the trash icon or `Delete`.




The Simple timeline: one row per layer, presets as coloured bars. Drag a bar to move it, drag its edges to change its length.

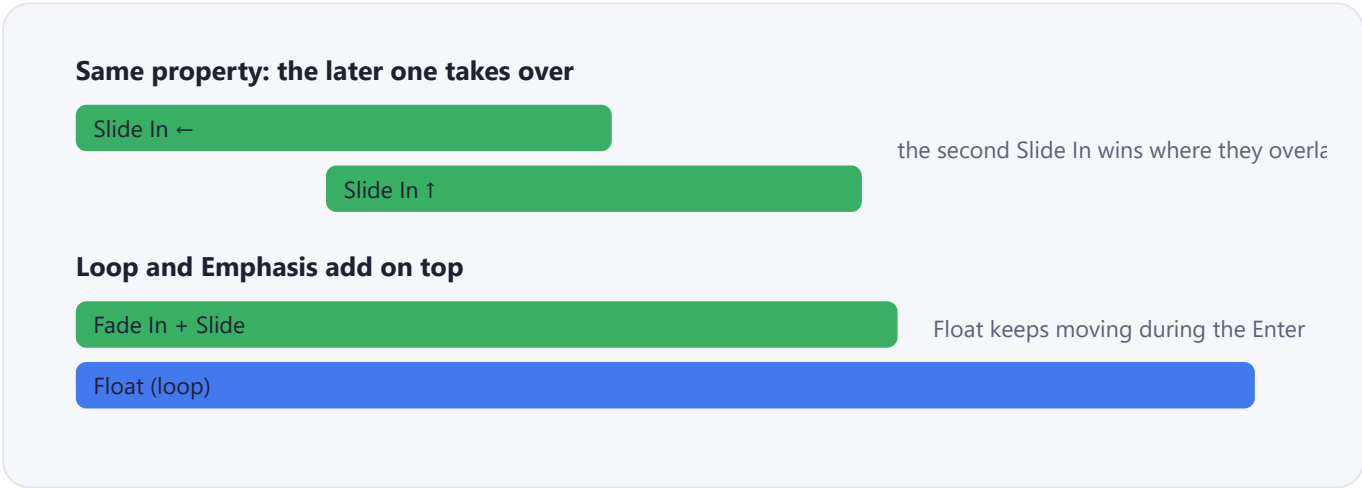
## Stagger: animate children one after another

Tick **Stagger to child layers** at the top of the Presets panel, select a group and double-click a preset. Instead of the group, each child layer gets the preset, each starting a little later. Set the delay between them (seconds) and the order:




The letters of the logo sample use stagger: *Draw On* on the group `Wordmark` with 0.125 s between letters. Random order is seeded, so it is the same on every render.

## Combining presets




- **Enter and Exit** presets *override*: where two of them change the same property at the same time, the one that starts later wins.
- **Loop and Emphasis** presets are *added* on top of everything else, so a layer can float while it slides in.
- **Keyframes** are the base: presets work relative to the keyframed value.
- Presets that rotate or scale (Swing, Spin, Pop…) turn around the **anchor point**; move it first if the pivot matters.

## Bake to Keyframes

**Animation ▸ Bake to Keyframes** turns the presets of the selected layer into ordinary keyframes, so you can fine-tune them in the Graph Editor. The badge next to each preset (*Bake*) means it is exported to Lottie in this baked form.

## All presets

| CATEGORY | PRESET | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|---|
| Enter | **Fade In** | Fades in from transparent. |
| Enter | **Slide In ←** | Enters from the left. |
| Enter | **Slide In →** | Enters from the right. |
| Enter | **Slide In ↑** | Rises from below. |
| Enter | **Slide In ↓** | Comes down from above. |
| Enter | **Scale Pop** | Grows from zero with a slight overshoot. |
| Enter | **Rotate In** | Rotates in while fading in. |
| Enter | **Bounce In** | Drops from above and bounces. |
| Enter | **Elastic Pop** | Grows with an elastic wobble. |
| Enter | **Drop** | Falls from above, accelerating. |
| Enter | **Zoom In** | Comes in large and shrinks to size. |
| Enter | **Fly In** | Flies in diagonally. |
| Enter | **Spiral In** | Spins while growing from zero. |
| Enter | **Roll In** | Rolls in from the left. |
| Enter | **Flip In X** | Flips in around the vertical axis (3D look). |
| Enter | **Flip In Y** | Flips in around the horizontal axis (3D look). |
| Enter | **Pop Up** | Pops up with a slight overshoot. |
| Enter | **Swing In** | Swings in and settles (put the anchor on the hinge). |

| CATEGORY | PRESET | DESCRIPTION |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Enter | **Stretch In** | Comes in stretched and springs into shape. |
| Enter | **Draw On** | Strokes draw on from the start of each path to its end (needs a stroke). |
| Enter | **Draw From Centre** | Strokes draw out from the middle of each path to both ends (needs a stroke). |
| Enter | **Blur In** | Comes into focus from a blur. |
| Enter | **Shear In** | Slides in slanted, then straightens. |
| Enter | **Wipe In** | Wipes on from one side. |
| Enter | **Iris In** | Opens from a small circle in the middle. |
| Enter | **Split Reveal** | Opens from the centre line out to both sides. |
| Enter | **Brush In** | Painted in by a brush sweeping back and forth. |
| Enter | **Typewriter** | Appears at once; staggered over letters it types out. |
| Enter | **Drop Bounce** | Falls from above and bounces twice, with squash and stretch. |
| Enter | **Neon Flicker** | Stutters on like a neon tube, then stays lit with a glow. |
| Enter | **Long Shadow Grow** | A flat long shadow growing out of the layer. |
| Enter | **Card Flip In** | Flips over from its back to its front, like a card. |
| Enter | **Peel On** | Lands like a sticker being laid down: the paper fold rolls flat. |
| Exit | **Fade Out** | Fades out to transparent. |
| Exit | **Scale Out** | Shrinks until it disappears. |
| Exit | **Slide Out ←** | Exits to the left. |
| Exit | **Slide Out →** | Exits to the right. |
| Exit | **Slide Out ↑** | Exits upwards. |

| CATEGORY | PRESET | DESCRIPTION |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Exit | **Slide Out ↓** | Exits downwards. |
| Exit | **Rotate Out** | Rotates out while fading out. |
| Exit | **Bounce Out** | Hops up, then falls out. |
| Exit | **Zoom Out** | Grows while fading out. |
| Exit | **Fly Out** | Flies out diagonally. |
| Exit | **Spiral Out** | Spins while shrinking away. |
| Exit | **Roll Out** | Rolls out to the right. |
| Exit | **Flip Out X** | Flips out around the vertical axis. |
| Exit | **Flip Out Y** | Flips out around the horizontal axis. |
| Exit | **Sink** | Sinks a little, shrinks and fades. |
| Exit | **Collapse** | Flattens to a line and disappears. |
| Exit | **Draw Off** | Strokes erase from the start of each path to its end (needs a stroke). |
| Exit | **Blur Out** | Blurs away while fading out. |
| Exit | **Wipe Out** | Wipes off towards one side. |
| Exit | **Iris Out** | Closes to a circle in the middle. |
| Exit | **Brush Out** | Wiped away by a brush sweeping back and forth. |
| Exit | **Backspace** | Vanishes at once; staggered in reverse it is deleted letter by letter. |
| Exit | **Peel Off** | Peels off like paper and folds away off screen (page curl). |
| Loop | **Float** | Floats up and down continuously. |
| Loop | **Pulse** | Grows and shrinks rhythmically. |
| Loop | **Spin** | Spins continuously. |

| CATEGORY | PRESET | DESCRIPTION |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Loop | **Swing** | Swings like a pendulum (anchor = pivot). |
| Loop | **Breathe** | Slowly grows and dims, like breathing. |
| Loop | **Blink** | Blinks briefly at a regular interval. |
| Loop | **Orbit** | Moves in a circle, starting and ending at its own position. |
| Loop | **Figure 8** | Moves along a figure eight. |
| Loop | **Bounce** | Hops in place with squash and stretch. |
| Loop | **Wobble** | Wobbles and stretches gently, continuously. |
| Loop | **Glow** | Dims and brightens rhythmically. |
| Loop | **Drift** | Drifts slowly and irregularly, still seamless when looped. |
| Loop | **Hover** | Hovers up and down with a slight tilt. |
| Loop | **Tick** | Rotates in steps like a clock hand. |
| Loop | **Trace** | A segment of the stroke travels along each path continuously (needs a stroke). |
| Loop | **Sway** | Sways from side to side like in the wind. |
| Loop | **Tint Pulse** | A colour pulses in and out continuously. |
| Loop | **Glow Pulse** | The light around the layer swells and fades rhythmically (neon, lamps). |
| Loop | **Long Shadow** | A flat long shadow falling one way (flat design). |
| Loop | **Flag Wave** | Waves like a flag or cloth, with light and shade in the folds. |
| Loop | **Coin Spin** | Spins like a coin, with a thick edge and a shine. |
| Emphasis | **Shake** | Shakes left and right, then settles. |
| Emphasis | **Heartbeat** | Two quick beats. |
| Emphasis | **Tada** | Shrinks, grows while wobbling, then settles. |

| CATEGORY | PRESET | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|---|
| Emphasis | **Jello** | Wobbles like jelly. |
| Emphasis | **Wiggle** | Smooth random motion (seeded, identical on every render). |
| Emphasis | **Flash** | Flashes a few times. |
| Emphasis | **Rubber Band** | Stretches and snaps back like rubber. |
| Emphasis | **Head Shake** | Shakes its head, like saying no. |
| Emphasis | **Nod** | Nods twice. |
| Emphasis | **Spin** | Spins full turns, then stops. |
| Emphasis | **Flip** | Flips over horizontally once. |
| Emphasis | **Pop** | Grows for a moment, then returns. |
| Emphasis | **Squash** | Squashes, then springs back. |
| Emphasis | **Nudge** | Nudges aside, then returns. |
| Emphasis | **Swing** | Swings a few times, then rests (anchor = pivot). |
| Emphasis | **Focus Pulse** | Blurs for a moment, then sharpens again. |
| Emphasis | **Lean** | Leans to one side, then springs back. |
| Emphasis | **Color Flash** | Flashes a colour for a moment, then returns. |
| Emphasis | **Jump** | Jumps twice, the second one lower. |
| Emphasis | **Glow Flash** | Lights up brightly once, then settles. |
| Emphasis | **Card Flip** | Turns over once, showing its back on the way. |
| Emphasis | **Peel Corner** | A corner lifts for a moment and settles back. |

**TIP**

Presets marked *needs a stroke* (Draw On, Draw From Centre, Draw Off, Trace) animate Trim Paths and only show on paths with a stroke.

# 12 Preset reference

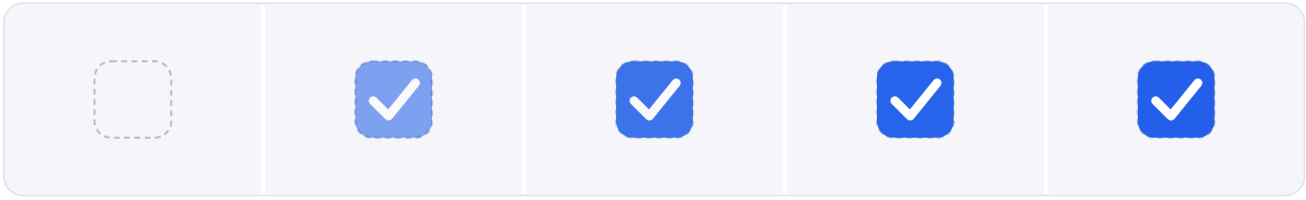
Every preset with frames rendered by Motionator, its default length, its parameters and when to use it.

Each strip shows five moments of the preset on a demo tile, from the start (left) to the end (right). The dashed outline marks the layer's rest pose. Loops show two seconds. Every parameter can be changed after applying, in the Properties panel.

## Enter presets

### Fade In Enter

Fades in from transparent. · Default length 0.6 s · `enter.fade`

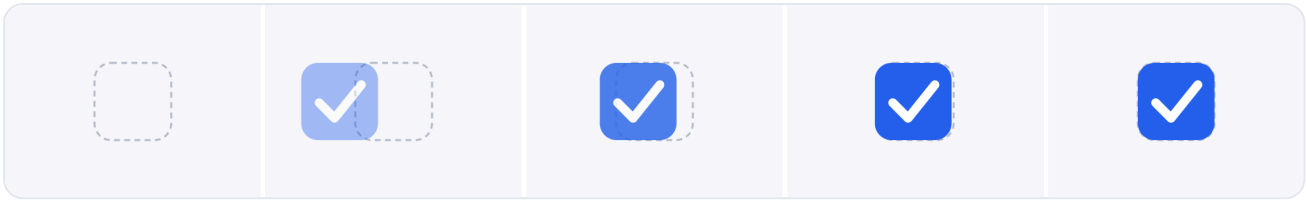



💡 The safest entrance: combine it with any move for a softer start. Use 0.3–0.6 s for UI, up to 1.5 s for calm backgrounds.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Slide In ← Enter

Enters from the left. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.slide_left`

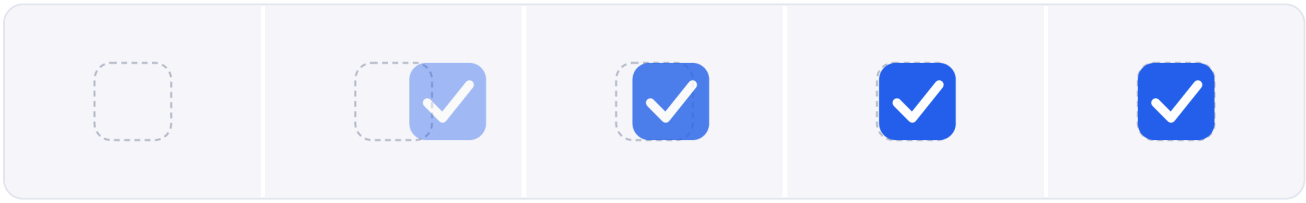



💡 Good for text and cards entering in reading order. Keep the distance small (40–120 px) for elegance, large for drama.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Slide In → Enter

Enters from the right. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.slide_right`

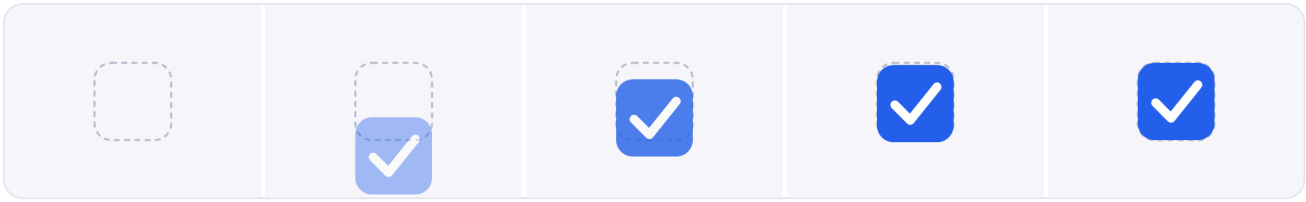



💡 Use for elements on the right side of the frame so they arrive from the nearest edge.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Slide In ↑ Enter

Rises from below. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.slide_up`

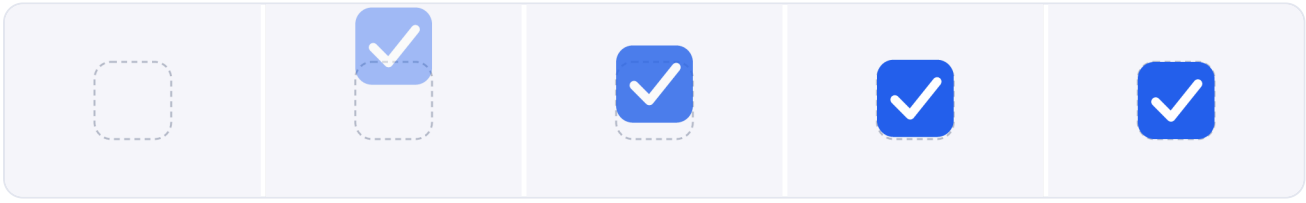



💡 The classic title move. With stagger on lines of text it reads naturally top to bottom.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Slide In ↓ Enter

Comes down from above. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.slide_down`

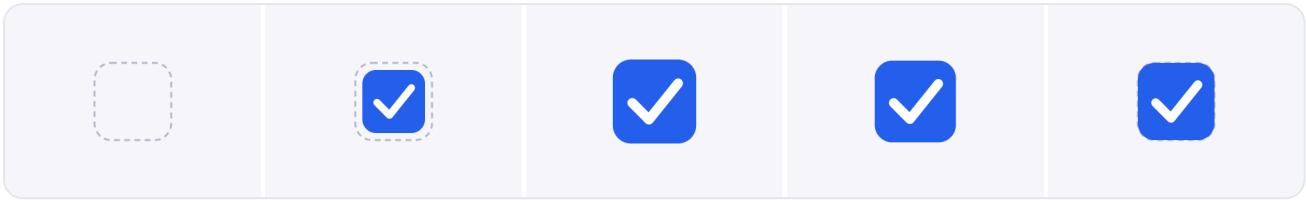



💡 Works for things that hang or drop into place: banners, labels, price tags.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Scale Pop Enter

Grows from zero with a slight overshoot. · Default length 0.6 s · `enter.scale_pop`

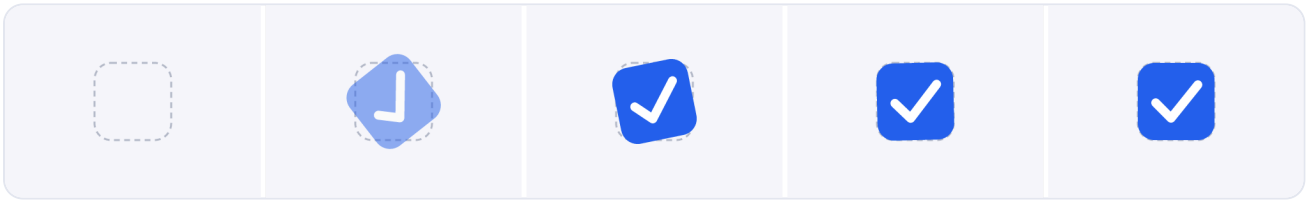



💡 The go-to for icons, buttons and badges. The slight overshoot makes it feel alive; keep the anchor in the centre.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Back |

## Rotate In Enter

Rotates in while fading in. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.rotate_in`

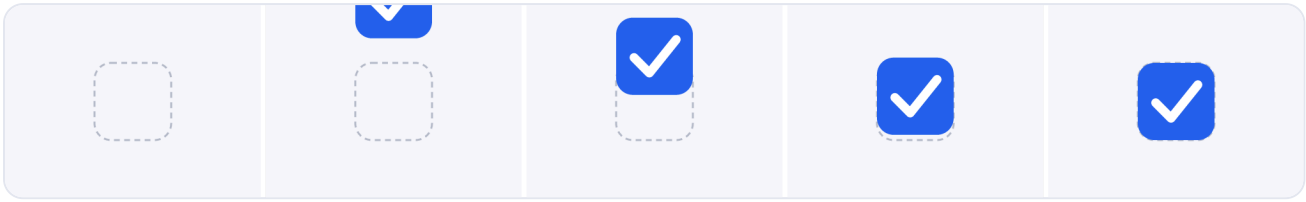



💡 Adds energy to logos and stickers. Combine with a centred anchor so it does not swing.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | -720 – 720 ° | -90 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Bounce In Enter

Drops from above and bounces. · Default length 1 s · `enter.bounce_in`

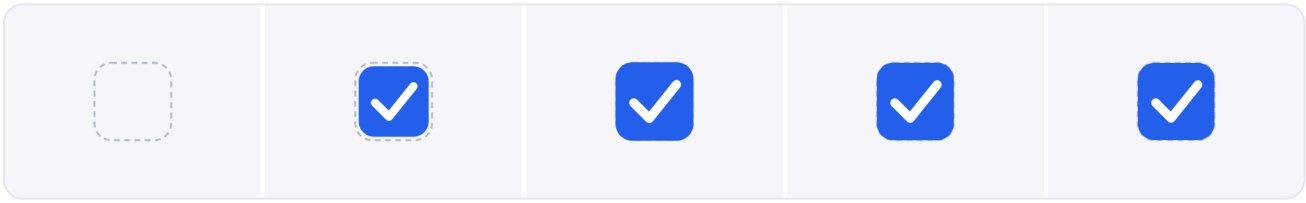



💡 Playful: cartoon objects, kids content, fun call-outs. Too much bounce feels cheap in corporate work.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 300 px |

## Elastic Pop Enter

Grows with an elastic wobble. · Default length 1 s · `enter.elastic_pop`

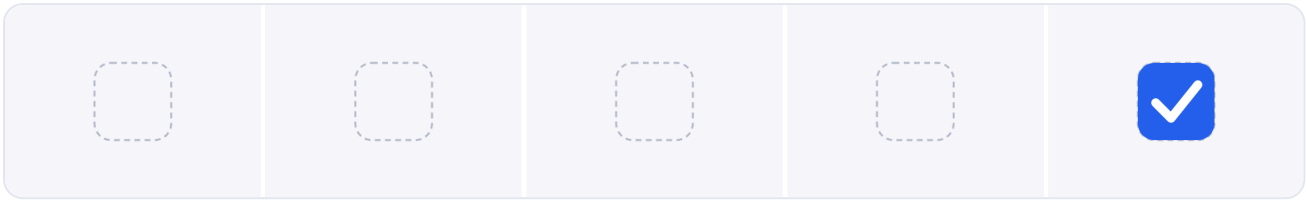



💡 A springier Scale Pop. Great for a logo dot, a notification badge or a like icon.

No parameters: only Start and Duration.

## Drop Enter

Falls from above, accelerating. · Default length 0.6 s · `enter.drop`

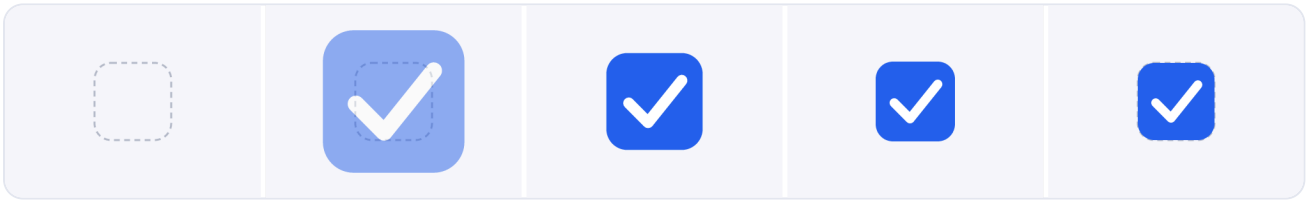



💡 Feels heavy, like gravity. Pair it with a Squash emphasis on landing.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 400 px |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Zoom In Enter

Comes in large and shrinks to size. · Default length 0.7 s · `enter.zoom_in`

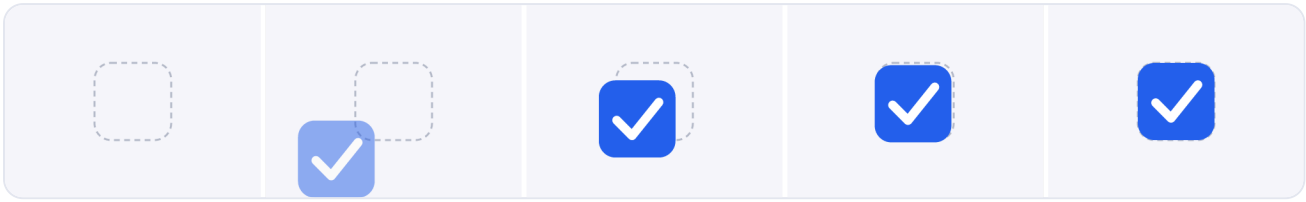



💡 Cinematic for big titles: the element settles into place from the camera's side.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Start scale | 100 – 1000 % | 300 % |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Fly In Enter

Flies in diagonally. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.fly_in`

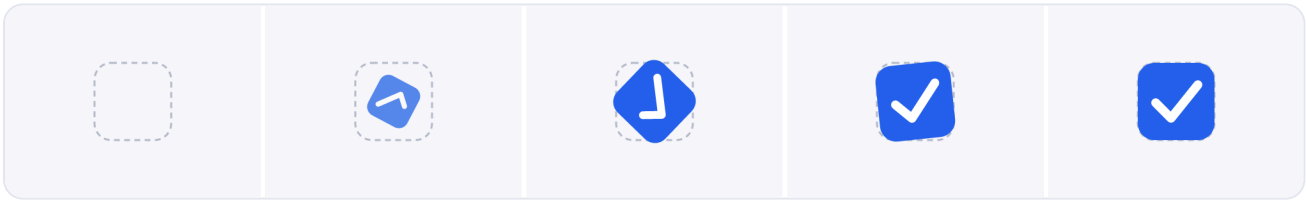



💡 For dynamic compositions where elements come from a corner; choose the corner in the parameters.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 300 px |
| From | Bottom left, Bottom right, Top left, Top right | Bottom left |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Spiral In Enter

Spins while growing from zero. · Default length 0.9 s · `enter.spiral_in`

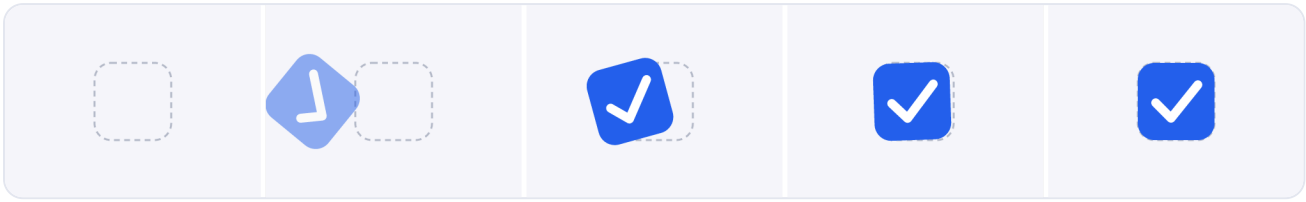



💡 Eye-catching for stickers and badges. Use sparingly: one spiral per scene is plenty.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | -1440 – 1440 ° | -360 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Roll In Enter

Rolls in from the left. · Default length 0.9 s · `enter.roll_in`

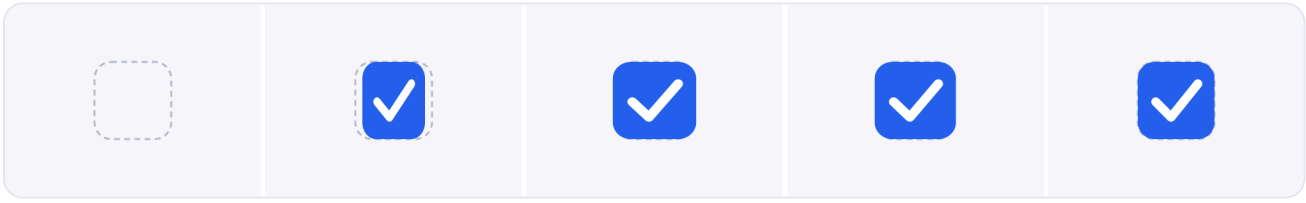



💡 For round things: wheels, coins, balls. The rotation matches the distance travelled.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 300 px |
| Angle | 0 – 1440 ° | 120 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Flip In X Enter

Flips in around the vertical axis (3D look). · Default length 0.7 s · `enter.flip_in_x`

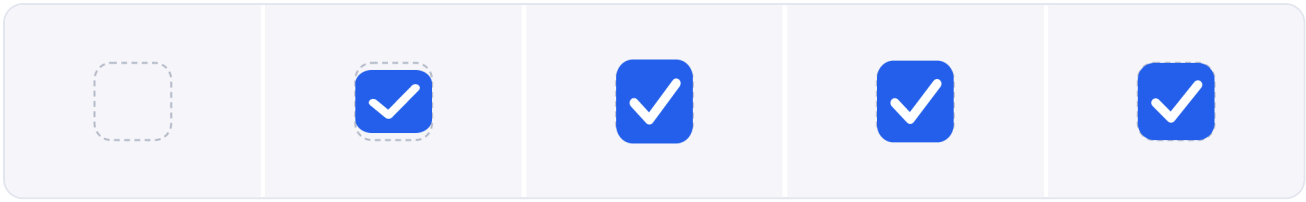



💡 Card and tile reveals. Looks 3D without any 3D setup.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Back |

## Flip In Y Enter

Flips in around the horizontal axis (3D look). · Default length 0.7 s · `enter.flip_in_y`

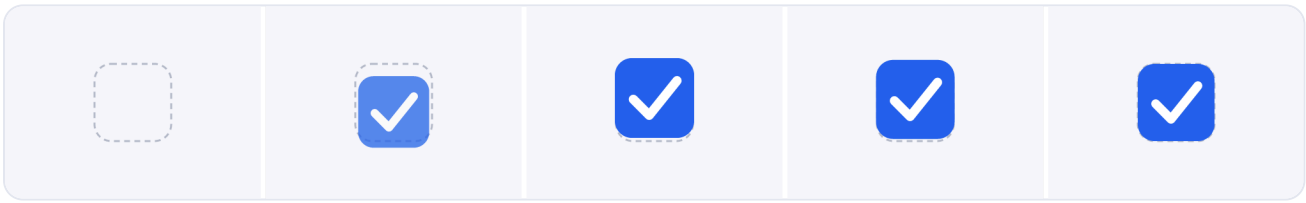



💡 Like Flip In X but vertical: good for counters and rows of tiles.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Back |

## Pop Up Enter

Pops up with a slight overshoot. · Default length 0.6 s · `enter.pop_up`

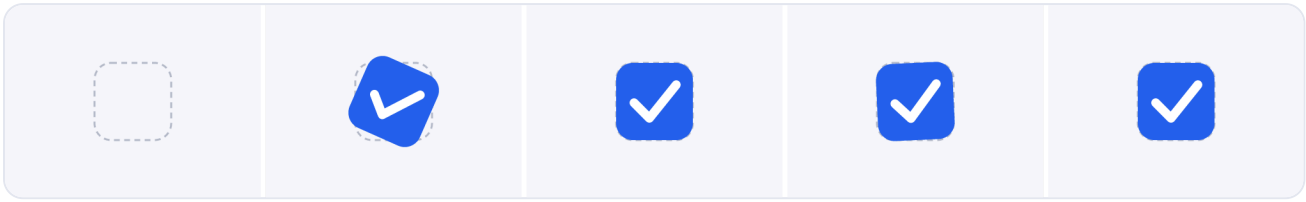



💡 Ideal for letters and list items with stagger: each rises and overshoots slightly.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 2000 px | 80 px |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Back |

## Swing In Enter

Swings in and settles (put the anchor on the hinge). · Default length 1 s · `enter.swing_in`

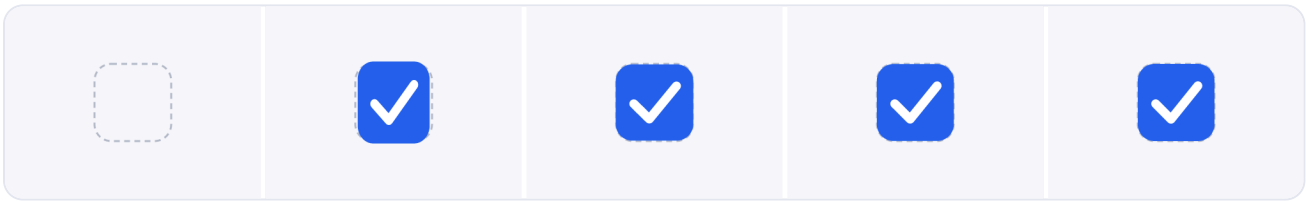



💡 Hanging signs and pendants. Put the anchor on the hinge with the Anchor Point tool first.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | -180 – 180 ° | -60 ° |

## Stretch In Enter

Comes in stretched and springs into shape. · Default length 0.9 s · `enter.stretch_in`

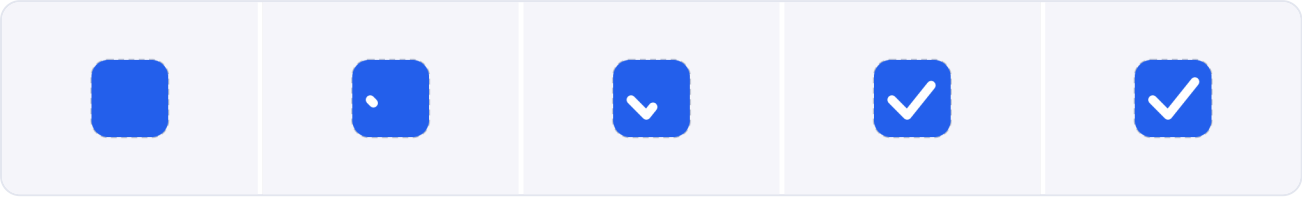



💡 Gives cartoon squash-and-stretch energy to simple shapes.

No parameters: only Start and Duration.

## Draw On Enter

Strokes draw on from the start of each path to its end (needs a stroke). · Default length 1.2 s · `enter.draw_on`

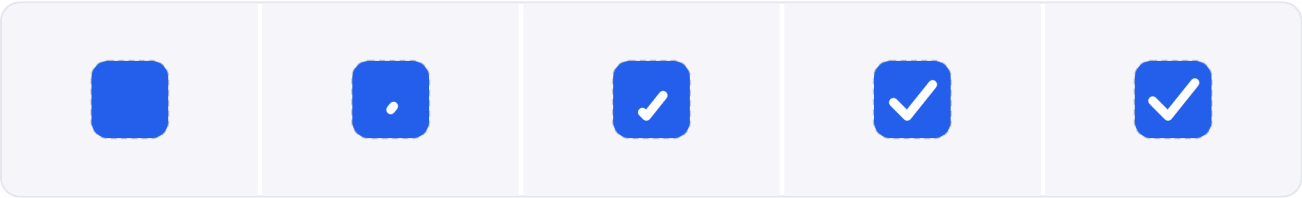



💡 The signature logo reveal: strokes draw from start to end. Path direction in your SVG decides where it starts.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Draw From Centre Enter

Strokes draw out from the middle of each path to both ends (needs a stroke). · Default length 1.2 s · `enter.draw_center`




💡 Symmetric reveals: underlines, frames and dividers growing from the middle.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Blur In Enter

Comes into focus from a blur. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.blur_in`

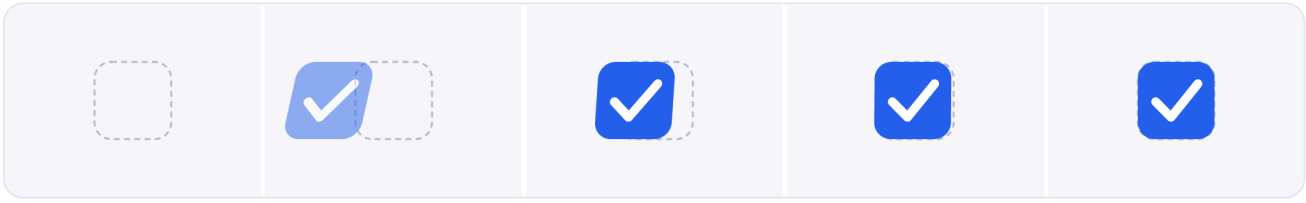



💡 Soft and modern, good for backgrounds and quotes. Blur is not in Lottie; use it for video and SVG.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Blur | 0 – 200 px | 24 px |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Shear In Enter

Slides in slanted, then straightens. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.shear_in`

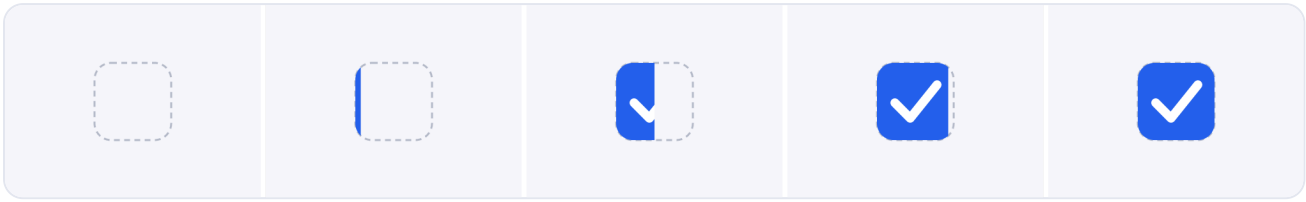



💡 Fast, sporty feel for headlines and sale banners.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 240 px |
| Slant | -80 – 80 ° | 30 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Wipe In Enter

Wipes on from one side. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.wipe`

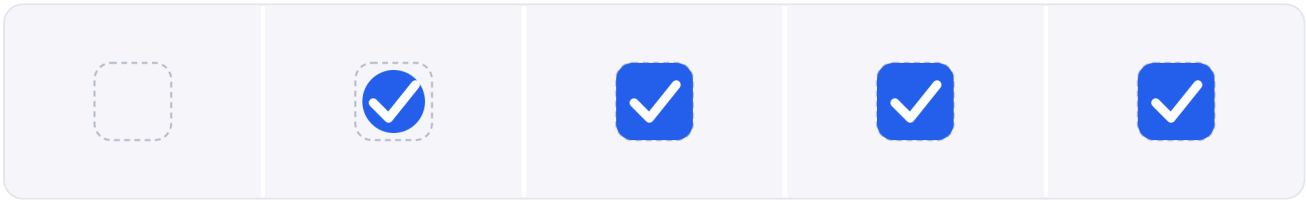



💡 Reveals filled shapes cleanly: bars, underlines, panels. Choose the side in *From*.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| From | From the left, From the right, From the top, From the bottom | From the left |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Iris In Enter

Opens from a small circle in the middle. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.iris`

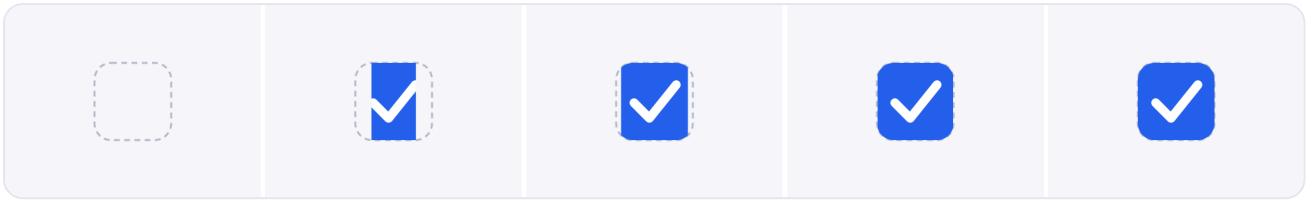



💡 A circular reveal: photos in circles, avatars, spotlight effects.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Split Reveal Enter

Opens from the centre line out to both sides. · Default length 0.8 s · `enter.split`



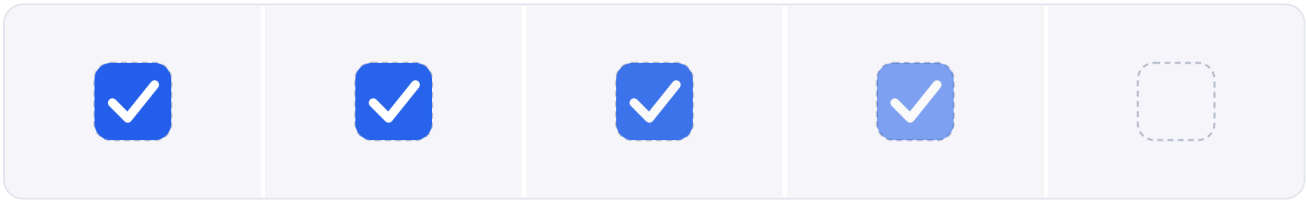

💡 Opens a panel from the centre line, like doors opening.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease Out Cubic |

## Exit presets

## Fade Out Exit

Fades out to transparent. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.fade`

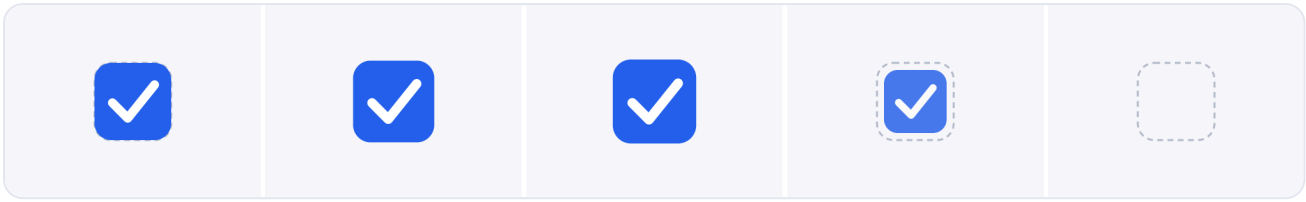



💡 The neutral exit. Placed at the end of the composition automatically.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Scale Out Exit

Shrinks until it disappears. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.scale`

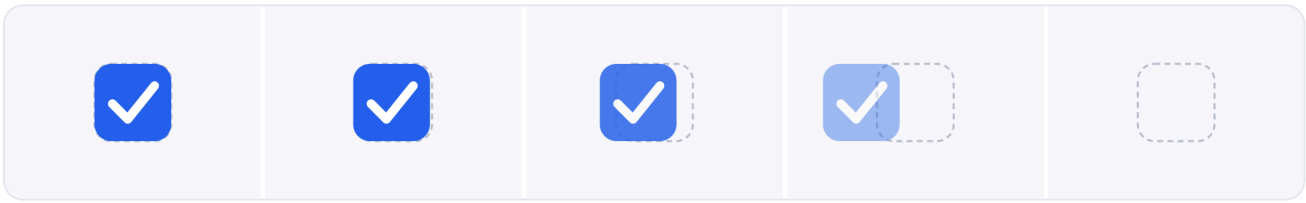



💡 A tidy exit for icons and badges; the reverse of Scale Pop.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Back |

## Slide Out ← Exit

Exits to the left. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.slide_left`

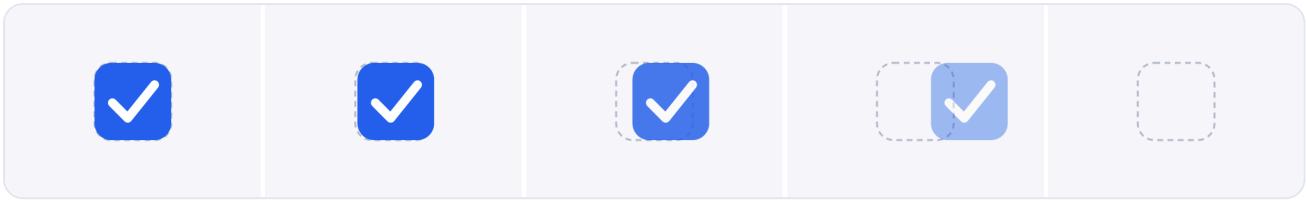



💡 Pairs with Slide In → for elements that pass through the frame.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Slide Out → Exit

Exits to the right. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.slide_right`

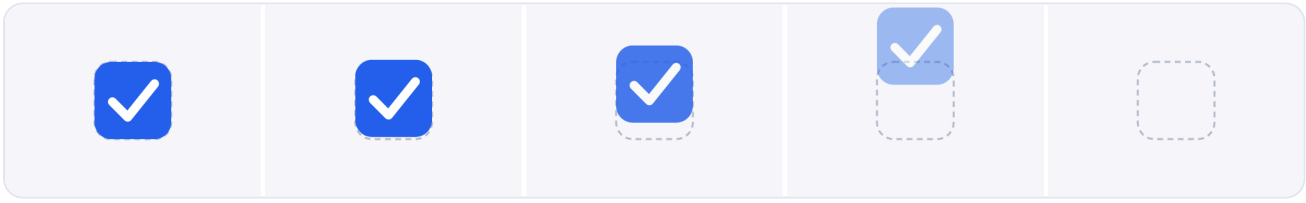



💡 Pairs with Slide In ← for continuous left-to-right motion.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Slide Out ↑ Exit

Exits upwards. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.slide_up`

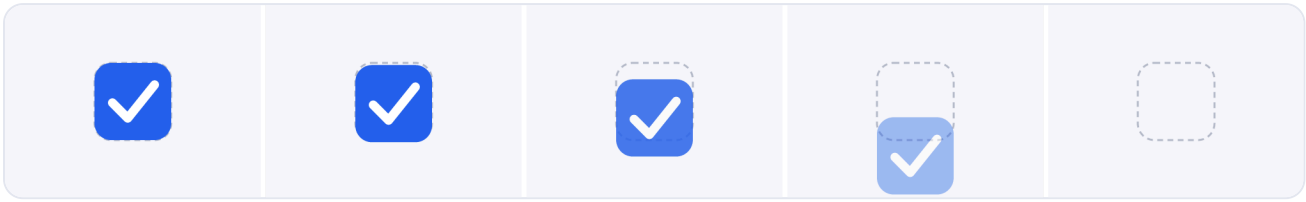



💡 Clears titles upwards, like credits rolling.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Slide Out ↓ Exit

Exits downwards. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.slide_down`

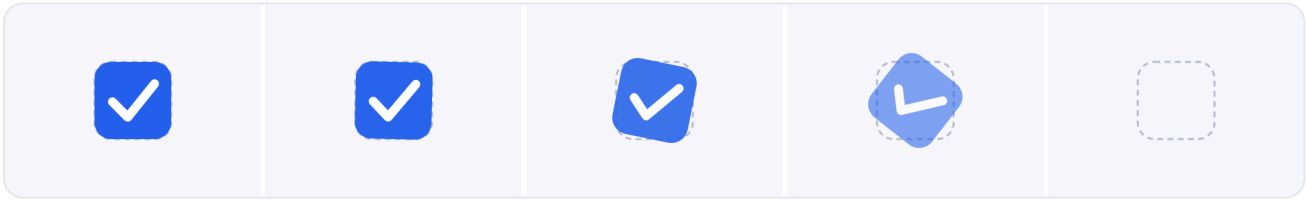



💡 Drops elements out of the frame; feels like letting go.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 200 px |
| With fade | Yes, No | Yes |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Rotate Out Exit

Rotates out while fading out. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.rotate_out`

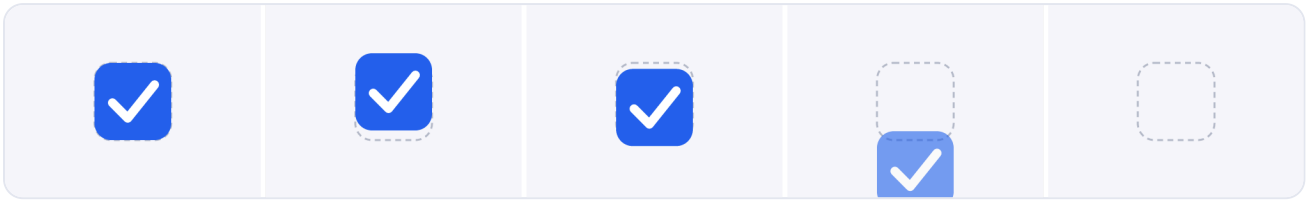



💡 The reverse of Rotate In.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | -720 – 720 ° | 90 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Bounce Out Exit

Hops up, then falls out. · Default length 0.9 s · `exit.bounce_out`

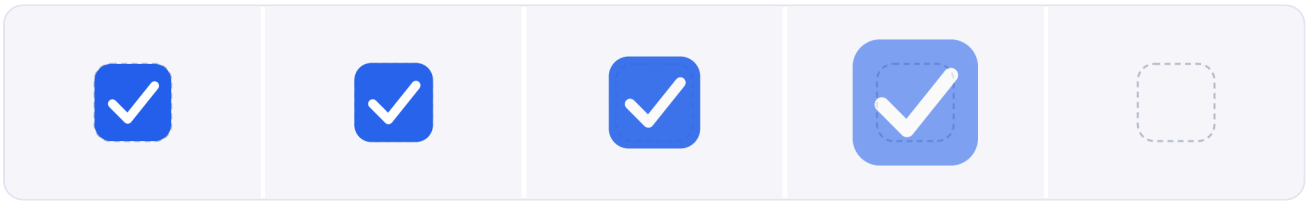



💡 A playful goodbye: a small hop, then a fall.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 400 px |

## Zoom Out Exit

Grows while fading out. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.zoom_out`

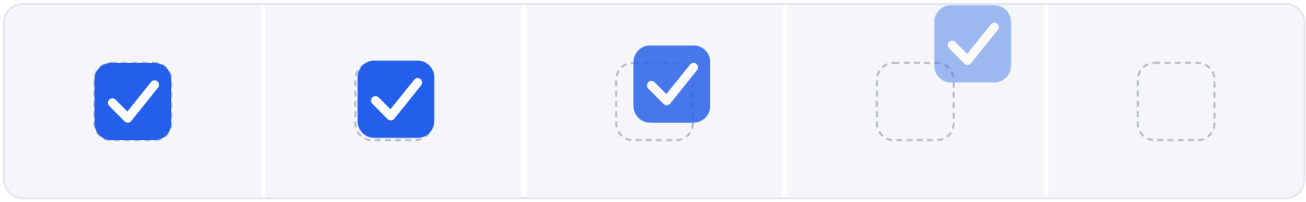



💡 Feels like the element flies towards the camera.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| End scale | 100 – 1000 % | 250 % |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Fly Out Exit

Flies out diagonally. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.fly_out`

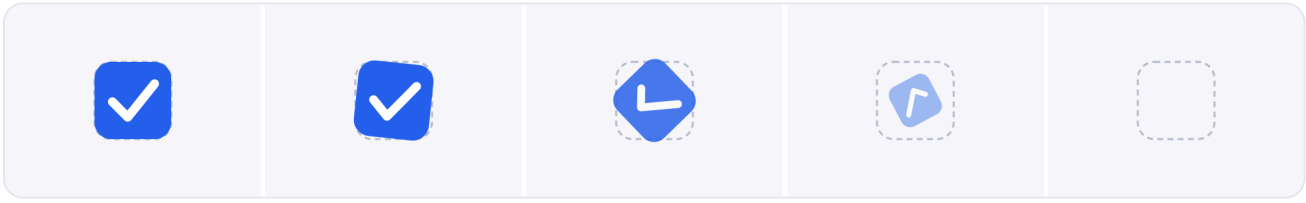



💡 Diagonal exit; choose the corner.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 300 px |
| To | Bottom left, Bottom right, Top left, Top right | Top right |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Spiral Out Exit

Spins while shrinking away. · Default length 0.9 s · `exit.spiral_out`

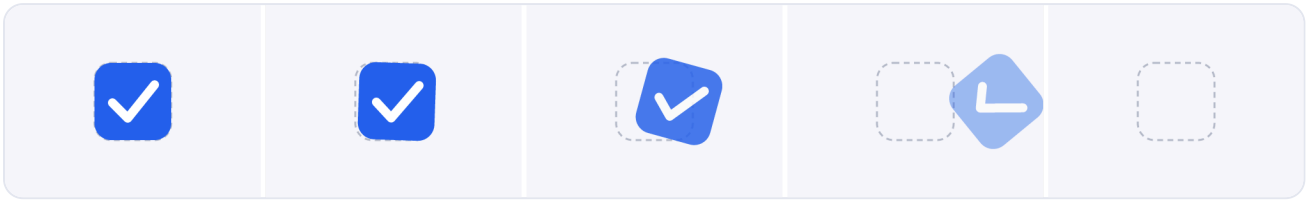



💡 The reverse of Spiral In: a whirl away.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | -1440 – 1440 ° | 360 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Roll Out Exit

Rolls out to the right. · Default length 0.9 s · `exit.roll_out`



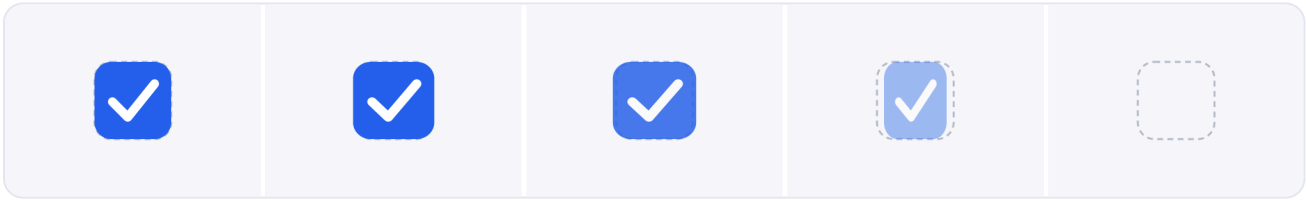
0.00 s | 0.23 s | 0.45 s | 0.68 s | 0.90 s

💡 Round objects rolling off to the right.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 4000 px | 300 px |
| Angle | 0 – 1440 ° | 120 ° |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Flip Out X Exit

Flips out around the vertical axis. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.flip_out_x`



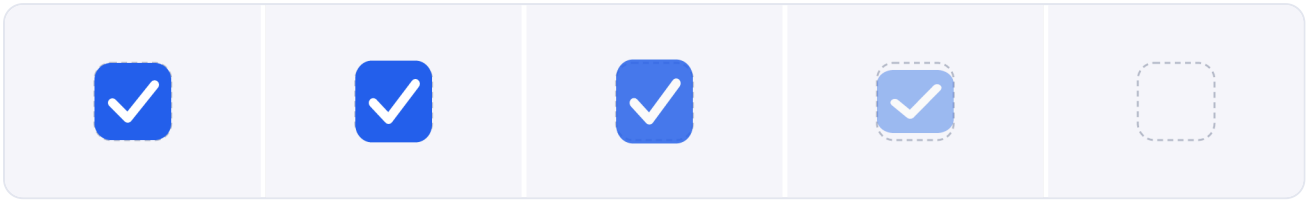
0.00 s | 0.15 s | 0.30 s | 0.45 s | 0.60 s

💡 Card flip away; pairs with Flip In X on the next card.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Back |

## Flip Out Y Exit

Flips out around the horizontal axis. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.flip_out_y`

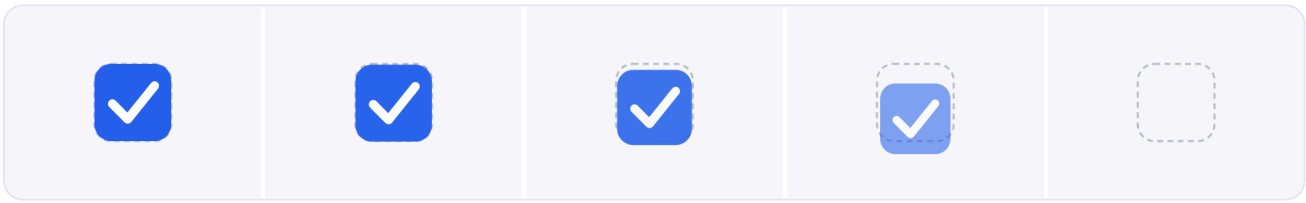



💡 Vertical flip away.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Back |

## Sink Exit

Sinks a little, shrinks and fades. · Default length 0.7 s · `exit.sink`

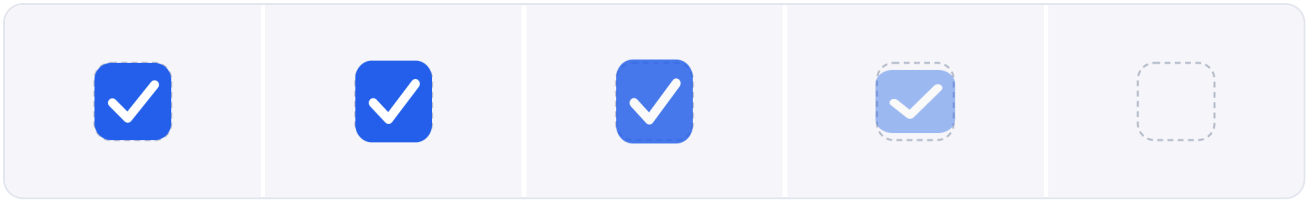



💡 A gentle, quiet exit for secondary elements.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 2000 px | 60 px |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Collapse Exit

Flattens to a line and disappears. · Default length 0.6 s · `exit.collapse`

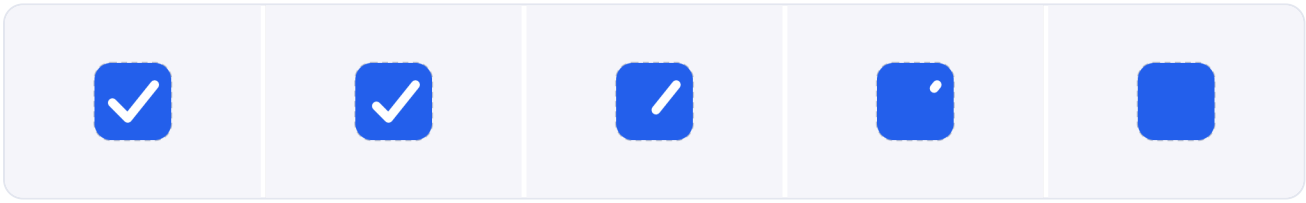



💡 Like a TV switching off: good for ends of scenes.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Back |

## Draw Off Exit

Strokes erase from the start of each path to its end (needs a stroke). · Default length 1 s · `exit.draw_off`




💡 Strokes erase themselves; the mirror of Draw On.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Blur Out Exit

Blurs away while fading out. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.blur_out`

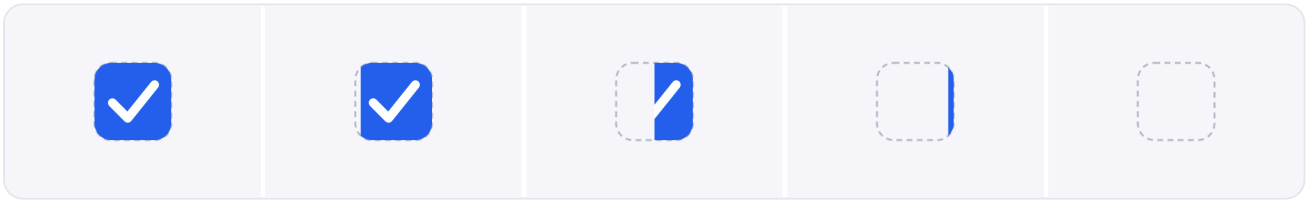



💡 Dreamy exit; video and SVG only (no blur in Lottie).

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Blur | 0 – 200 px | 24 px |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

## Wipe Out Exit

Wipes off towards one side. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.wipe`

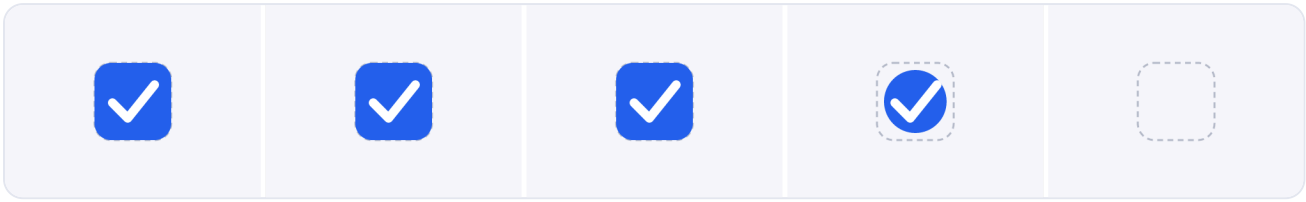



💡 Hides bars and panels towards a side.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| From | From the left, From the right, From the top, From the bottom | From the left |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Iris Out Exit

Closes to a circle in the middle. · Default length 0.8 s · `exit.iris`



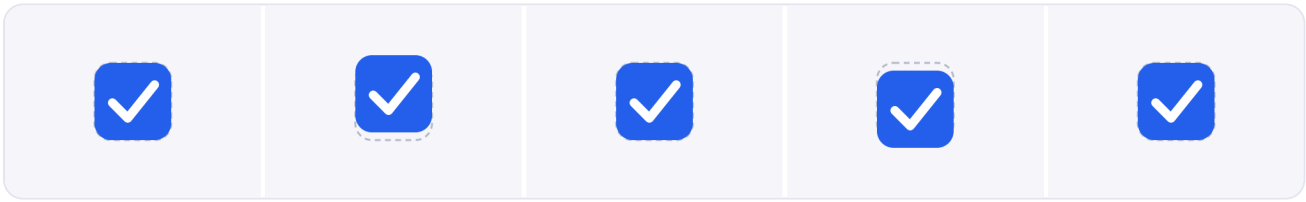

💡 Closes to a circle, like the classic cartoon ending.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In Cubic |

# Loop presets

## Float Loop

Floats up and down continuously. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.float`

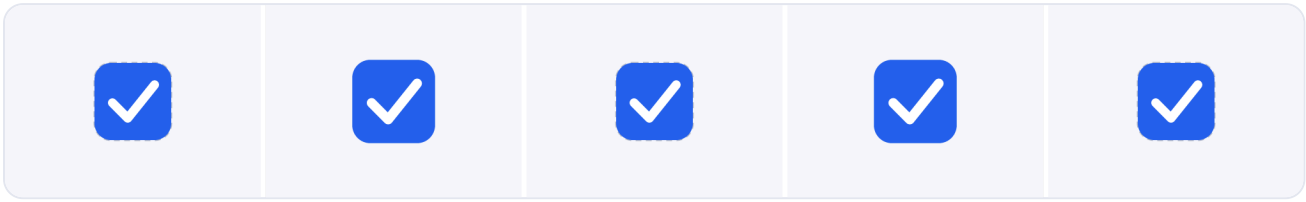



💡 Makes still elements feel alive. For seamless clips make the period divide the duration (2 s in a 10 s clip).

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 500 px | 12 px |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

## Pulse Loop

Grows and shrinks rhythmically. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.pulse`

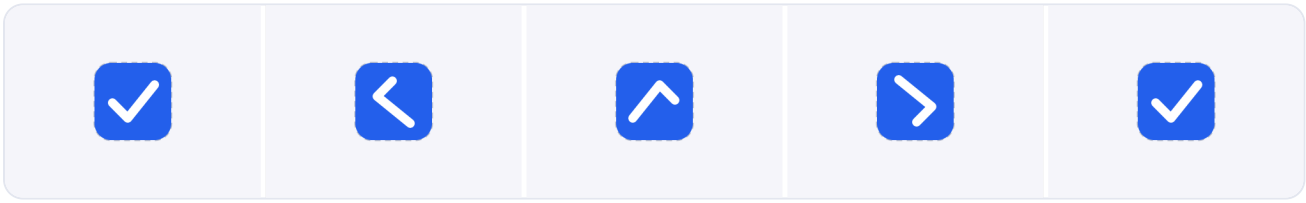



💡 Draws attention to a button or a dot. Small amounts (4–8 %) look premium.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 8 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 1 s |

## Spin Loop

Spins continuously. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.spin`

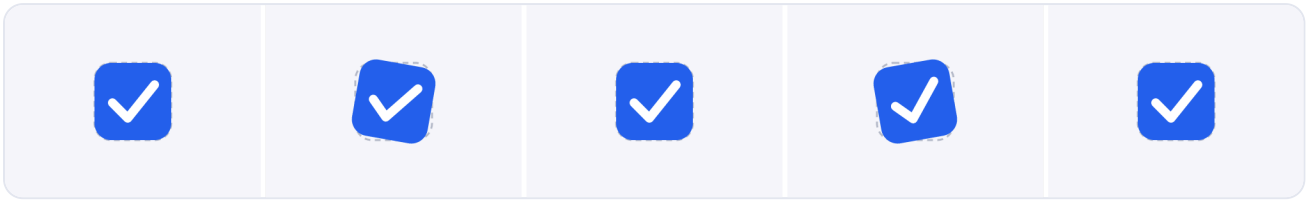



💡 Loaders, gears, suns. A symmetric shape loops seamlessly even when the period is longer than the clip.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Spin period | 0.1 – 60 s | 4 s |
| Direction | Clockwise, Counter-clockwise | Clockwise |

## Swing Loop

Swings like a pendulum (anchor = pivot). · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.swing`

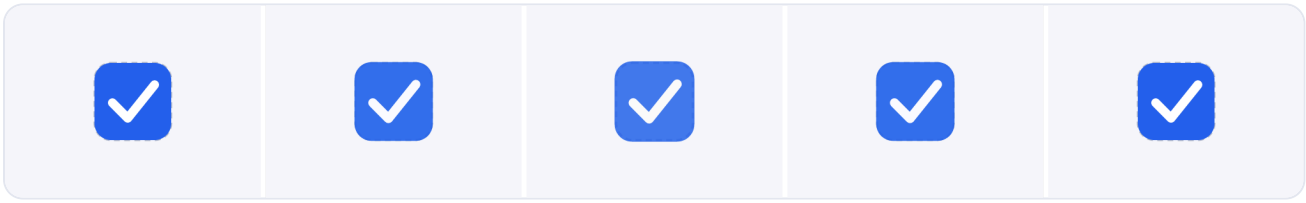



💡 Pendulums, hanging signs, leaves. Anchor = pivot.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | 0 – 180 ° | 10 ° |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

## Breathe Loop

Slowly grows and dims, like breathing. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.breathe`

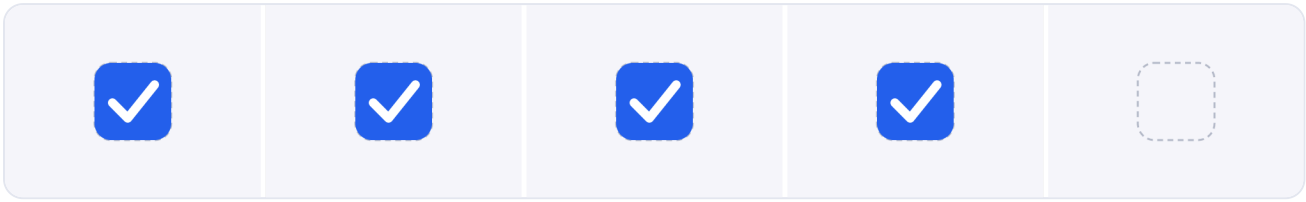



💡 Slow, calm motion for meditation, wellness and ambient backgrounds.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 4 % |
| Fade | 0 – 100 % | 15 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 3 s |

## Blink Loop

Blinks briefly at a regular interval. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.blink`

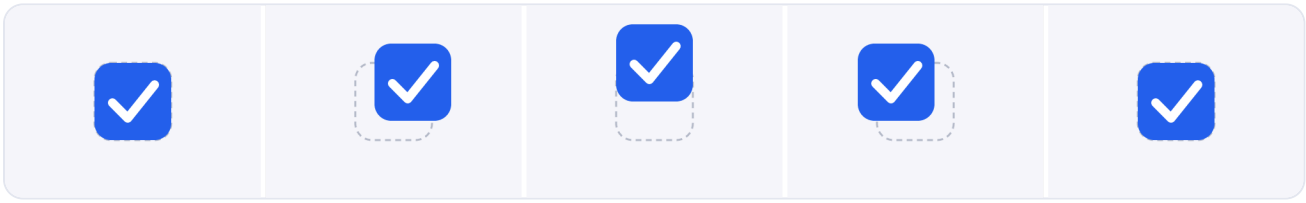



💡 Eyes, cursors and indicator lights.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 1 s |

## Orbit Loop

Moves in a circle, starting and ending at its own position. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.orbit`

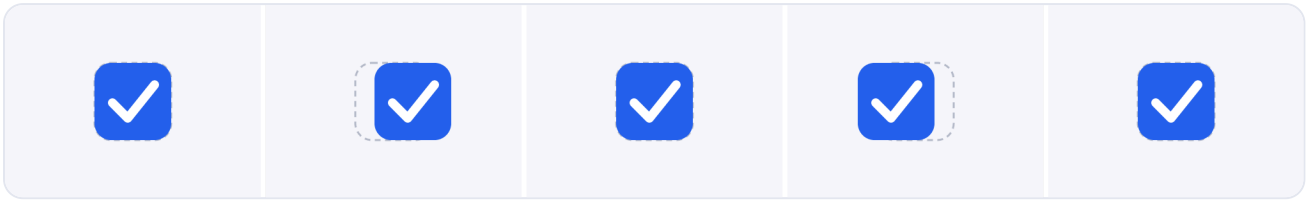



💡 Planets, particles, decorative dots circling their spot.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Radius | 0 – 2000 px | 30 px |
| Period | 0.1 – 60 s | 3 s |
| Direction | Clockwise, Counter-clockwise | Clockwise |

## Figure 8 Loop

Moves along a figure eight. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.figure8`

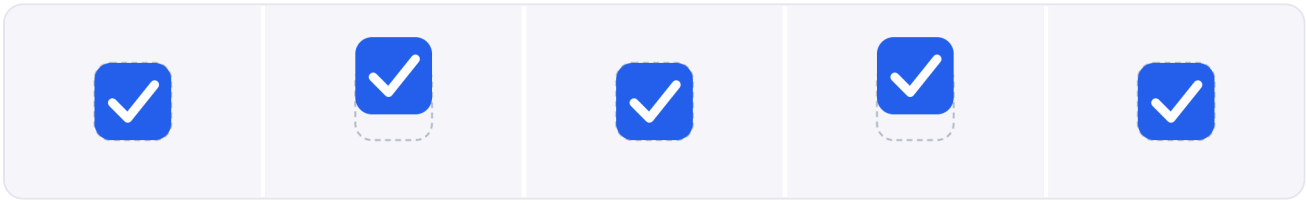



💡 An organic, wandering path for insects, sparks and floating particles.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 2000 px | 30 px |
| Period | 0.1 – 60 s | 4 s |

## Bounce Loop

Hops in place with squash and stretch. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.bounce`

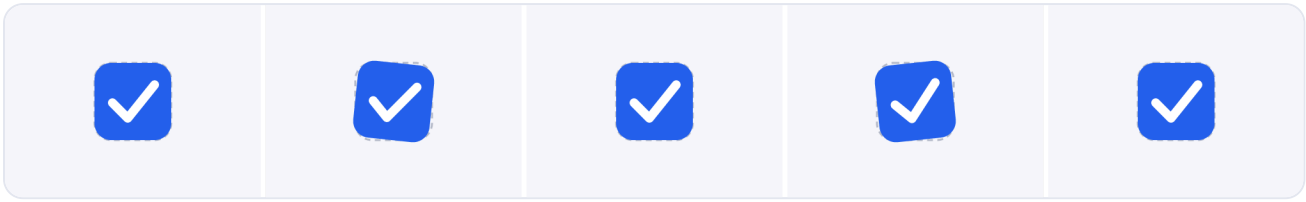



💡 A ball or character hopping in place. Anchor at the bottom for a nice squash.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Height | 0 – 2000 px | 40 px |
| Squash | 0 – 100 % | 15 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 1 s |

## Wobble Loop

Wobbles and stretches gently, continuously. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.wobble`

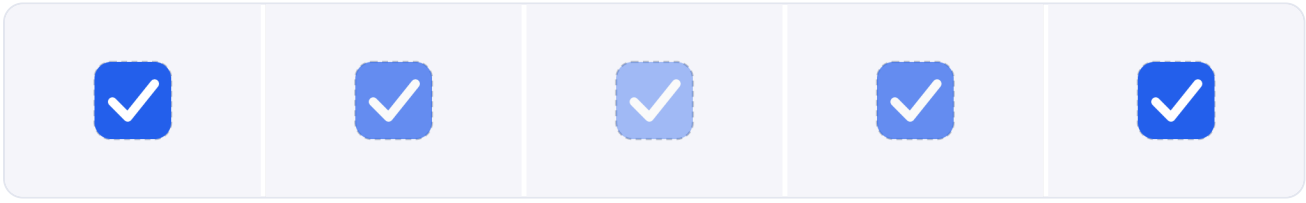



💡 Jelly-like idle motion for mascots and blobs.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | 0 – 90 ° | 6 ° |
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 5 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

## Glow Loop

Dims and brightens rhythmically. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.glow`

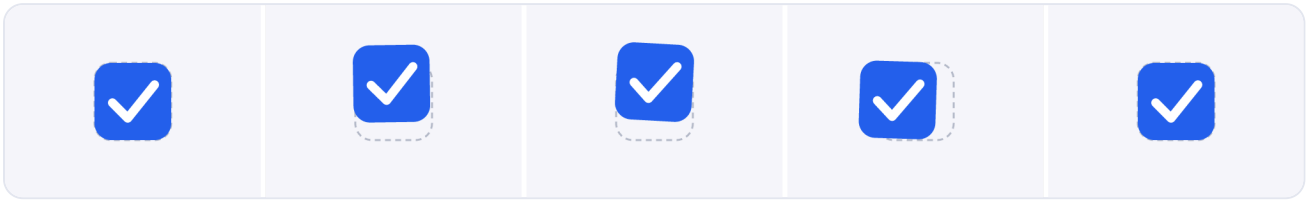



💡 Lights, stars, neon signs. Lower *min* for a stronger flicker.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Lowest opacity | 0 – 100 % | 40 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

## Drift Loop

Drifts slowly and irregularly, still seamless when looped. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.drift`

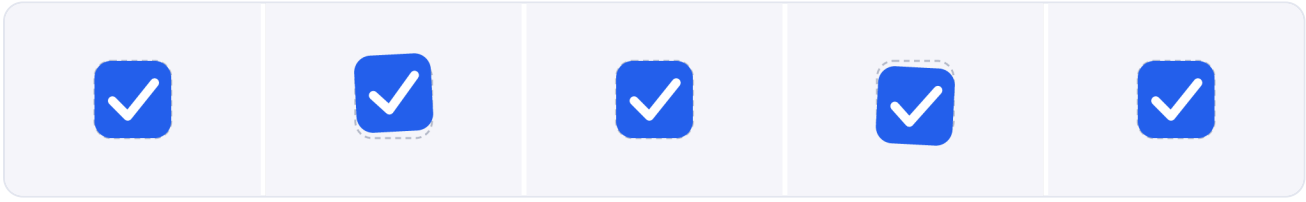



💡 Bubbles, dust, clouds. Give each item a different period for natural variety.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 2000 px | 20 px |
| Rotation | 0 – 90 ° | 3 ° |
| Period | 0.5 – 60 s | 6 s |

## Hover Loop

Hovers up and down with a slight tilt. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.hover`

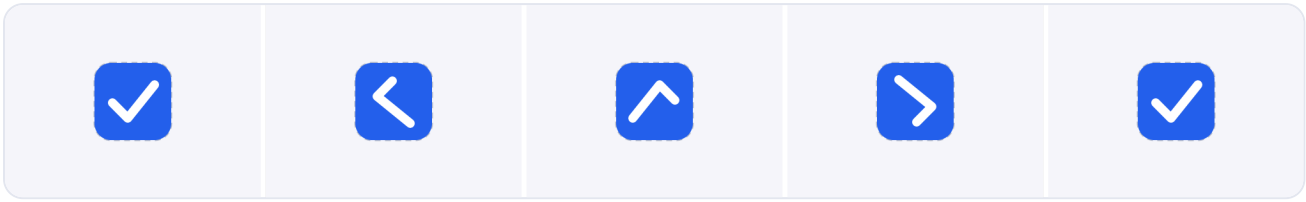



💡 Floating objects with a gentle tilt: drones, balloons, product shots.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 500 px | 10 px |
| Tilt | 0 – 45 ° | 3 ° |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 3 s |

## Tick Loop

Rotates in steps like a clock hand. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.tick`

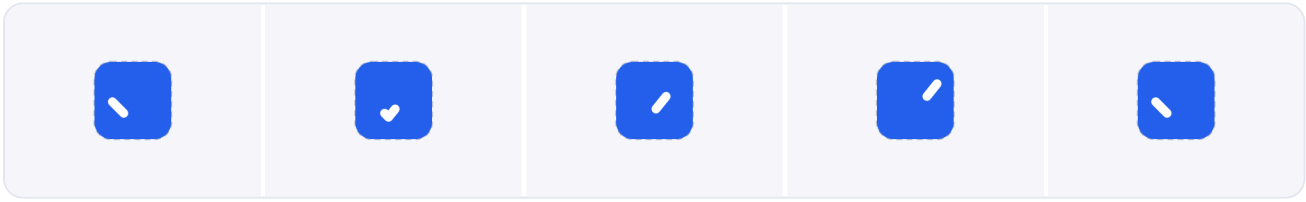



💡 Clock hands and step-by-step rotation. Set steps to 60 for a seconds hand.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Steps per turn | 2 – 120 | 12 |
| Spin period | 0.1 – 120 s | 12 s |

## Trace Loop

A segment of the stroke travels along each path continuously (needs a stroke). · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.trace`

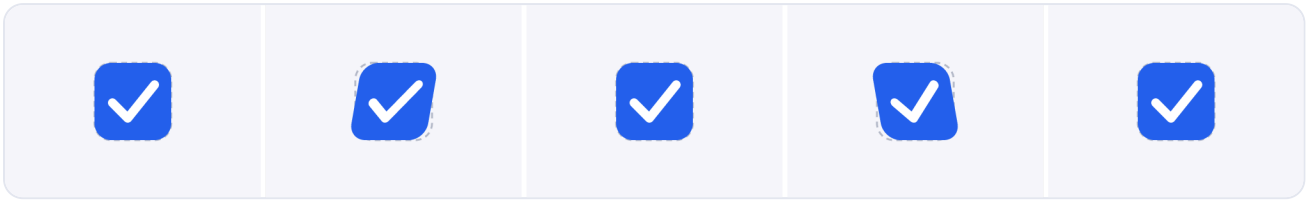



💡 A light running along a line: circuits, routes on a map, neon outlines.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Length | 1 – 99 % | 25 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 60 s | 2 s |

## Sway Loop

Sways from side to side like in the wind. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.sway`

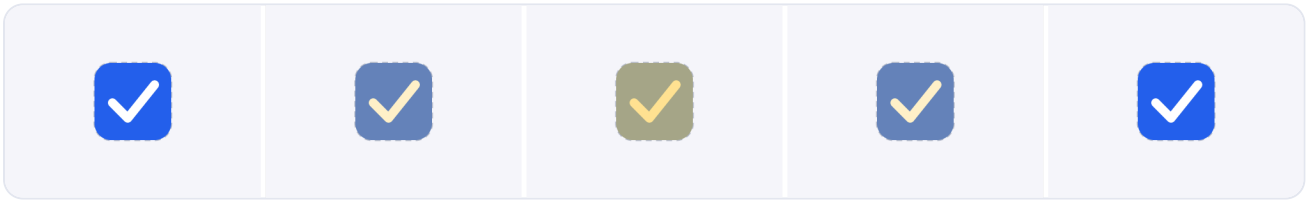



💡 Plants, grass, flags and waves moving in the wind.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Slant | 0 – 80 ° | 10 ° |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

## Tint Pulse Loop

A colour pulses in and out continuously. · Runs for the whole composition · `loop.tint_pulse`



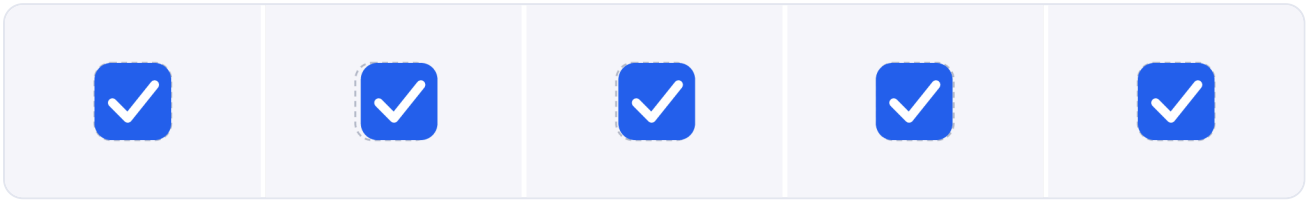

💡 Colour breathing: alerts, highlights, mood changes.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Colour | any colour | `#ffd54a` |
| Strength | 0 – 100 % | 60 % |
| Period | 0.1 – 30 s | 2 s |

# Emphasis presets

## Shake Emphasis

Shakes left and right, then settles. · Default length 0.6 s · `emphasis.shake`



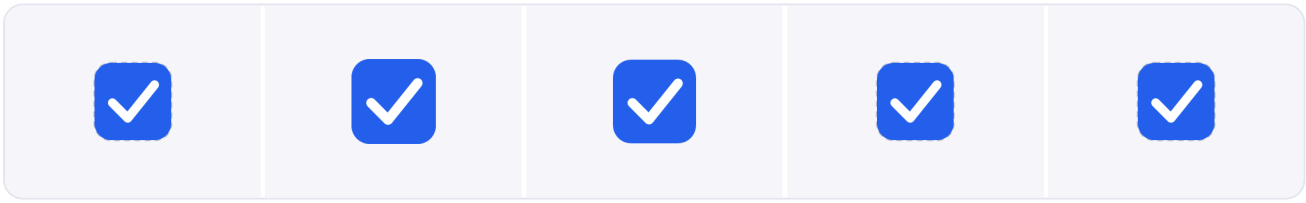
0.00 s 0.15 s 0.30 s 0.45 s 0.60 s

💡 Errors, wrong answers, impact moments.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 200 px | 12 px |
| Frequency | 1 – 30 Hz | 8 Hz |

## Heartbeat Emphasis

Two quick beats. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.heartbeat`



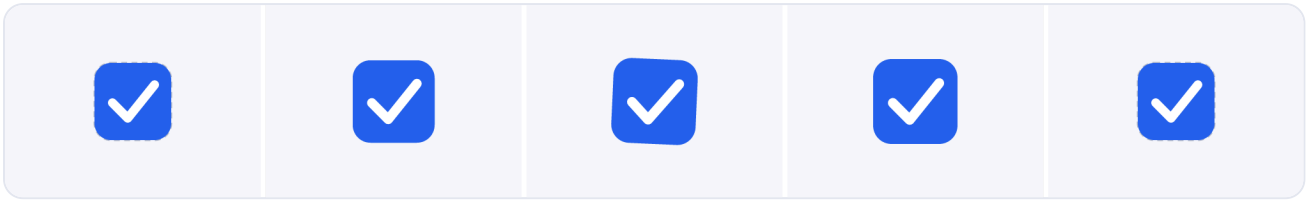
0.00 s 0.20 s 0.40 s 0.60 s 0.80 s

💡 Likes, love, health topics, “buy now” moments.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 12 % |

## Tada Emphasis

Shrinks, grows while wobbling, then settles. · Default length 1 s · `emphasis.tada`

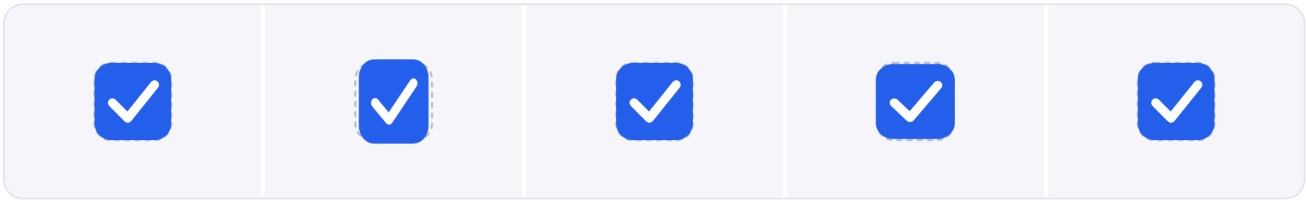



💡 Celebrations and achievements.

No parameters: only Start and Duration.

## Jello Emphasis

Wobbles like jelly. · Default length 0.9 s · `emphasis.jello`

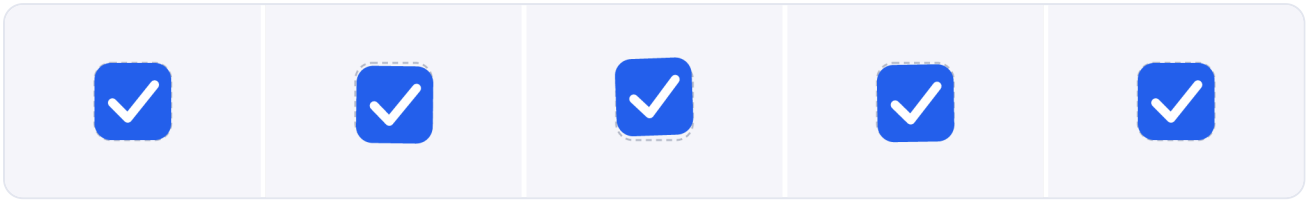



💡 Playful attention grabber for mascots and buttons.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 12 % |

## Wiggle Emphasis

Smooth random motion (seeded, identical on every render). · Default length 2 s · `emphasis.wiggle`

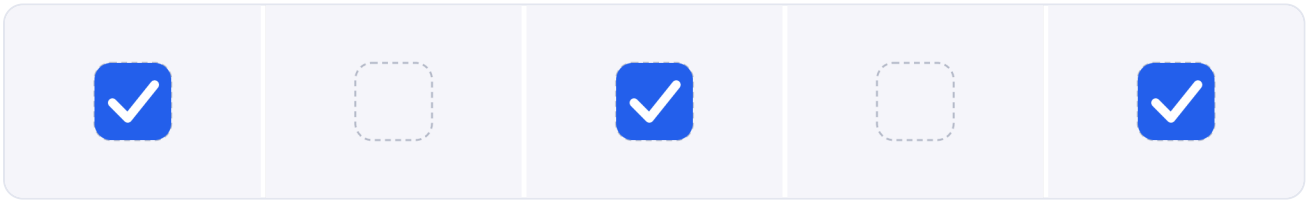



💡 Hand-made, nervous or electric motion. Change the seed for a different pattern.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 500 px | 10 px |
| Rotation | 0 – 180 ° | 3 ° |
| Frequency | 0.1 – 30 Hz | 4 Hz |
| Seed | 0 – 9999 | 1 |

## Flash Emphasis

Flashes a few times. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.flash`

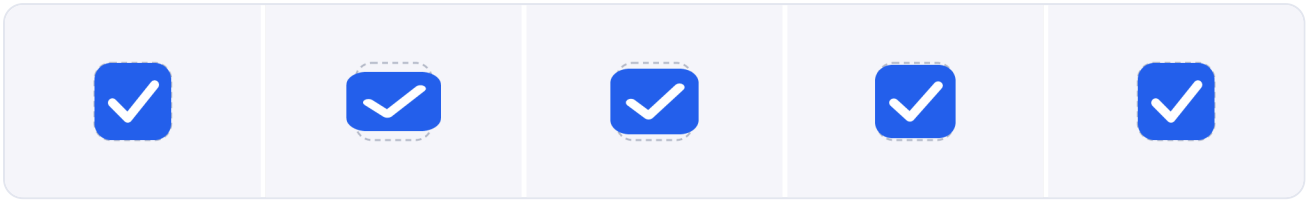



💡 Blinks a few times: notifications, “new”, alerts.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Count | 1 – 10 × | 2 × |

## Rubber Band Emphasis

Stretches and snaps back like rubber. · Default length 1 s · `emphasis.rubber_band`

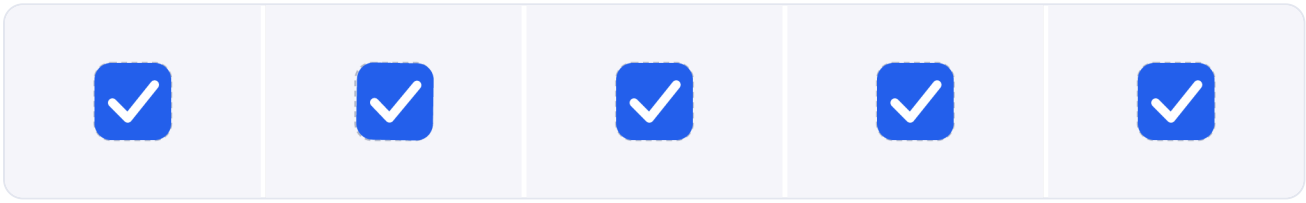



💡 Stretchy squish for cartoon buttons and icons.

No parameters: only Start and Duration.

## Head Shake Emphasis

Shakes its head, like saying no. · Default length 1 s · `emphasis.head_shake`

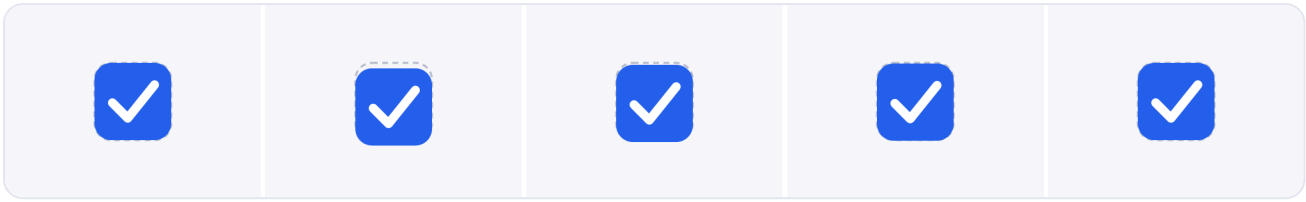



💡 Saying “no”: wrong answers, rejected actions.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amplitude | 0 – 200 px | 12 px |

## Nod Emphasis

Nods twice. · Default length 0.9 s · `emphasis.nod`

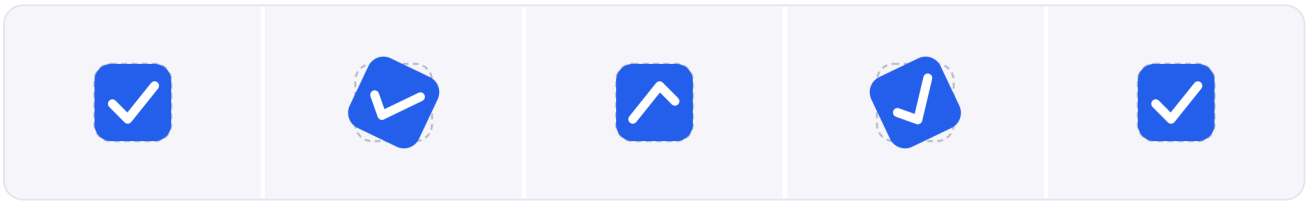



💡 Saying “yes”: confirmations and agreement.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 200 px | 10 px |

## Spin Emphasis

Spins full turns, then stops. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.spin`

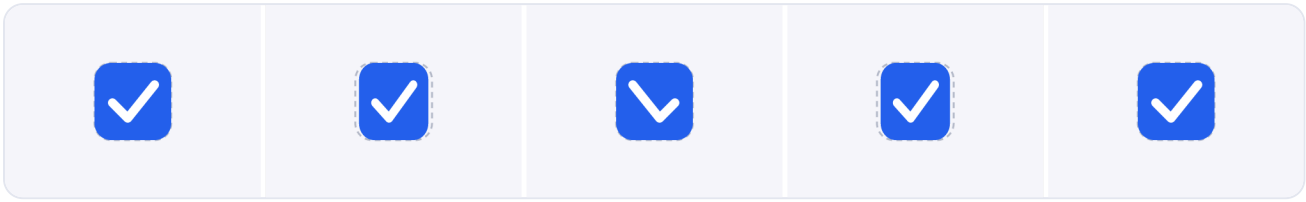



💡 A full turn to celebrate or to switch state (refresh icons).

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Turns | 1 – 10 × | 1 × |
| Direction | Clockwise, Counter-clockwise | Clockwise |
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Flip Emphasis

Flips over horizontally once. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.flip`

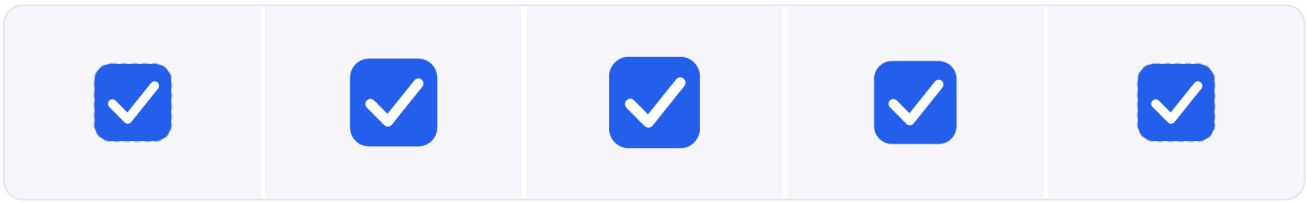



💡 Turn a card or coin over once.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Easing | any easing curve (see Easing reference) | Ease In-Out Cubic |

## Pop Emphasis

Grows for a moment, then returns. · Default length 0.4 s · `emphasis.pop`

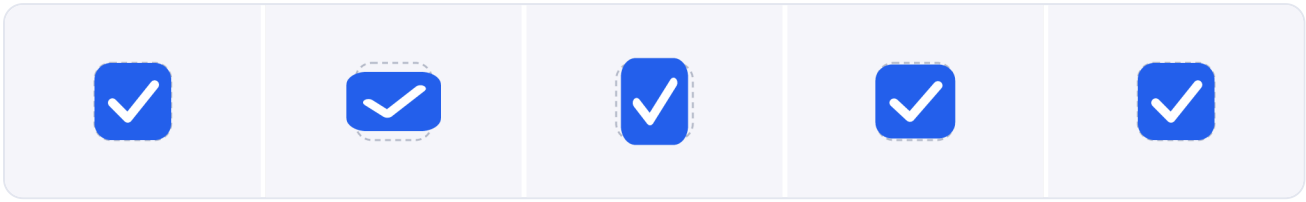



💡 A quick “look here” for logos and prices. Used at 3 s on the logo sample.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amount | 0 – 200 % | 20 % |

## Squash Emphasis

Squashes, then springs back. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.squash`

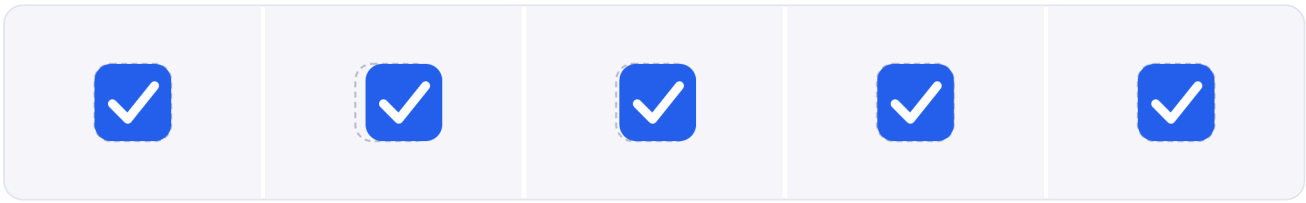



💡 Landing impact after a Drop or Bounce In. Anchor at the bottom.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Amount | 0 – 100 % | 25 % |

## Nudge Emphasis

Nudges aside, then returns. · Default length 0.6 s · `emphasis.nudge`

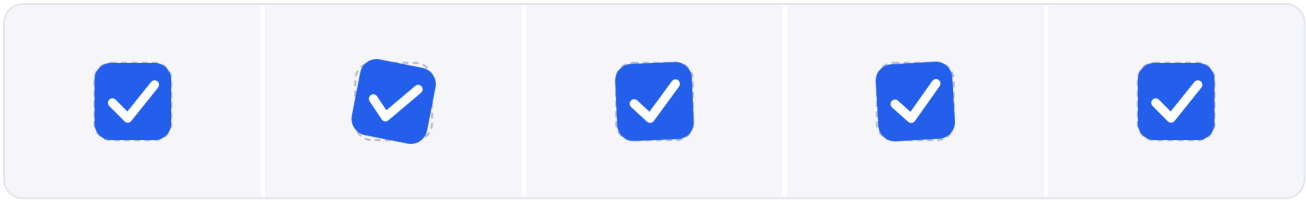



💡 A small push to suggest direction: arrows, “swipe” hints.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Distance | 0 – 500 px | 20 px |
| Direction | Right, Left, Up, Down | Right |

## Swing Emphasis

Swings a few times, then rests (anchor = pivot). · Default length 1 s · `emphasis.swing`



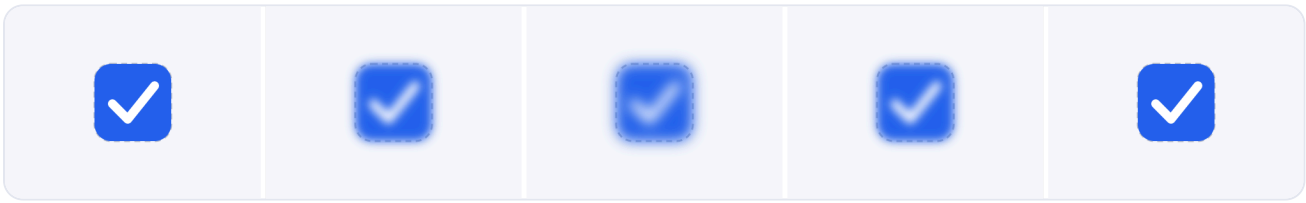
0.00 s | 0.25 s | 0.50 s | 0.75 s | 1.00 s

💡 A sign swinging after being hit; anchor = pivot.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Angle | 0 – 90 ° | 15 ° |

## Focus Pulse Emphasis

Blurs for a moment, then sharpens again. · Default length 0.8 s · `emphasis.focus`



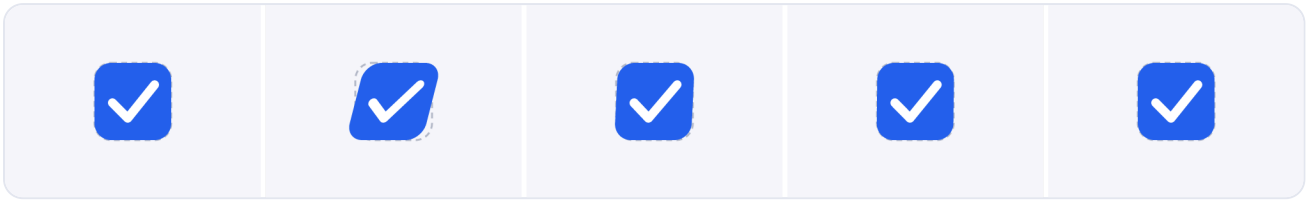
0.00 s | 0.20 s | 0.40 s | 0.60 s | 0.80 s

💡 Briefly out of focus, then sharp: rack-focus feel.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Blur | 0 – 200 px | 10 px |

## Lean Emphasis

Leans to one side, then springs back. · Default length 0.9 s · `emphasis.lean`



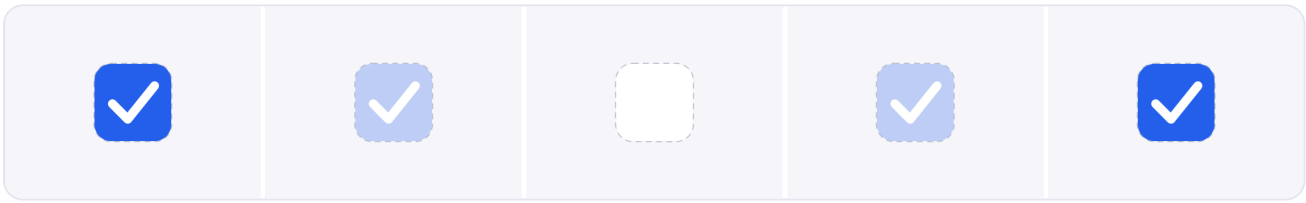
0.00 s | 0.23 s | 0.45 s | 0.68 s | 0.90 s

💡 Leans and springs back: excitement, a gust of wind.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Slant | -80 – 80 ° | 18 ° |

## Color Flash Emphasis

Flashes a colour for a moment, then returns. · Default length 0.6 s · `emphasis.color_flash`



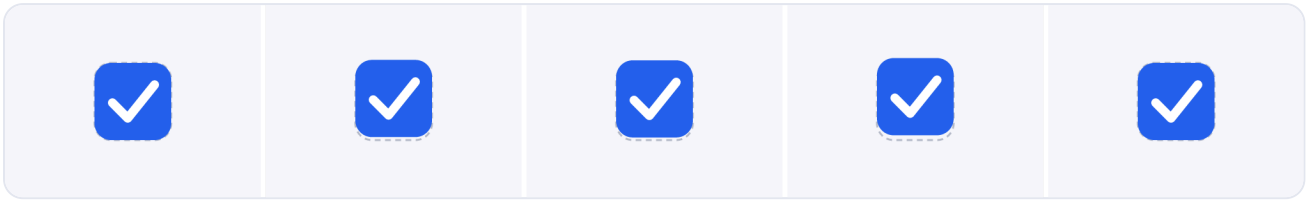
0.00 s | 0.15 s | 0.30 s | 0.45 s | 0.60 s

💡 Flashes a colour: hits, highlights, “on sale” moments.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
|---|---|---|
| Colour | any colour | ☐ `#ffffff` |
| Strength | 0 – 100 % | 100 % |

## Jump Emphasis

Jumps twice, the second one lower. · Default length 1 s · `emphasis.jump`

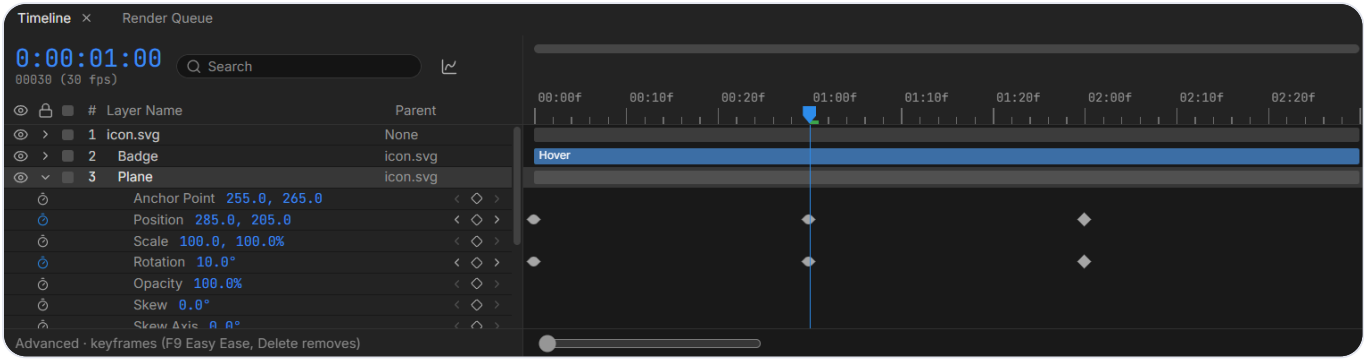



💡 A happy double jump for characters and icons.

| PARAMETER | RANGE / OPTIONS | DEFAULT |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Height | 0 – 2000 px | 30 px |

# 13 Keyframes and easing

Full control: set values at moments in time and Motionator fills in the frames between.




The Advanced timeline: Plane twirled open, Position and Rotation have keyframes (diamonds).

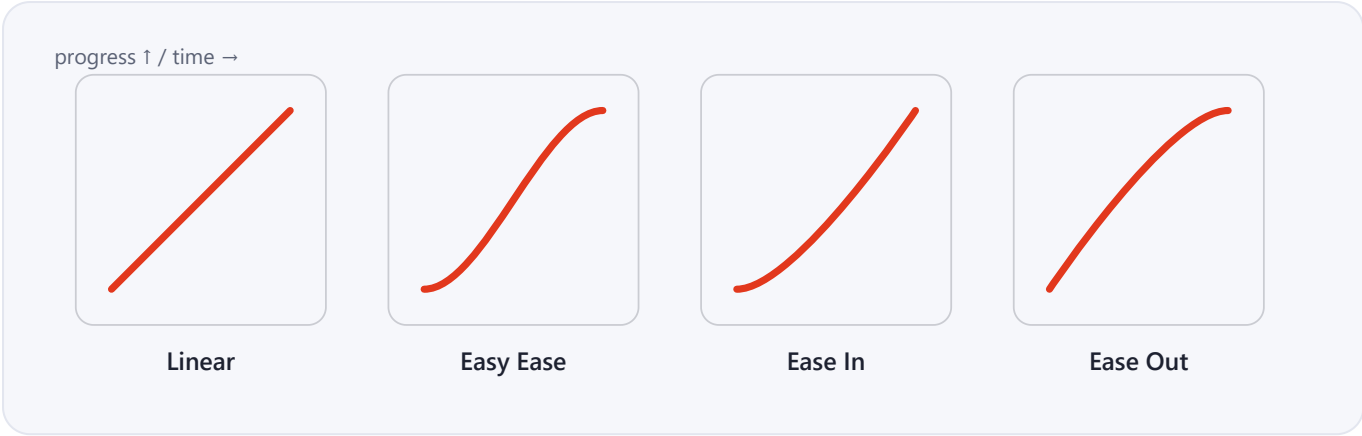
## Making keyframes

1. Switch to the **Advanced** workspace `Shift` + `F11` and twirl a layer open with its arrow.
2. Click the **stopwatch** next to a property (here or in the Properties panel). A keyframe is made at the playhead with the current value.
3. Move the playhead and change the value, by dragging the number, typing, or moving the layer on the canvas. A new keyframe is added automatically.
4. Use the ◇ button to add or remove a keyframe at the playhead, and ‹ › to jump between keyframes ( `J` / `K` ).

- **Select** keyframes by clicking; `Shift`-click to select several.
- **Move** them by dragging; `Delete` removes them.
- Clicking the stopwatch again removes all keyframes of that property.
- `U` shows only the properties that are animated.

## Easing

Easing controls how a value speeds up and slows down between keyframes. Select keyframes and press:



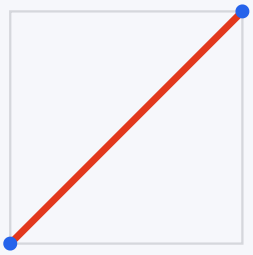

| EASING | KEY | FEELS LIKE |
|---|---|---|
| Linear | | Constant speed, mechanical. |
| Easy Ease | `F9` | Slows into and out of the keyframe: natural motion. |
| Easy Ease In | `Shift` + `F9` | Arrives gently (slows down into the keyframe). |
| Easy Ease Out | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `F9` | Leaves gently (speeds up out of the keyframe). |

For finer control, shape the curve in the Graph Editor.

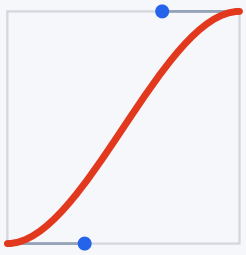
# 14 Easing reference

The 22 named curves you can pick for a preset's Easing parameter.

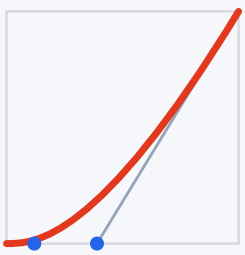
Each curve shows progress (up) over time (right). The blue dots are the bezier handles; the numbers are the CSS `cubic-bezier()` values, so you can reuse them in web projects. Curves that go above the box overshoot (Back) and give a springy feel.



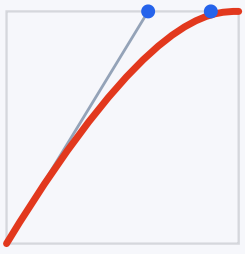
**Linear**
`0, 0, 1, 1`



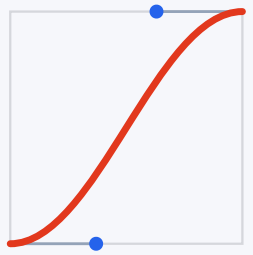
**Easy Ease**
`0.333, 0, 0.667, 1`



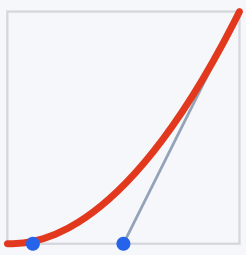
**Ease In Sine**
`0.12, 0, 0.39, 0`



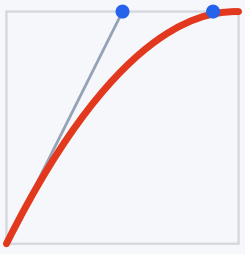
**Ease Out Sine**
`0.61, 1, 0.88, 1`



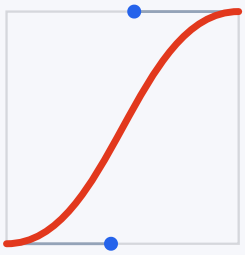
**Ease In-Out Sine**
`0.37, 0, 0.63, 1`



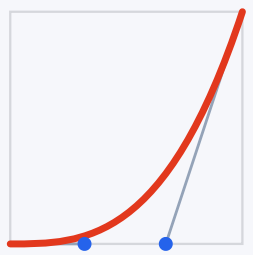
**Ease In Quad**
`0.11, 0, 0.5, 0`



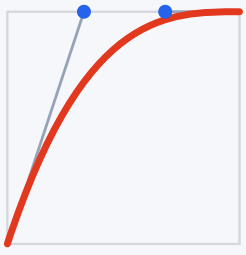
**Ease Out Quad**
`0.5, 1, 0.89, 1`



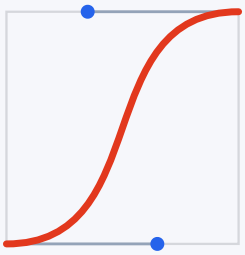
**Ease In-Out Quad**
`0.45, 0, 0.55, 1`



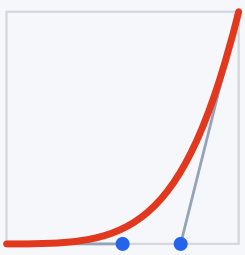
**Ease In Cubic**
`0.32, 0, 0.67, 0`



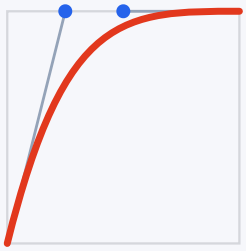
**Ease Out Cubic**
`0.33, 1, 0.68, 1`



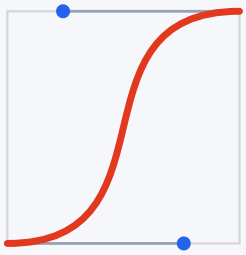
**Ease In-Out Cubic**
`0.65, 0, 0.35, 1`



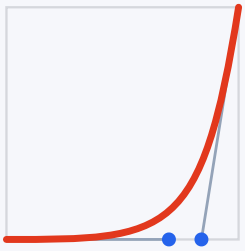
**Ease In Quart**
`0.5, 0, 0.75, 0`



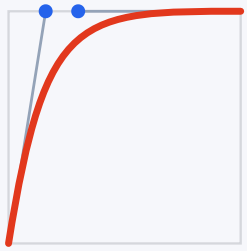
**Ease Out Quart**
`0.25, 1, 0.5, 1`



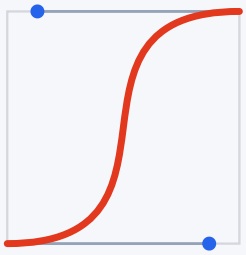
**Ease In-Out Quart**
`0.76, 0, 0.24, 1`



**Ease In Expo**
`0.7, 0, 0.84, 0`



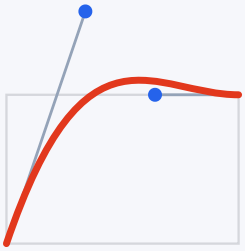
**Ease Out Expo**
`0.16, 1, 0.3, 1`



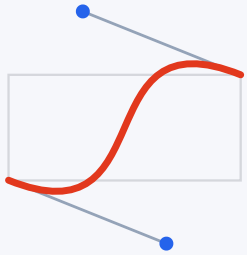
**Ease In-Out Expo**
`0.87, 0, 0.13, 1`



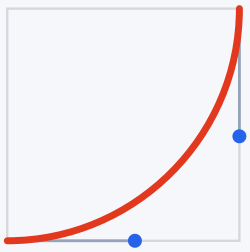
**Ease In Back**
`0.36, 0, 0.66, -0.56`



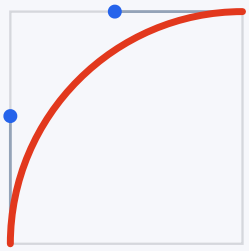
**Ease Out Back**
`0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1`



**Ease In-Out Back**
`0.68, -0.6, 0.32, 1.6`



**Ease In Circ**
`0.55, 0, 1, 0.45`



**Ease Out Circ**
`0, 0.55, 0.45, 1`

## Choosing an easing

| FAMILY | CHARACTER | USE FOR |
|---|---|---|
| Sine | Very gentle | Slow ambient loops, backgrounds |
| Quad / Cubic | Natural, balanced | Most UI and text motion (Cubic is the default of many presets) |
| Quart / Expo | Snappy, decisive | Fast reveals, modern tech look |
| Circ | Sudden start or stop | Mechanical, physical motion |

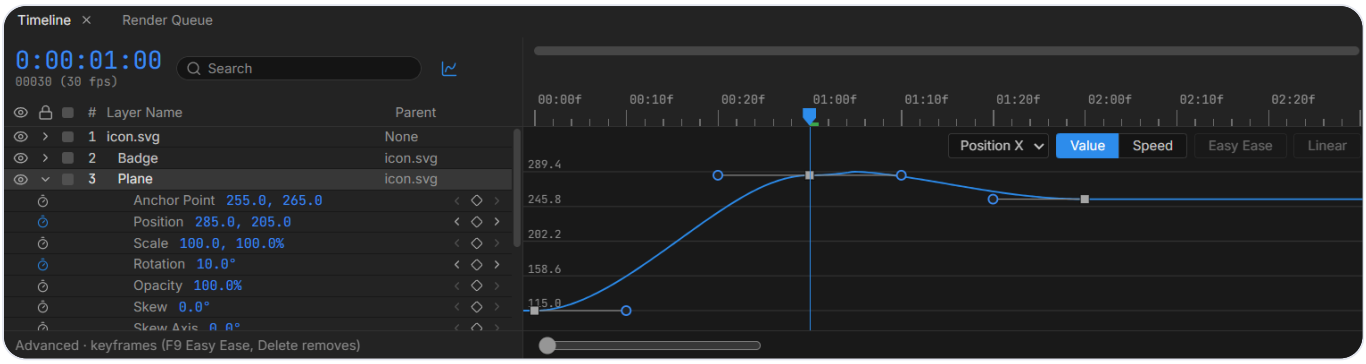
| FAMILY | CHARACTER | USE FOR |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Back | Overshoots and settles | Pops, icons, playful entrances |

- **Ease Out** curves (fast start, slow end) for things *entering*: they arrive and settle.
- **Ease In** curves (slow start, fast end) for things *leaving*: they gather speed and go.
- **Ease In-Out** for things moving from one place to another on screen.
- **Linear** only for constant motion: spinning loaders, scrolling tickers, Trace.

# 15 Graph Editor

See and shape the timing of keyframes as curves.

Open it with `Shift` + `F3` or the graph button at the top of the timeline (Advanced workspace). Choose the property in the drop-down; only properties with keyframes are listed.

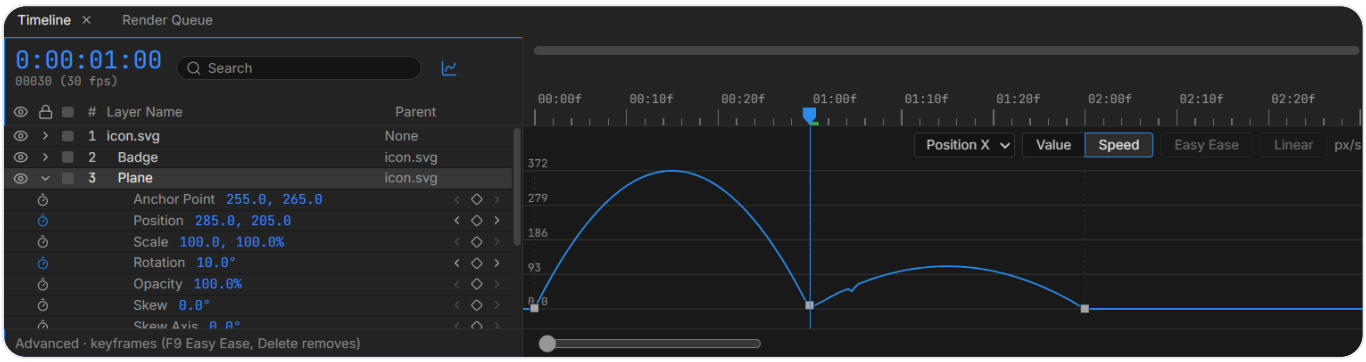



Value graph: the value of Position X over time, with keys and easing handles.

## Value graph

- Drag a **key** (square) up or down to change its value, left or right to change its time.
- Drag the round **handles** to shape the easing: long, flat handles give a soft ease; short ones a sharp change.
- **Easy Ease** and **Linear** buttons set the selected segments.

## Speed graph

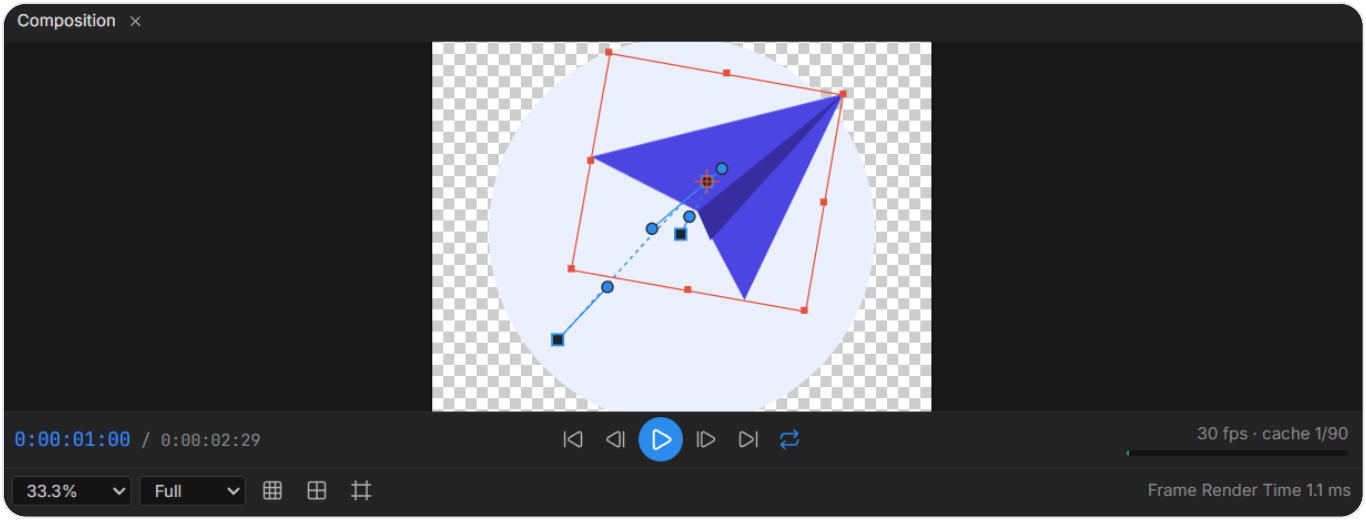



Speed graph of the plane: it speeds up and slows down between keys. For Position, it is the speed along the motion path.

The speed graph shows how fast the value changes (units per second). It is for reading: a smooth hill means a natural ease, a sharp corner means a jolt. Edit easing in the value graph and watch the result here.

# 16 Motion paths

Position keyframes form a path you can see and curve on the canvas.




The plane's motion path: squares are keyframes, circles are the curve handles.

- When Position has two or more keyframes, the selected layer shows its path on the canvas.
- Drag a **keyframe square** to move that position.
- Drag a **handle** to bend the path into a curve. Handles on both sides stay in line for a smooth curve.
- With the **Pen** tool `G`, click a keyframe to switch between a smooth curve and a sharp corner.
- Hold `Alt` while dragging a handle to break the pair and make a sharp turn.

> **TIP**
> Motion paths are exported to Lottie as real curves, so the web version moves exactly like the video.

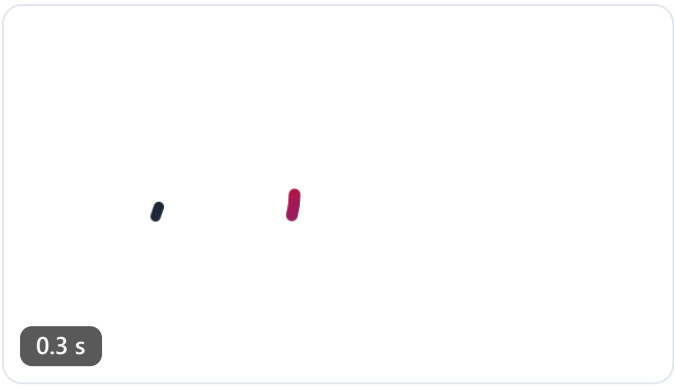
# 17 Trim Paths: drawing lines on

Show only part of each stroke to draw logos and line art on.




| PROPERTY | MEANING |
|---|---|
| Start | Where the visible part begins, 0–100 % of the path length. |
| End | Where it ends. Animate End from 0 % to 100 % to draw the line on. |
| Offset | Shifts both along the path in degrees (360° = once around). Animate it to make a segment travel. |

Trim Paths applies to every stroked path inside the layer, each path trimmed on its own. The easiest way is the *Draw On*, *Draw From Centre*, *Draw Off* and *Trace* presets; for full control, keyframe Start, End and Offset.




The ring and the wave of the logo sample are drawn on with Draw On.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Trim Paths only affects strokes. Filled shapes are not affected; reveal those with Wipe In or Iris In instead.

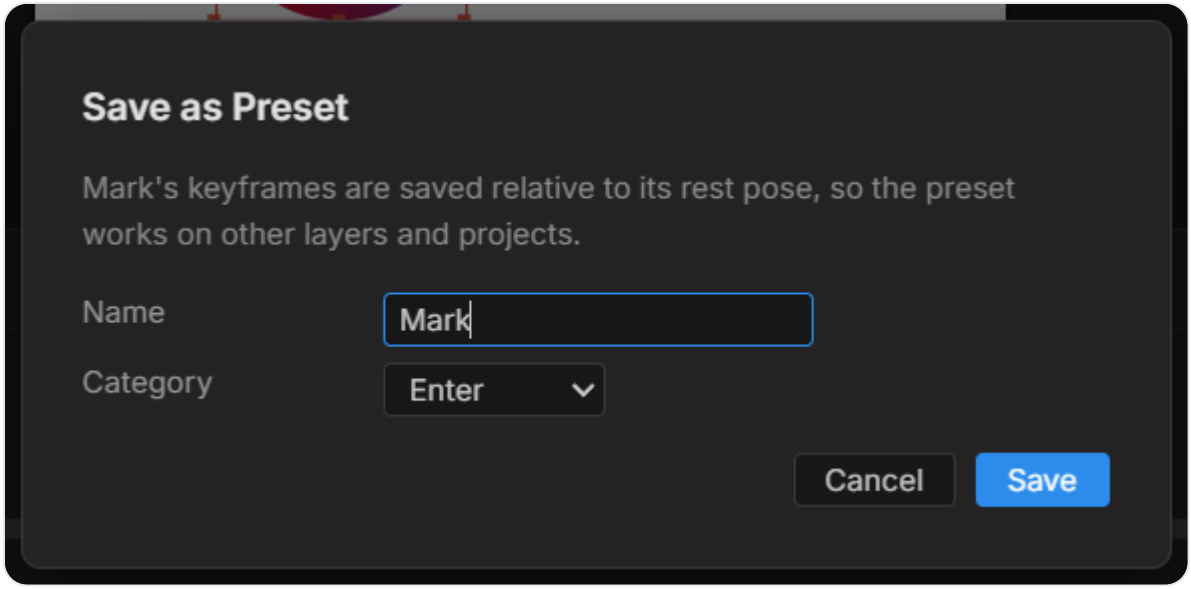
# 18 Effects and what each export supports

Every layer has Skew, Blur, Tint, Reveal and Glow in the Properties panel, each with its own stopwatch. Not every web format can show every effect, so plan with this table if you export to Lottie or SVG:

| FEATURE | VIDEO | LOTTIE | ANIMATED SVG |
|---|---|---|---|
| Transform, opacity, skew | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Curved motion paths | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Trim Paths | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Blur | ✓ | ✗ | ~ CSS blur (may differ slightly per browser) |
| Tint | ✓ | ✓ | ✗ |
| Reveal / wipe | ✓ | ~ as a mask (not on the root SVG layer) | ✗ |
| Clip paths from the SVG | ✓ | ~ outer clip only when nested | ✓ |
| SVG filters, patterns, blend modes | ✓ | ✗ | ✓ |
| Brush reveal | ✓ | ~ as a wipe from the left | ✗ |
| Glow | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ |
| 2.5D presets (Coin Spin, Card Flip, Peel) | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Generator layers | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Text layers | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Audio | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ |

> **NOTE**
>
> Each export shows a compatibility report listing exactly what was simplified or left out, so nothing is lost silently.

# 19 Saving your own presets



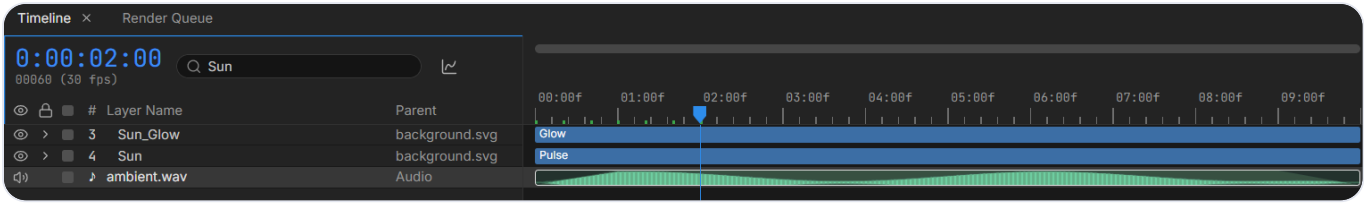

Save as Preset: keyframes are stored relative to the rest pose.

1. Animate a layer with keyframes until you like the motion.
2. Choose **Animation ▸ Save as Preset...**, give it a name and a category (Enter, Exit, Loop or Emphasis).
3. It appears under **My Presets** in the Presets panel, in every project. Apply it like any other preset.

Keyframes are saved as changes from the layer's rest pose (e.g. “move 200 px left and fade in”), so the preset works on other layers wherever they are. A project that uses your preset keeps its own copy, so it still opens on another computer. Delete a preset with the trash icon in My Presets.

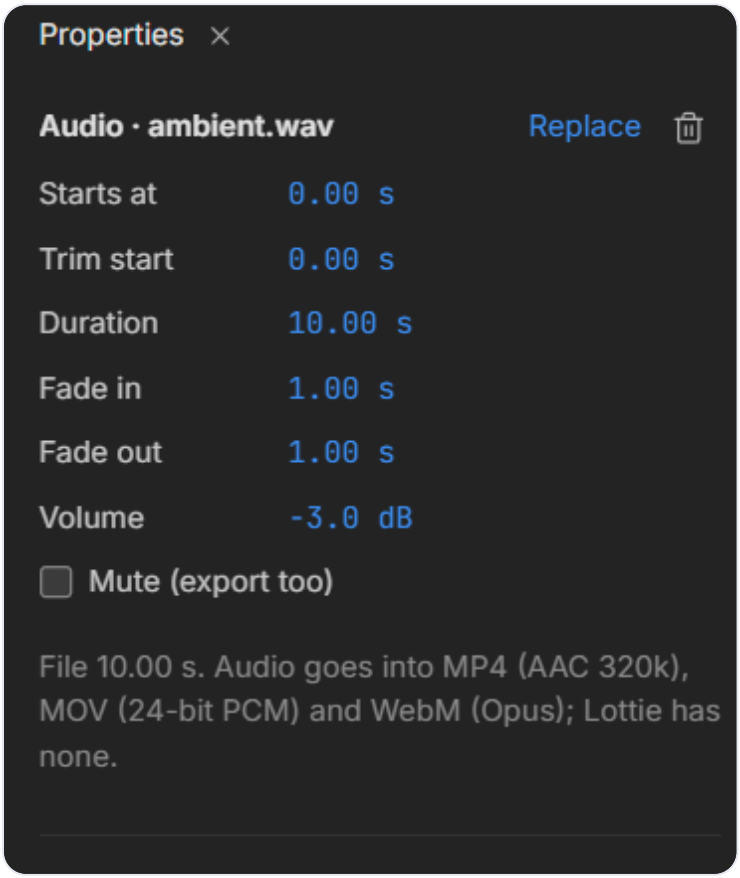
# 20 Audio

One soundtrack per project, with a waveform for timing.




The audio track at the bottom of the timeline, with its waveform and fades.

1. Choose **File** ▸ **Import Audio...** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `I` or drag an audio file onto the window (WAV, MP3, AAC/M4A, FLAC, OGG).
2. The track appears at the bottom of the timeline. Drag it to move it in time; drag its edges to trim it.
3. Click the track to edit it in the Properties panel.




Audio properties.

| SETTING | MEANING |
| --- | --- |
| Starts at | Where the sound starts in the composition. |
| Trim start | Skips the beginning of the file. |
| Duration | How long it plays. |
| Fade in / Fade out | Smooth volume ramps at both ends (seconds). |
| Volume | Gain in dB (0 dB = original). |
| Mute | Silences the track, in preview and export. |

Audio plays along with the preview and is mixed into MP4 (AAC 320 kbps), MOV (24-bit PCM) and WebM (Opus). Lottie and animated SVG have no sound. **Replace** swaps the file and keeps the timing; the trash icon removes the track.

> **TIP**
> The audio file is not stored inside the project. Keep it next to the `.motionator` file; if it is moved, the track shows *File missing* and **Replace** lets you find it again.

# 21 Text layers and per-letter animation

Type text in Motionator and animate it letter by letter.




Drop Bounce on each letter with a 0.08 s stagger: the letters fall, squash on landing and settle.

Text inside an imported SVG is not drawn (it must be outlined first). For titles, captions and animated words, make the text in Motionator instead: it is laid out with any font installed on your computer, with proper kerning, and every letter becomes its own layer.

## Adding text

1. Choose **Layer** ▸ **New Text** or press `Ctrl` + `T`. A text layer reading *Motionator* appears in the middle, in a colour that shows on your background, and is selected.
2. In the **Text** group of the **Properties** panel, type your text. Press `Ctrl` + `Enter` or click elsewhere to apply it; press Enter for a new line.
3. Pick the font, size, weight, italic, colour, alignment, letter spacing and line height. Every change rebuilds the letters at once.
4. Choose **Layer per**: *Letter* (default), *Word* or *Line*. This decides what each child layer is.

In the Layers panel the text is a root layer with one child per letter, named after it: `L1 H`, `L2 e` … Words are named `W1 hello` and lines `Line1 …`.

## Animating letter by letter

1. Select the **text layer** (the root, not a letter).
2. In the **Presets** panel, tick **Stagger to child layers**, set the step (0.05–0.1 s reads well) and the order.
3. Double-click a preset. It is applied to every letter, each starting a step after the one before.

| PRESET | EFFECT ON TEXT | TIP |
|---|---|---|
| Typewriter | Each letter appears at once: typed out | Step 0.1 s; a monospace font such as Consolas |
| Backspace | Each letter vanishes at once | Order **Reverse**, so the last letter goes first |
| Drop Bounce | Falls, bounces twice with squash and stretch | Playful titles; set the drop height |
| Neon Flicker | Stutters on like a neon tube, then stays lit with glow | Dark background; Layer per *Line* for signs |
| Scale Pop, Elastic Pop | Pops in with an overshoot | Step 0.05 s |
| Blur In, Slide In ↑ | Calm, corporate reveals | Layer per *Word* |





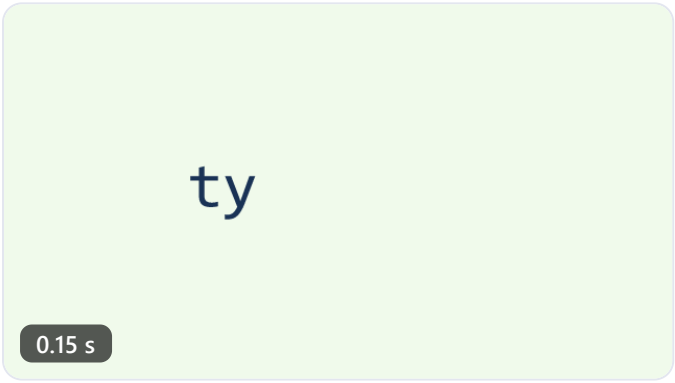








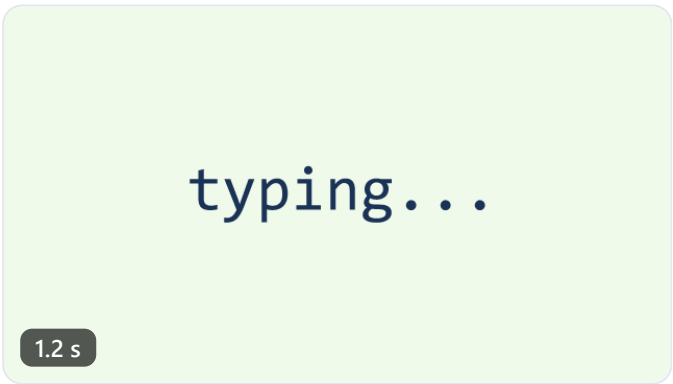
Neon Flicker on two lines (Segoe Script, Layer per Line, 0.5 s stagger).










Typewriter with a 0.12 s step.

## Looping waves across letters




Float (period 1 s) on each letter with a 0.15 s stagger: a wave that still loops seamlessly.

With a **Loop** preset (Float, Swing, Pulse, Glow Pulse…), stagger shifts each letter's *phase* rather than its start: every letter moves from the first frame, each a step behind the one before, and the clip still ends exactly as it began. This is how to make waving or rippling titles for stock loops.

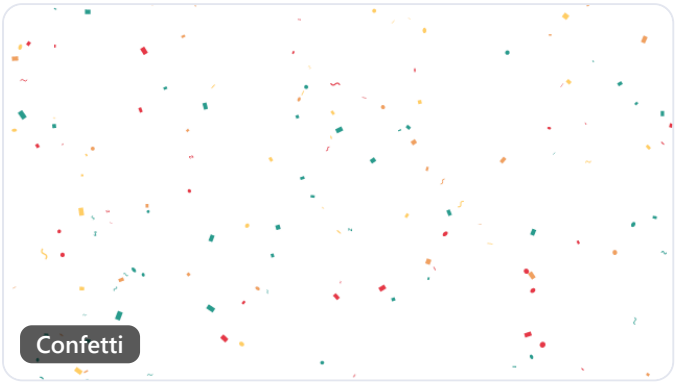
## Editing text later

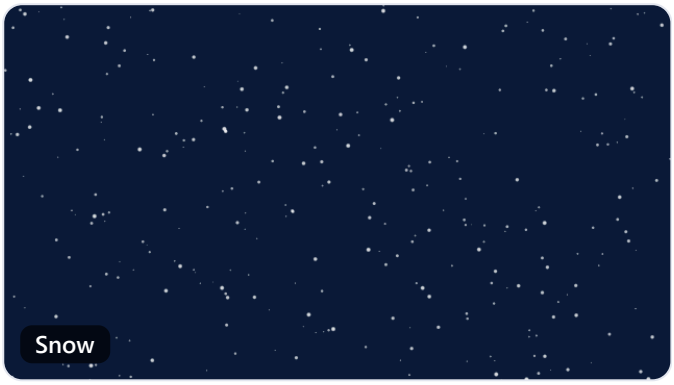
Change the text or its settings any time. Letters that keep their place keep their presets and keyframes, so changing *Hey* to *Hello* keeps the animation on H and e and adds new layers for the rest. The text layer itself stays where you put it.

> **NOTE**
> The letters are stored as outlines, so a project opens and renders the same on a computer without the font. If the font has no shape for a character, the status bar names it; pick another font.

# 22 Generator layers: confetti, counters, landscapes and more

Twenty-three kinds of content made from settings instead of artwork, ready to loop.

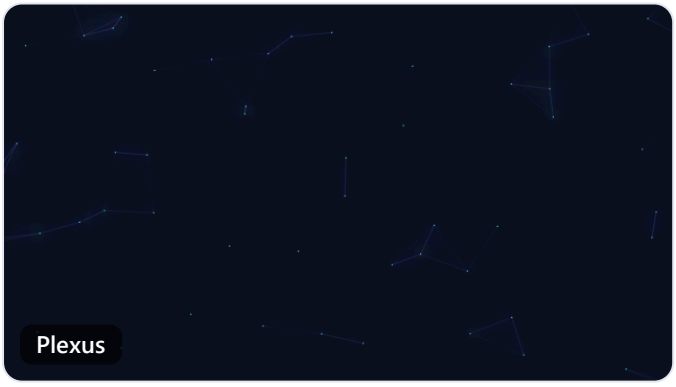








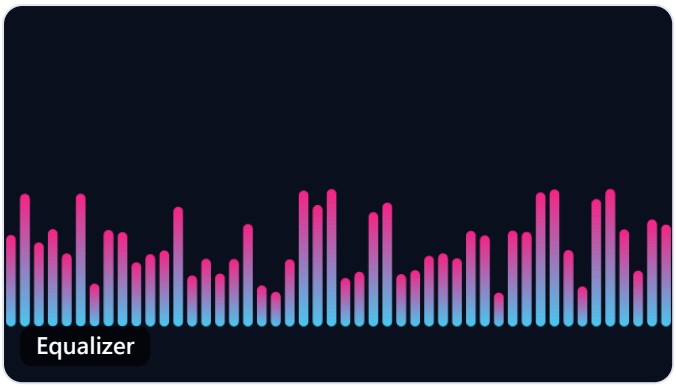



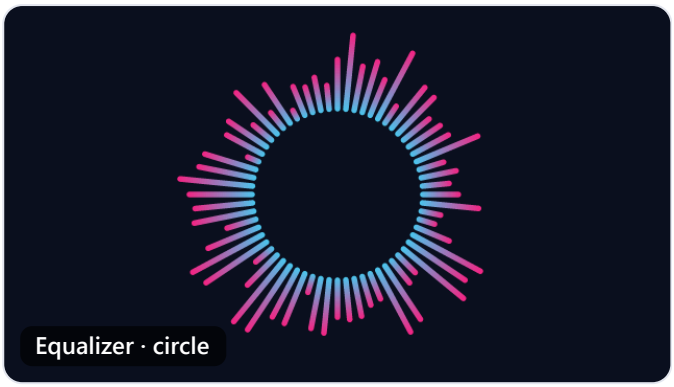










Equalizer

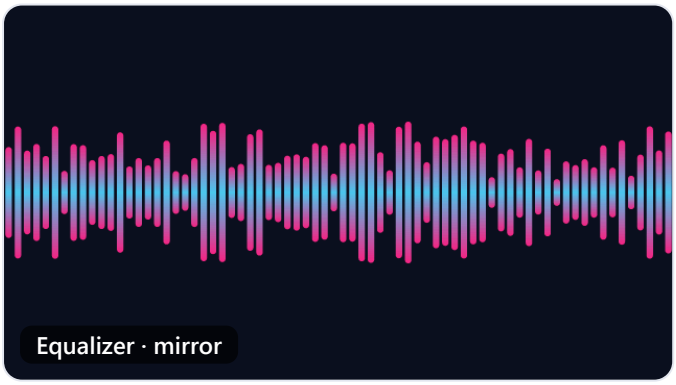

Equalizer · circle


Gradient


Waves


Rings


Rings · stripes


Equalizer · mirror




Drone Show




Constellation



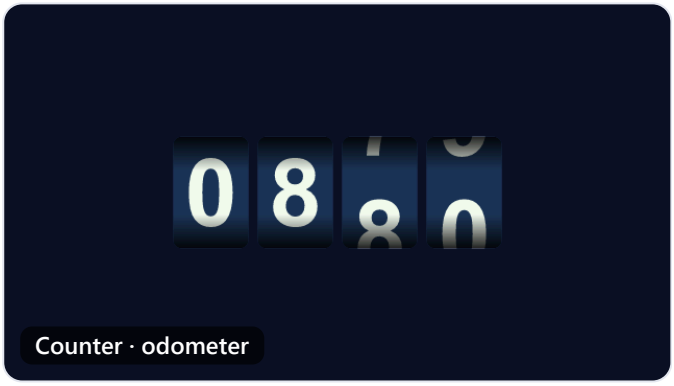

Particle Text




Word Cloud



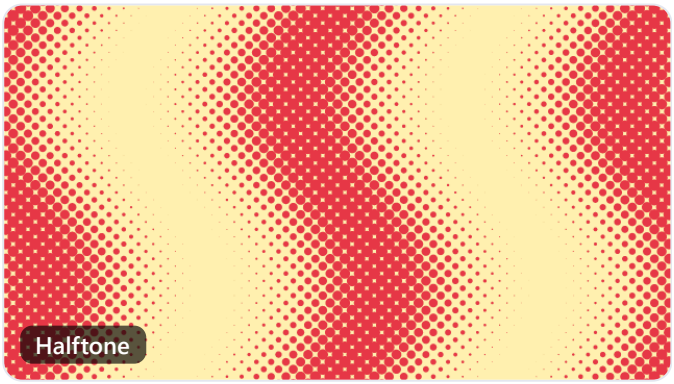

Counter · flip



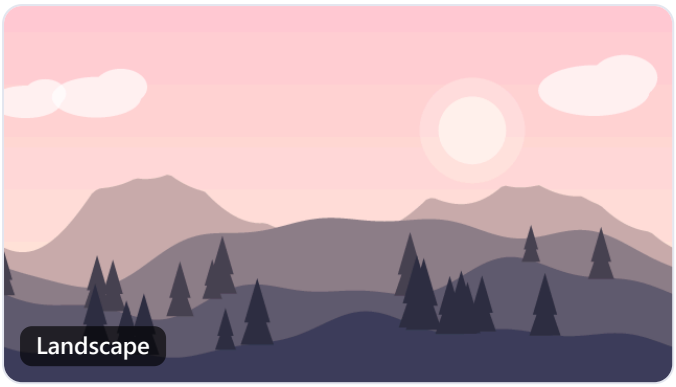

Counter · odometer

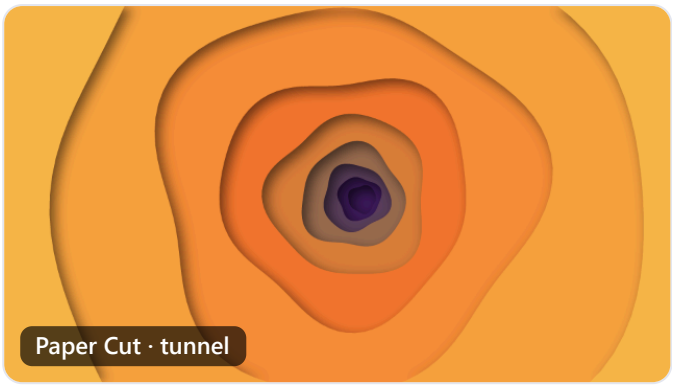


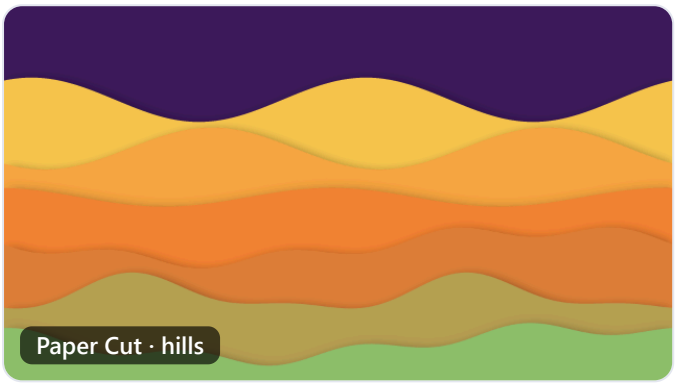
Circuit

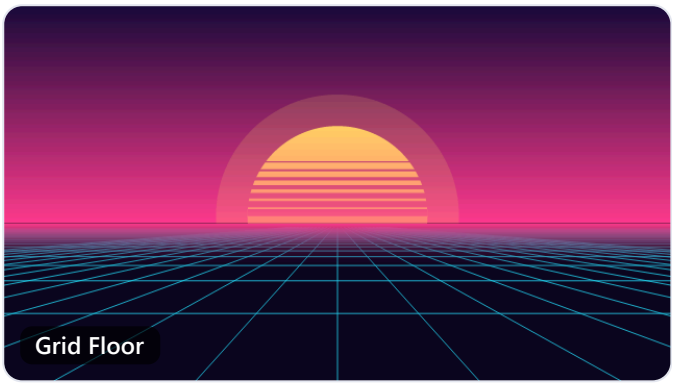


Halftone



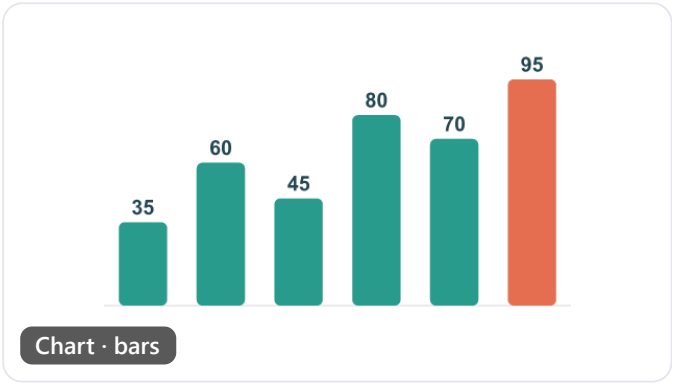



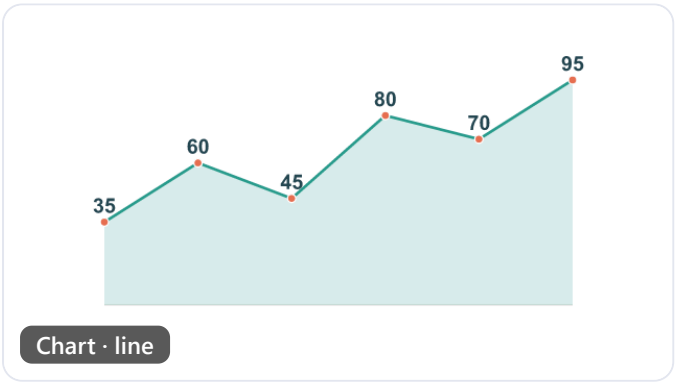



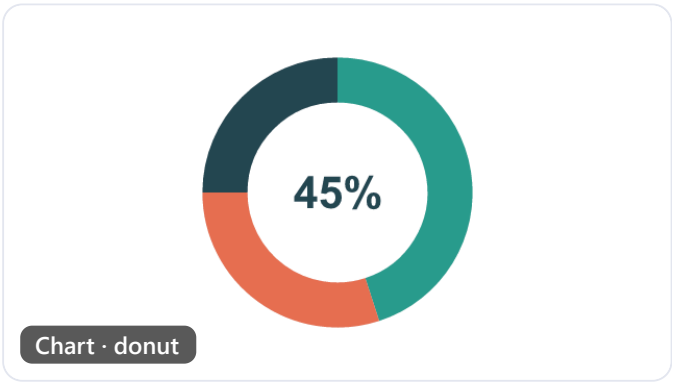










A generator draws hundreds of moving pieces from a few settings. Every piece moves on a path worked out for each moment, never simulated step by step, and every motion repeats a whole number of times over the composition. So a generator loops seamlessly (the ones that build up can too, see below), any frame renders on its own, and the same settings always give the same result.

## Adding a generator

1. Open the **Generator** category at the top of the **Presets** panel.
2. Double-click a generator. It is added as a new layer on top, covering the composition, and selected.
3. Adjust it in the **Generator** group of the **Properties** panel. **Variation** is the seed: another number gives another arrangement with the same look. **Shuffle** picks one at random.

| GENERATOR | WHAT IT DRAWS | MAIN SETTINGS |
|---|---|---|
| Confetti | Paper pieces falling, tumbling and swaying | Count, size, fall speed, sway, shapes, 4 colours |
| Snow | Soft flakes in depth: near ones bigger and faster | Count, size, speed, drift, colour, opacity |
| Bokeh | Soft circles of light drifting and pulsing | Count, size, drift, softness, opacity, 3 colours |
| Bubbles | Rising bubbles with a rim and a highlight | Count, size, rise speed, wobble, colour |
| Plexus | Moving dots linked by lines when close (tech, data) | Count, link distance, drift, dot and line size and colour |
| Fireworks | Bursts with trails, gravity and twinkle | Bursts per loop, sparks, size, gravity, 4 colours |
| Twinkle | Stars and sparkles twinkling in place | Count, size, twinkle rate, colour |
| Equalizer | Audio bars to a beat: from the bottom, mirrored or in a circle | Bars, style, height, beat (bpm), gap, base and tip colour |
| Gradient | A soft gradient flowing slowly (mesh-gradient look) | Speed, spread, 4 colours (the first is the base) |
| Waves | Layered waves rolling by | Layers, wave height, waves across, speed, 4 colours (back to front) |
| Rings | Colour bands in rings or diagonal stripes, always moving outward | Shape, band width, speed, 4 colours |

| GENERATOR | WHAT IT DRAWS | MAIN SETTINGS |
|---|---|---|
| Drone Show | Hundreds of lights flying into a text, then a heart, star or circle, then scattering | Text, font, second shape, count, size, 3 colours |
| Constellation | Stars appearing along the letters' outlines, joined by lines | Text, font, star spacing and size, line width, background stars, 2 colours |
| Particle Text | Particles flying in to form a text, then scattering | Text, font, count, size, spread, 3 colours |
| Word Cloud | Words popping in and packing together, the first one biggest | Words (one per line), font, biggest size, some vertical, 4 colours |
| Counter | A number counting up or down: flip clock, odometer, slot machine or plain | Style, from, to, minimum digits, start, end, clip ending, size, font, digit and card colour |
| Circuit | A circuit board with chips, 45° traces and pulses of light | Extra traces, chips, grid step, share of pulses, pulse speed, 4 colours (board, traces, pulses, chips) |
| Halftone | Pop-art dots growing and shrinking in waves | Pattern (waves, ripples, diagonal), dot spacing, grid angle, waves, speed, 2 colours |
| Landscape | Hills, mountains and pines scrolling sideways with parallax | Hill layers, speed, trees, sun, 4 colours (sky top, horizon, far, near) |
| Paper Cut | Cut paper with soft shadows: an endless tunnel or layered hills | Style, hole shape, layers, speed, shadow, 4 colours (the first is the deepest) |
| Grid Floor | A synthwave grid rushing towards you under a striped sun | Speed, line width, horizon height, sun, 4 colours (sky, horizon, grid, sun) |
| Ensō | A Zen circle of dry brush painted in one stroke | Size, brush width, start, end, clip ending, ink colour |
| Chart | Bars, a line or a donut growing in, with counting numbers | Type, values (comma separated), numbers, font, start, end, clip ending, 4 colours |

## Text, counters and charts

Drone Show, Constellation, Particle Text, Word Cloud, Counter and Chart draw letters or digits with an installed font, picked in their **Font** setting. Type the text in the **Text** box and press `Enter`; Word Cloud takes one word per line, applied with `Ctrl` + `Enter`.

Counter, Ensō and Chart **build up**: they run between **Start** and **End** (percent of the composition) and then hold. For a seamless stock loop, set **Clip ending** to *Go back to the start*: the last part of the clip returns them to how they began. The Counter's flip clock turns each card when its digit changes, the odometer rolls a higher drum while the ones below it pass 9 to 0, and the slot machine spins each reel and lands it on the final digit, left to right.

## Working with generators

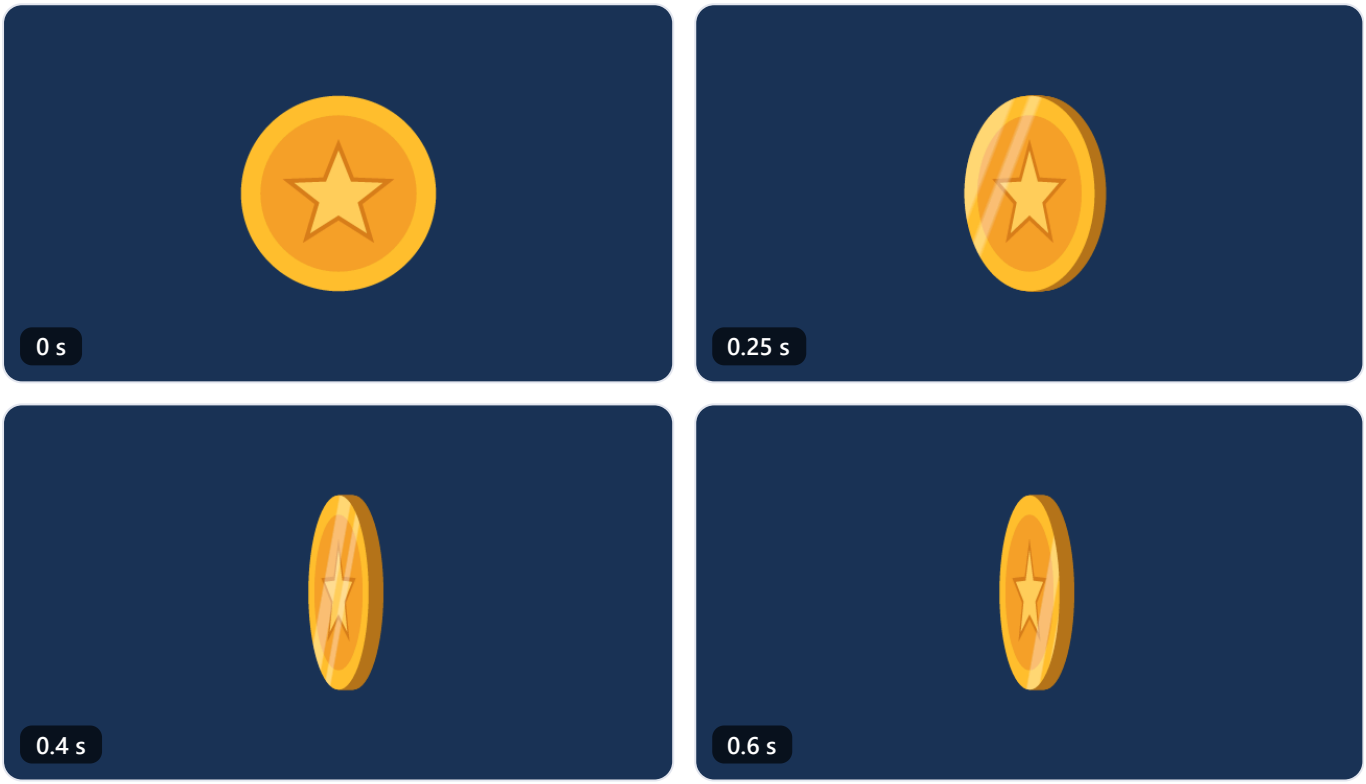
- **A generator is a normal layer.** Move and scale it, fade it in with a preset, add glow, put artwork or text above it, or stack several (bokeh behind, confetti in front).
- **Sizes in pixels mean pixels at 1080p** and scale with the composition, so the same settings look the same in 4K.
- **Loops follow the composition.** Change the duration and the motion still ends where it began.
- **Video only.** Lottie and animated SVG exports leave generator layers empty and say so in their report.

> **TIP**
>
> Fireworks, Plexus, Twinkle, Drone Show, Constellation and Circuit look their best with a little **Glow** on a dark background.

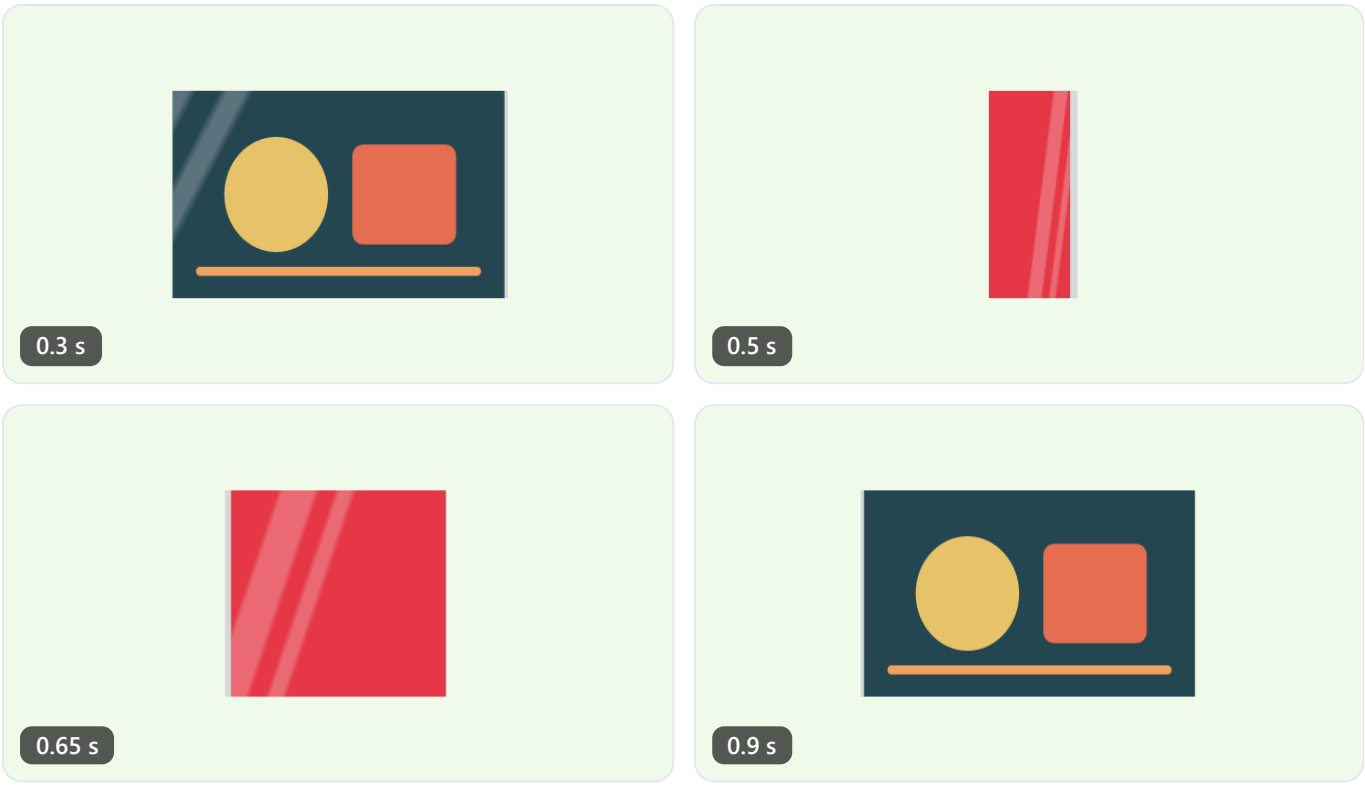
# 23 2.5D presets, brush reveals and render effects

Coins, cards and paper that turn and peel, long shadows, waving flags and sparklers, on any artwork.

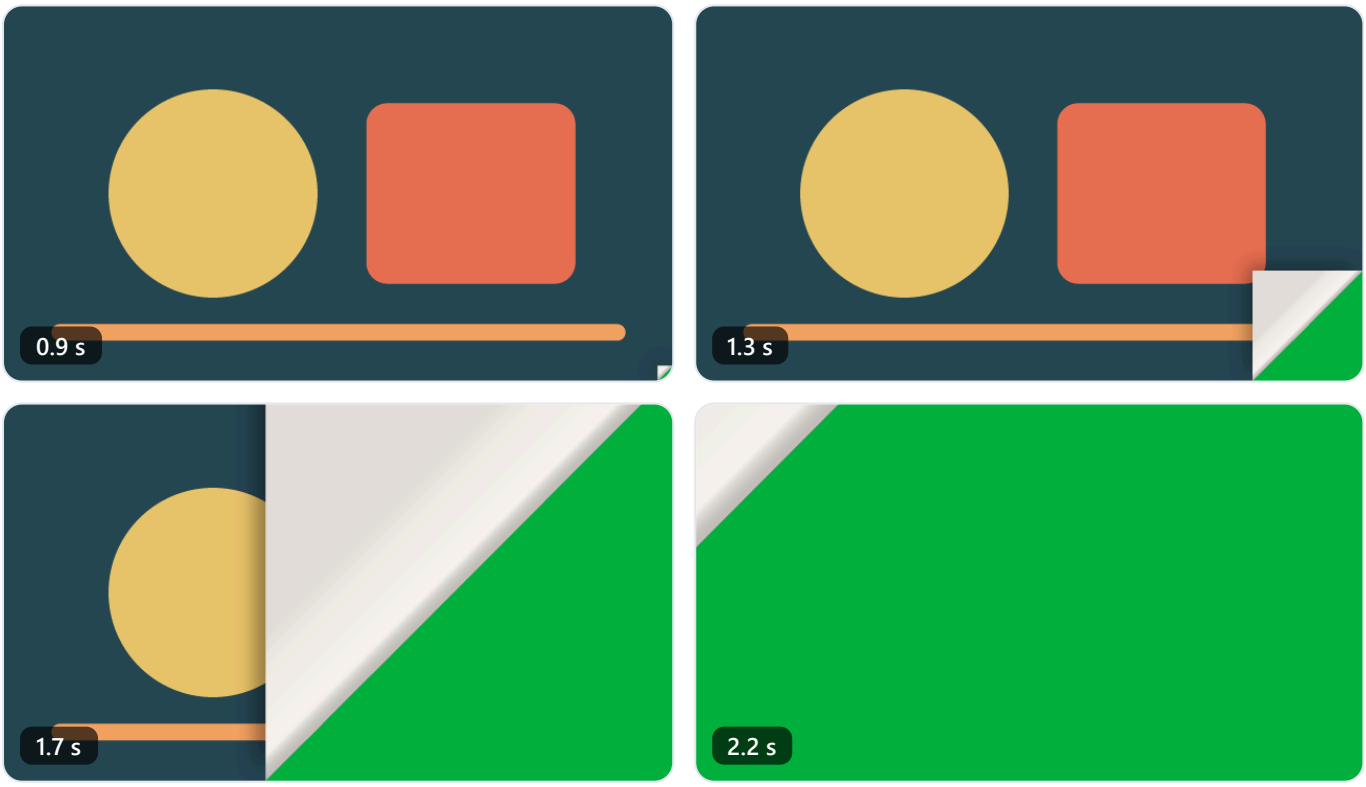
These presets do more than move a layer: the renderer gives it thickness, a back side, a shine or a paper fold. They work on any shape, not only circles and rectangles, and render in video only.




Coin Spin: thickness in the edge colour and a shine that sweeps the face; a whole number of turns, so it loops.

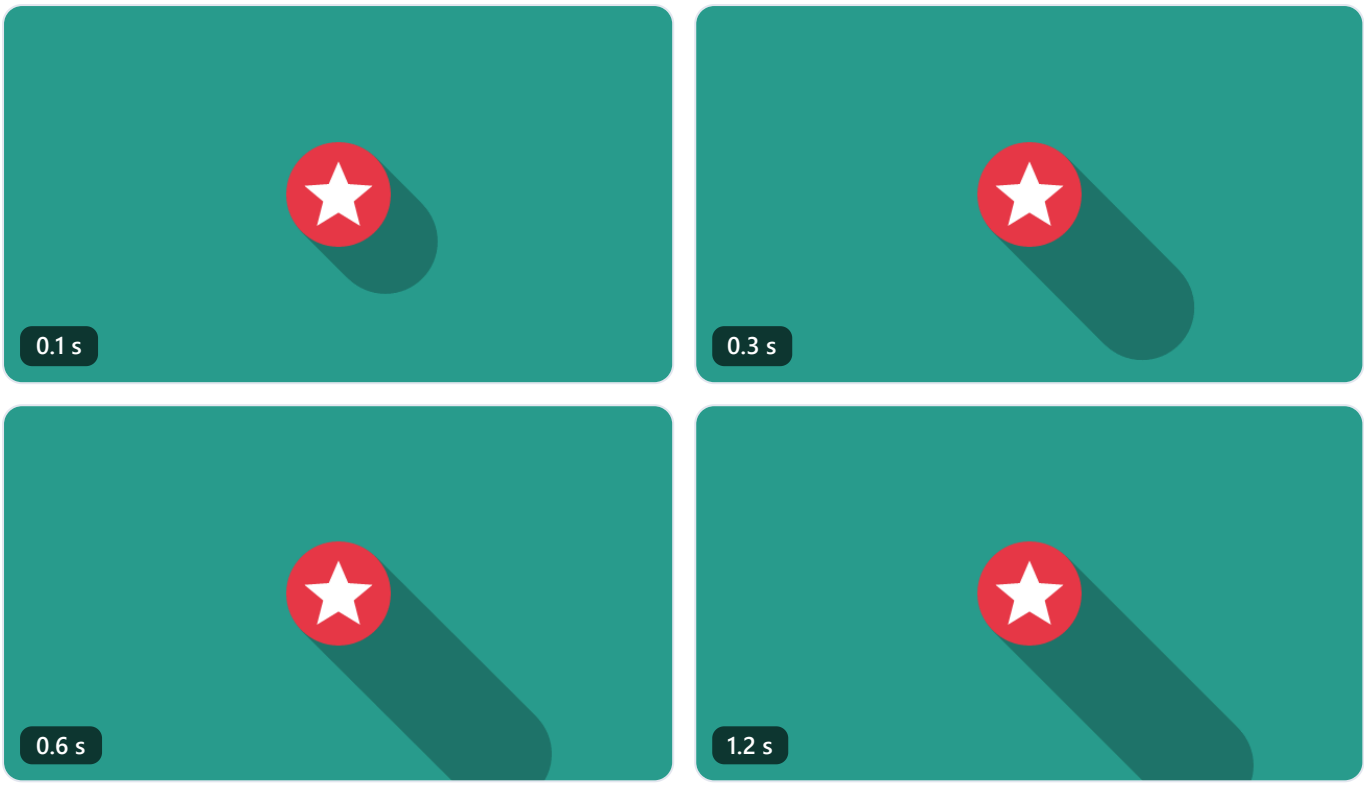



Card Flip: turns over, showing a coloured back.




Peel Off on green screen: the paper's back shows, the shadow falls only on the paper, and the screen ends fully green.

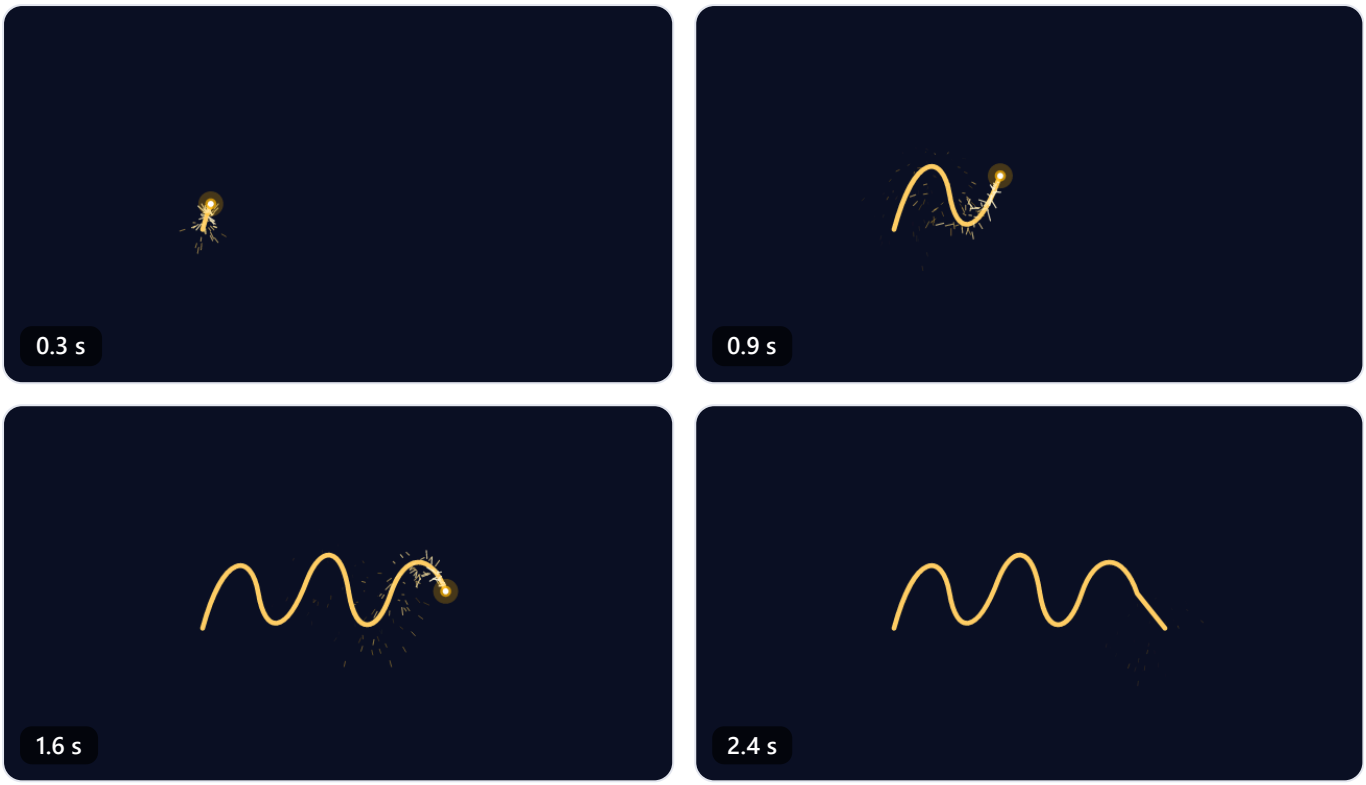
| PRESET | CATEGORY | SETTINGS |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Coin Spin | Loop | Period, direction, axis (vertical coin or horizontal board), thickness, edge colour, back side (same, mirrored, plain colour), shine |
| Card Flip In | Enter | Turns from its back to its front; same settings as Coin Spin |
| Card Flip | Emphasis | One full turn, showing the back on the way |
| Peel On / Peel Off | Enter / Exit | Starts at a corner or an edge, paper back colour, shadow; the flap leaves the screen |
| Peel Corner | Emphasis | A corner lifts by an amount and settles back |
| Brush In / Brush Out | Enter / Exit | Painted in (or wiped away) by a brush going back and forth |
| Long Shadow / Long Shadow Grow | Loop / Enter | A flat shadow swept away from the light: direction, length, colour, opacity, fade at the end |
| Flag Wave | Loop | Waves like cloth with light and shade in the folds: wave height, waves across, period, left edge held, light and shade |
| Sparkler Draw | Enter | Strokes draw on while sparks fly from the tip: sparks per second, size, launch speed, colour, ease |



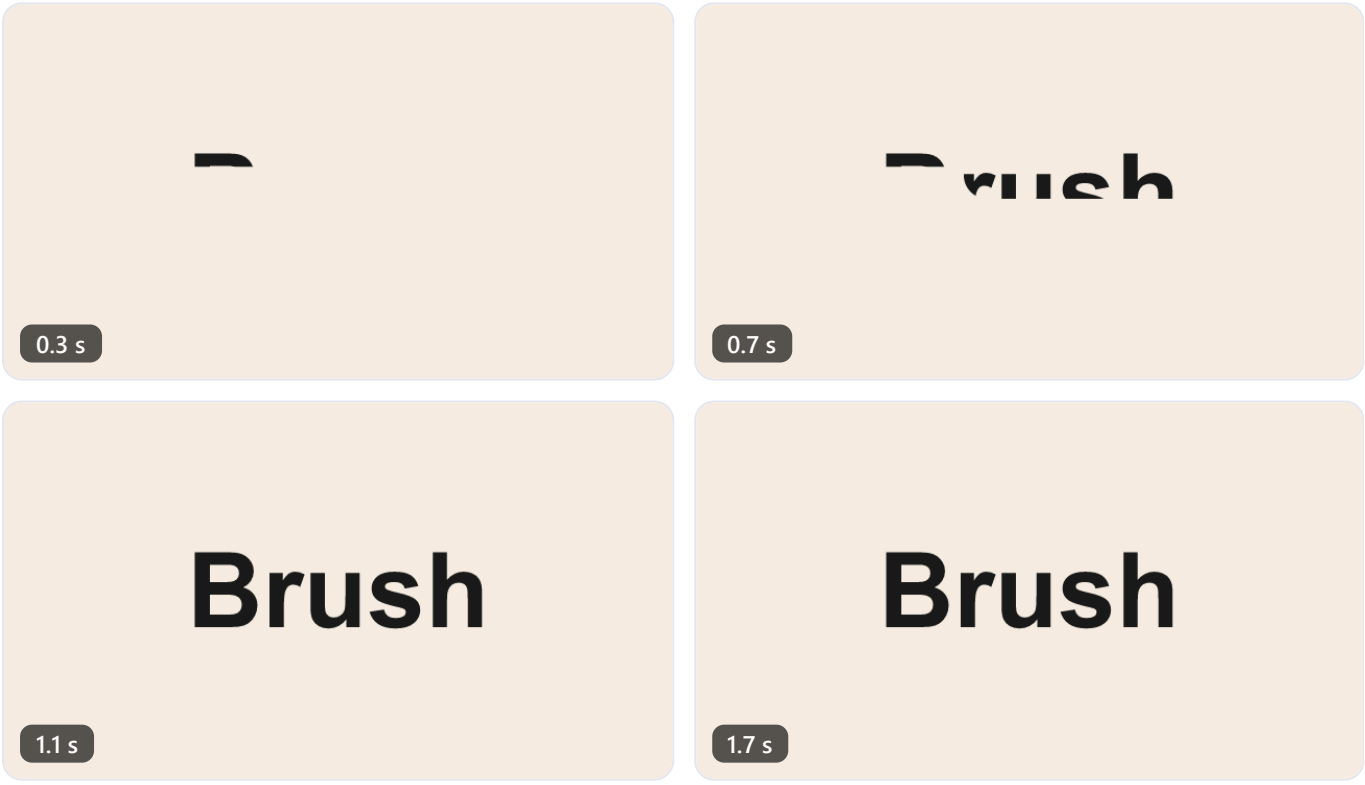

Long Shadow Grow on a badge: the shadow keeps the badge's outline, at 45°.




Flag Wave: held at the pole, with light and shade in the folds; a seamless loop.




Sparkler Draw on a stroked path: sparks fly and fall from the drawing tip and burn out after it.




Brush In: four back-and-forth strokes paint the layer in. The same reveal is in Properties ▸ Reveal from ▸ Brush strokes.

> **TIP**
>
> For a page-curl transition, put all the artwork in one group covering the frame and apply **Peel Off** to it over a `#00B140` background, then run **Stock check** in the Render Queue.

**NOTE**

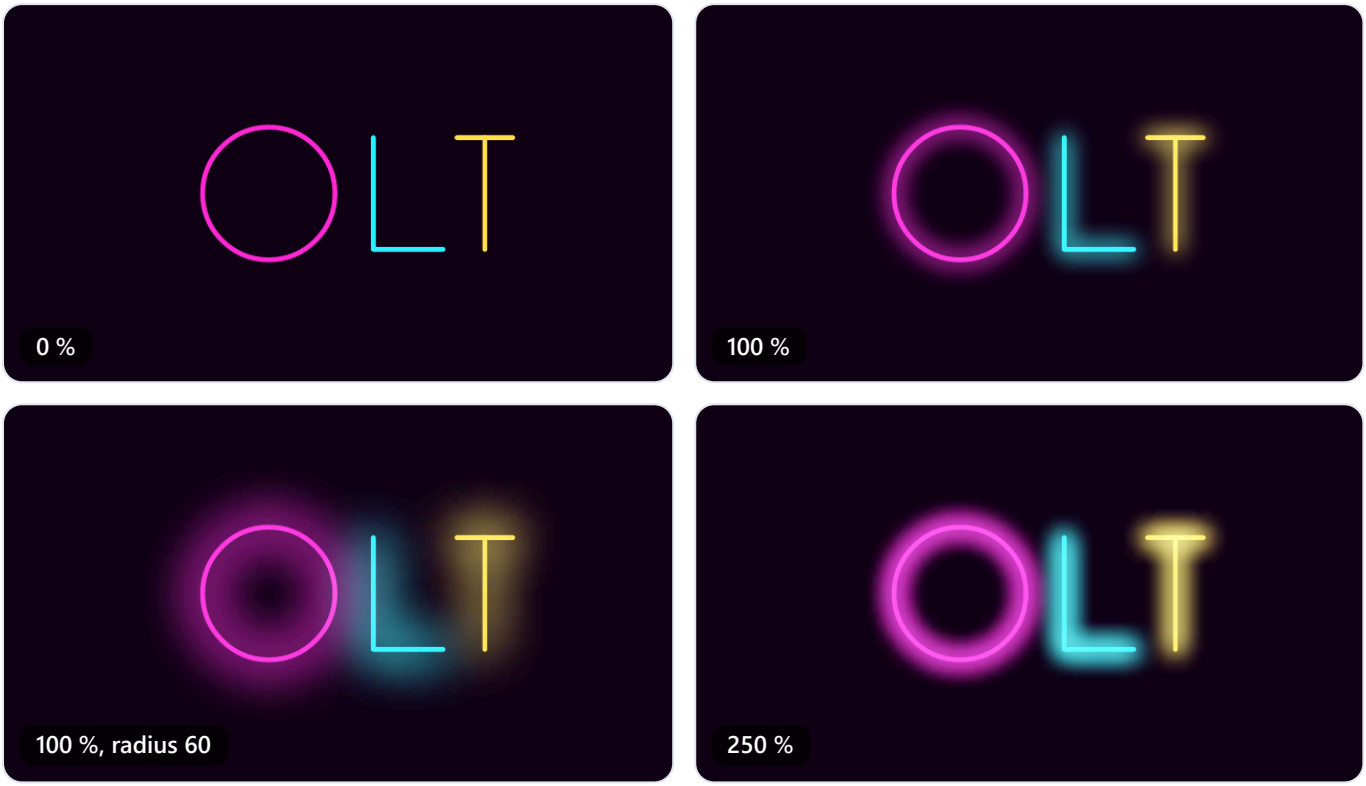
A layer that spins does not also peel (the spin wins), and a layer that spins or peels does not wave or cast a long shadow. Bake to keyframes keeps these presets as presets, since they have no keyframe form, and Lottie and animated SVG leave them out.

**TIP**

Put a long shadow on the outermost group of an icon, not on its parts as well: shadows of shadows take much longer to render.

# 24 Glow

Light around a layer, in its own colours.




**Glow** in the Effects group of the Properties panel adds the layer's own light around it. It has a stopwatch like Blur, so it can be keyframed; **Glow radius** sets how far the light spreads, in composition pixels. The presets **Glow Pulse** (a seamless loop) and **Glow Flash** (once) animate it for you, and **Neon Flicker** uses it for text.

- **Thin lines still light up**, and strong light turns softly towards white, like a real glow.
- **It sits in the layer's place.** Layers above it cover its light, as they cover the layer.
- **Glow only brightens**, so it shows on dark backgrounds and not on white.
- **Video only.** Lottie and animated SVG exports leave it out and say so.

> **NOTE**
> Glow is rendered at a quarter of the output size and blurred there, so even 4K stays quick. Glow on a whole SVG, a generator or a text layer is the fastest; glow on a part inside an SVG takes a little longer.

# 25 Animation principles for motion design

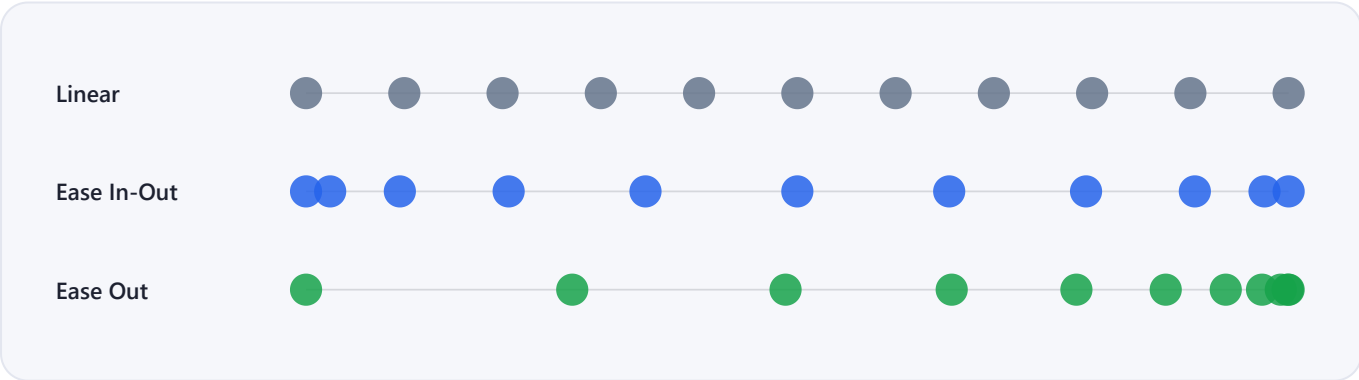
The classic rules of animation, and the Motionator feature for each.

## Timing

How long a motion lasts sets its mood: short is energetic, long is calm. Typical durations:

| CONTENT | TYPICAL DURATION |
|---|---|
| Button and icon feedback (web/app) | 0.15 – 0.3 s |
| UI elements entering, cards, menus | 0.3 – 0.6 s |
| Titles and text lines | 0.5 – 1 s |
| Logo reveal (whole) | 2 – 5 s |
| Social media post | 5 – 15 s |
| Stock background loop | 10 – 30 s |

## Spacing and easing




The dots show where an object is on equally spaced frames. Linear motion has equal steps and looks robotic. Eased motion bunches frames at the ends, so the object speeds up and slows down like a real object with weight. Press `F9` on keyframes, or pick an easing for a preset.

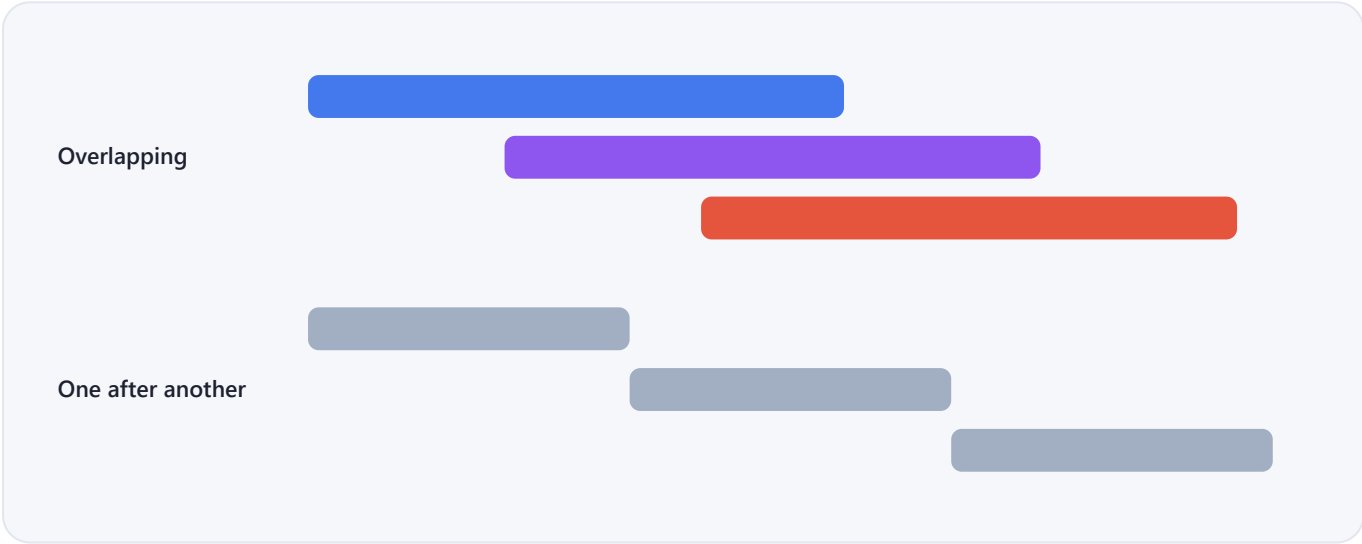
## Anticipation

A small move in the opposite direction before the main action prepares the eye: a character crouches before jumping, a button shrinks slightly before popping. In Motionator, keyframe a small opposite value just before the motion, or use curves with a negative handle such as *Ease In Back*.

## Follow-through and overshoot

Real objects do not stop dead; they go a little too far and settle. *Scale Pop*, *Pop Up* and *Elastic Pop* do this built in, and any preset can use *Ease Out Back*. In keyframes, add a key slightly past the final value a few frames before the end.

## Overlapping action and stagger




When parts start at slightly different times and overlap, motion feels fluid and organic. Waiting for each part to finish feels slow and mechanical. Use **Stagger** with a step shorter than the preset's duration (e.g. 0.08 s for 0.6 s Pop Up) for overlap.

## Arcs

Living things move along curves, not straight lines. Curve your motion paths with the handles on the canvas; the plane in the icon sample swoops instead of sliding.

## Secondary action

A small extra motion supports the main one: the badge hovers while the plane flies, a glow pulses while the logo sits. Add a Loop preset with a small amount on top of the main animation.

## Squash and stretch

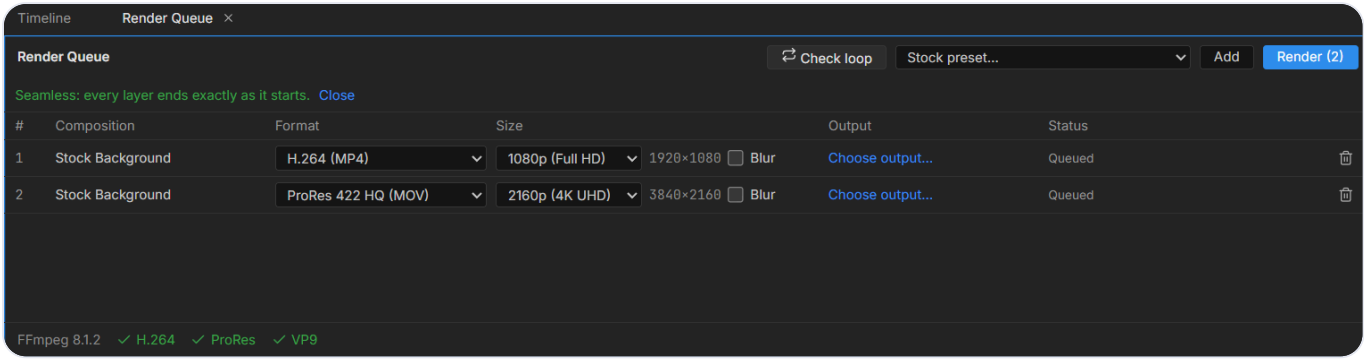
Squashing on impact and stretching in fast motion gives flexibility and weight. *Squash*, *Stretch In*, *Rubber Band* and the *Bounce* loop do this; keep the anchor at the contact point.

## Hierarchy and restraint

- Animate the most important thing first and most clearly; let secondary items follow.
- Use one or two kinds of motion per scene. Ten different presets at once looks busy.
- Leave moments of stillness so the viewer can read.
- Match motion to the brand: soft eases for calm brands, snappy Expo and Back for energetic ones.

# 26 Video export: Render Queue

Render one composition to several formats and sizes in one go.




The Render Queue with two outputs of the background sample, after a loop check.

1. Click **Export** or press `Ctrl` + `M`: the composition is added to the queue. Add it again for more outputs.
2. Choose the **format** and **size** of each item, and tick **Blur** for motion blur.
3. Click **Choose output...** to set the file name.
4. Press **Render**. Items render one after another with progress and time left; each can be cancelled.

## Formats

| FORMAT | TRANSPARENCY | USE IT FOR |
|---|---|---|
| H.264 (MP4) | ✗ | Stock footage, social media, presentations: plays everywhere. |
| ProRes 422 HQ (MOV) | ✗ | Masters for editing and for stock sites that accept ProRes; large files. |
| ProRes 4444 (MOV) | ✓ | Overlays with transparency for video editors (Premiere, Resolve, Final Cut). |
| VP9 (WebM) | ✓ | Transparent video for websites. |

**Size** scales the composition to 720p, 1080p, 1440p or 2160p (4K UHD) keeping its aspect ratio, or keeps the composition size. Because Motionator draws vectors, a 4K render is as sharp as the

composition at any size. H.264 and VP9 need even widths and heights; an odd size is shown in red.

**Motion blur** blends 8 sub-frames per frame (180° shutter) for natural blur on fast motion. It takes about 8× longer to render.

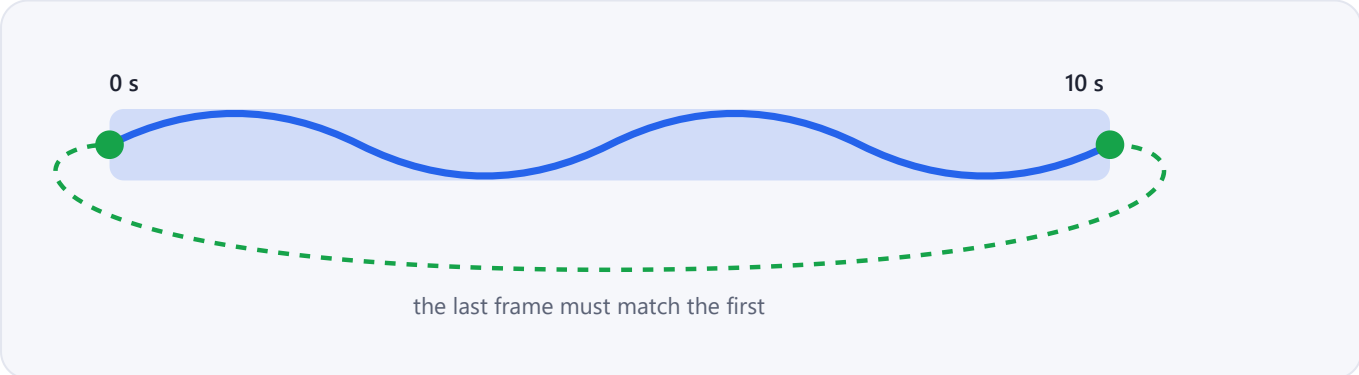
## Stock presets and checks

**Stock preset…** adds an item already set up for microstock sites:

| PRESET | OUTPUT |
|---|---|
| Microstock 4K · H.264 | 3840×2160, high-quality H.264 (CRF 12) |
| Microstock 4K · ProRes 422 HQ | 3840×2160 master |
| Microstock HD · H.264 | 1920×1080, H.264 (CRF 14) |

A yellow warning appears on an item when something is commonly rejected by stock sites: a clip shorter than 5 s or longer than 60 s, a height below 1080 px, a non-standard frame rate, or a format with alpha. Always check the current rules of the site you upload to.

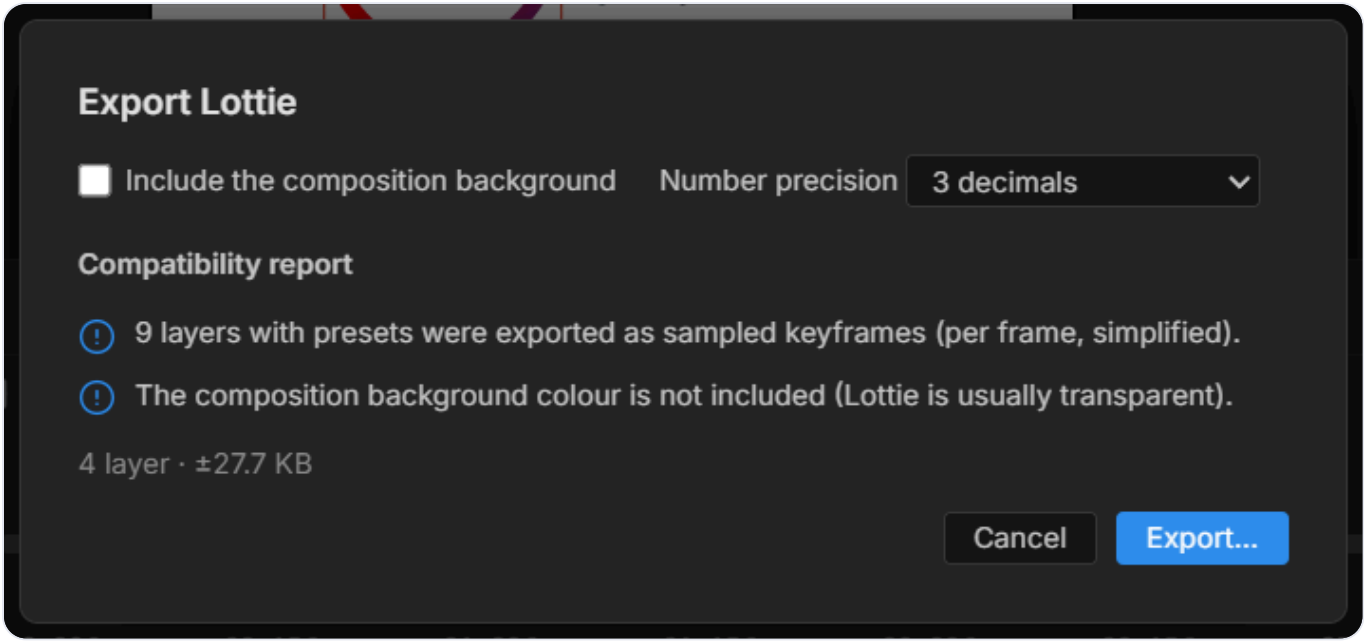
## Checking a seamless loop




Looping backgrounds sell better when they repeat without a visible jump. **Check loop** compares every layer at the end of the composition with the start. If something differs, it lists the layers and properties. **Match the end to the start** adds keyframes at the end with the start values. Loop presets are always seamless; Enter, Exit and Emphasis presets cannot be fixed automatically, so use Loop presets or remove them.

# 27 Lottie export

Small JSON animations for websites and apps.




Export Lottie with its compatibility report and the estimated size.

1. Choose **File** ▸ **Export Lottie...** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `L`.
2. Decide whether to include the composition background (Lottie is usually transparent) and the number precision (fewer decimals = smaller file).
3. Read the compatibility report, then click **Export...** and save the `.json` file.

Keyframes are exported as Lottie keyframes with their easing; presets are exported as sampled keyframes (simplified), which looks the same. Shapes, gradients, strokes, Trim Paths, clip paths and Tint are kept.

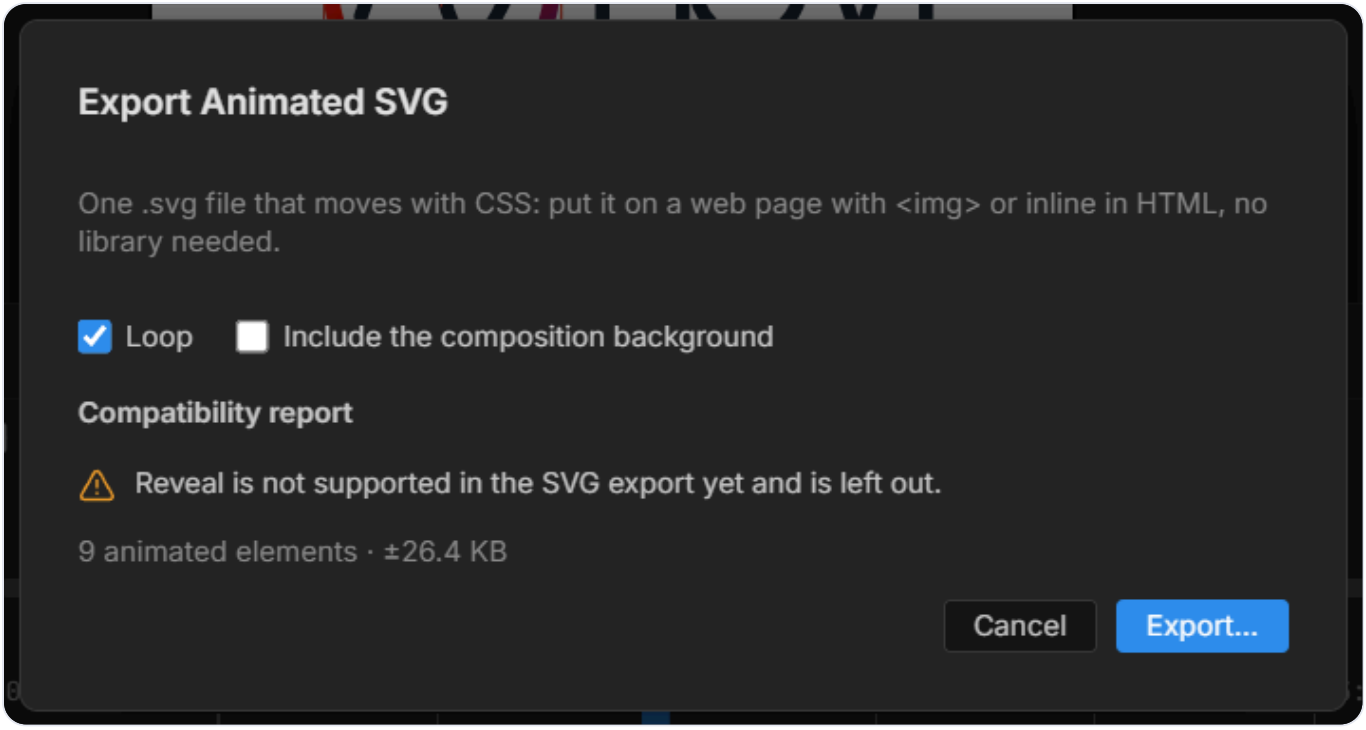
## Using it on a web page

```
 <div id="logo" style="width:480px;height:270px"></div>
<script src="https://cdnjs.cloudflare.com/ajax/libs/lottie-web/5.12.2/lottie.min.js"></script>
<script>
  lottie.loadAnimation({
    container: document.getElementById("logo"),
    renderer: "svg",
    loop: true,
    autoplay: true,
    path: "logo.json"
  });
</script>
```

Or use the `<lottie-player>` / `<dotlottie-player>` web components, Lottie for Android/iOS, or upload the file to LottieFiles. Test the JSON in the player you will use: support for some features differs between players.

# 28 Animated SVG export

One self-contained .svg that moves with CSS, with no library needed.




Export Animated SVG: loop, background and the compatibility report.

Choose **File ▸ Export Animated SVG...** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `G`. Tick **Loop** to repeat forever or leave it off to stop on the last frame. The file contains your artwork and CSS keyframe animations; it plays in every modern browser.

## Putting it on a page

```
<!— as an image: simplest, the animation plays on its own —>
<img src="icon.svg" width="256" height="256" alt="Paper plane">

<!— inline in the HTML: lets your page's CSS reach inside —>
<div class="hero-icon">
  <!— paste the contents of icon.svg here —>
</div>
```

- **<img>** and CSS `background-image` work and keep the animation; scripts on the page cannot control it.
- Inline SVG can be paused with `animation-play-state: paused` on its elements.

| CHOOSE | WHEN |
| --- | --- |
| Animated SVG | Icons, logos and illustrations on websites, with no JavaScript. Usually the smallest file. |
| Lottie | Apps (Android, iOS, Flutter, React Native), or when you need to control playback from code. |
| Video (VP9/MP4) | Complex scenes with heavy blur, many layers or filters. |

# 29 Using animations on websites and in apps

Practical code for lottie-web, React and animated SVG.

## Controlling a Lottie with JavaScript

`loadAnimation` returns an object with methods to control playback:

```
 const anim = lottie.loadAnimation({
  container: document.getElementById("icon"),
  renderer: "svg", loop: false, autoplay: false,
  path: "icon.json"
});

anim.play();                    // play from the current frame
anim.pause();
anim.stop();                    // back to frame 0
anim.setSpeed(1.5);             // 1 = normal
anim.setDirection(-1);          // play backwards
anim.goToAndStop(45, true);     // jump to frame 45
anim.playSegments([0, 30], true);
anim.addEventListener("complete", () => console.log("done"));
```

### Play on hover

```
 const box = document.getElementById("icon");
box.addEventListener("mouseenter", () => { anim.setDirection(1); anim.play(); });
box.addEventListener("mouseleave", () => { anim.setDirection(-1); anim.play(); });
```

### Play when scrolled into view

```
new IntersectionObserver(([e]) => e.isIntersecting ? anim.play() : anim.pause(),
 { threshold: 0.4 }).observe(document.getElementById("icon"));
```

## Lottie in React

```
 // npm install lottie-react
import Lottie from "lottie-react";
import spinner from "./spinner.json";

export function Loader() {
  return <Lottie animationData={spinner} loop style={{ width: 96, height: 96 }} />;
}
```

Other platforms: **lottie-android** and **lottie-ios** (Airbnb), **lottie** for Flutter, **lottie-react-native**. They all read the same JSON.

## Keeping Lottie files small

- Lower **Number precision** in the export dialog (2 decimals is usually invisible).
- Prefer keyframes over presets where file size matters: keyframes export as a few bezier keys, presets as sampled keys.
- Simplify paths in your design tool; every point is stored.
- Leave out the background if the page already has one.
- Serve the JSON with gzip/brotli compression (most hosts do this automatically); JSON compresses very well.

## Accessible animated SVG

```
 <!— decorative: hide it from screen readers —>
<img src="wave.svg" alt="" aria-hidden="true">

<!— meaningful: describe it —>
<img src="logo.svg" alt="Motionator logo">

<!— respect users who prefer less motion (inline SVG) —>
<style>
  @media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
    .hero-icon svg * { animation: none !important; }
  }
</style>
```

> **TIP**
>
> With `<img>` the animation cannot be paused by page CSS. If you need reduced-motion support, either inline the SVG and use the CSS above, or swap the source with `<picture>` and `media="(prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)"` pointing to a static SVG.

## Transparent video on the web

```
<video autoplay loop muted playsinline width="640">
  <source src="badge.webm" type="video/webm">   <!-- VP9 + alpha -->
  <source src="badge.mp4"  type="video/mp4">    <!-- fallback, no alpha -->
</video>
```

VP9 with alpha plays with transparency in Chrome, Edge and Firefox. Safari needs HEVC with alpha, which Motionator does not export; the MP4 fallback shows there on the composition background. For simple vector graphics, Lottie or animated SVG are lighter and sharper.

## Which format is lightest?

For the logo sample (3 s, 9 animated layers) the export dialogs report about **27.7 KB** for Lottie (3 decimals) and **26.4 KB** for the animated SVG, before gzip compression. A video of the same clip is many times larger and is fixed to one resolution. The dialogs always show the size before you save, so compare for your own project.

Vector formats stay sharp at any size and on high-DPI screens; choose video only when the scene needs effects the vector formats cannot show.

# 30 Making motion backgrounds for microstock

A practical workflow from idea to upload.

> **NOTE**
> Stock agencies change their requirements from time to time. The values below are common across major sites; always check the current contributor guidelines of the site you upload to.

## Technical checklist

| ITEM | COMMON REQUIREMENT | IN MOTIONATOR |
|---|---|---|
| Resolution | At least 1920×1080; 3840×2160 (4K) sells better | Size 2160p in the Render Queue |
| Length | 5 – 60 s | Composition duration; warning if outside |
| Frame rate | Standard rates (23.976–60) | Composition settings |
| Codec | H.264 high quality or ProRes | Stock presets |
| Audio | Usually none for backgrounds | Mute the track or leave it out |
| Seamless loop | A strong selling point (mention it) | Check loop |
| Content | No logos, brands or text you do not own | Use your own artwork |

## What sells: ideas that suit Motionator

🌊

### Abstract waves

Layered waves with Sway and Float, gradients, slow motion. Classic presentation backgrounds.

✨

### Particles and bokeh

Many small circles with Drift and Glow at different periods; blur some for depth.

### Geometric patterns

Grids of shapes with Spin, Pulse and stagger; perfect loops by design.

### Tech and circuits

Line art with Trace running along paths, Glow on nodes.

### Seasonal

Snow, confetti, lanterns, Ramadan and Christmas themes, released a few months early.

### Lower thirds and overlays

Transparent ProRes 4444 elements editors can drop onto their video.

## Designing perfect loops

1. Pick the clip length first (for example 10 s).
2. Give every Loop preset a period that divides it: 10, 5, 2.5, 2 or 1 s. Different periods (5 and 2.5) create variety and still meet at the end.
3. For Spin, a full turn must fit, or the shape must be symmetric: a 16-point star repeats every 22.5°.
4. Do not use Enter/Exit presets in a loop: the start and end would differ.
5. For keyframes, make the last key equal to the first (the Check loop fix does this for you).
6. Run **Check loop**, then watch the clip with loop playback on: the jump from last to first frame should be invisible.

## One project, many clips

Stock buyers search by colour and mood. After finishing one background, save copies of the project with different colours (use **Tint** on the root layer, or recolour the SVG), different speeds (change the periods) or a different crop (scale the root layer), and render each. Queue them all in the Render Queue overnight.

## Titles and keywords

- Title: what it is, the style and the use. *“Abstract purple waves seamless loop background 4K”*.
- Keywords: subject (waves, particles), colours, mood (calm, corporate, festive), technique (loop, motion graphics, animation), use (presentation, intro, backdrop).
- Most sites need English metadata; write it in English even if your audience is local.
- Abstract graphics made entirely by you need no model or property release.

# 31 Microstock tools: checks, metadata and batches

Catch rejections before uploading and write each site's CSV.

## Stock templates

In the composition's Properties (click empty canvas), **Stock template** sets size, frame rate, duration and background for a kind of clip:

| TEMPLATE | SETUP | RULE |
|---|---|---|
| Green-screen transition | 3840×2160, 30 fps, 5 s, #00B140 | Green at both ends, fully covered around 2.3–2.7 s (the cut point) |
| Luma matte | 3840×2160, 30 fps, 5 s, black | First frame pure black, last pure white |
| Stock loop | 3840×2160, 30 fps, 10 s | Ends exactly as it starts (Check loop) |

## Stock check

**Stock check** in the Render Queue renders a few frames and tests what reviewers reject. It knows the clip kind from the background (chroma green means a transition) and lists each problem in one line:

- **Every clip:** standard frame rate and 5–60 s (errors), 3840×2160 (a warning below 4K).
- **Green-screen transition:** first frame 100 % chroma, last frame at least 99.9 %, no chroma at all at the cut point, no green or teal artwork (it would be keyed out), and no half-transparent edges over the green such as glow, blur or shadows (they leave a green fringe).
- **Luma matte:** first frame pure black, last frame pure white.

## Stock metadata and CSVs

Fill in **Stock metadata** in the composition's Properties once per project: title, description (at least 5 words), keywords (most important first), one or two Shutterstock categories and the Adobe Stock category. After rendering, **Metadata CSV** in the Render Queue writes four files into a `metadata` folder next to the finished videos, one row per video:

| FILE | ADAPTED TO THE SITE |
| --- | --- |
| shutterstock_metadata.csv | Video category names (art, health care), at most 50 keywords |
| adobestock_metadata.csv | Title up to 200 characters, at most 49 keywords, category number |
| vecteezy_metadata.csv | No underscores in file names, letters and digits only, words such as *vector*, *video*, *AI* removed, licence Pro |
| pond5_metadata.csv | Title up to 80 characters, clean description, price 39 (4K) and 25 (HD) |

Loops get the keywords *seamless loop* and *looping animation* automatically. Anything a site would refuse is shown in the status bar.

## Batch variations




One project, three variations: another seed, swapped colours, a new background and new text.

1. Build one clip as a template. Generators, text layers and colours are what variations can change.

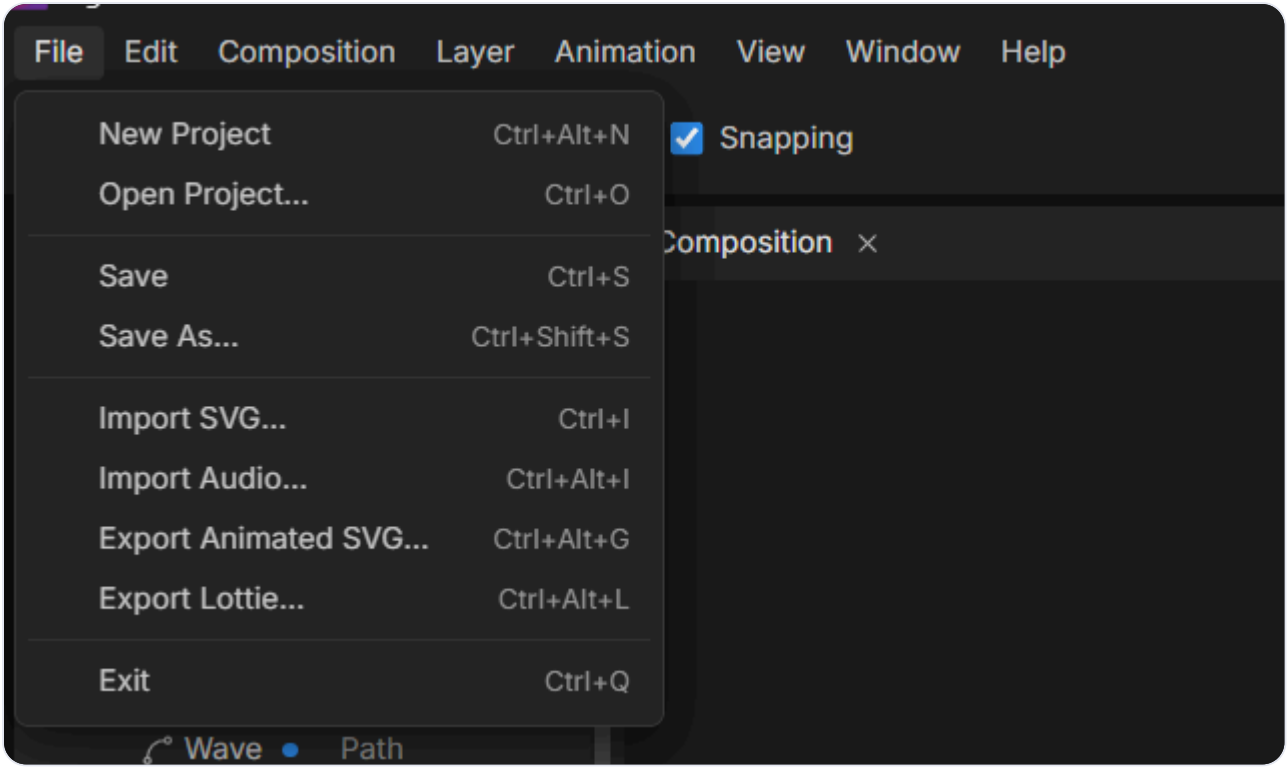
2. In the Render Queue, click **Batch variations...**. Each row is one video: file name, seed, replacements for the project's six main colours, background, new text for the first text layer and its own stock title.

3. Add rows, choose the output folder and click **Add to the queue**. Every row becomes a 4K H.264 item that renders its own variation.

4. Press **Render**, then **Metadata CSV**: each row keeps its own title.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Variations change the look, not the motion. Stock sites reject batches of near-identical clips ("similar content"), so mix variations with clips that move differently or have their own style.

# 32 Projects, auto-save and recovery




The File menu.

- **Save** `Ctrl` + `S` / **Save As...** `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S` write a `.motionator` file. It contains the SVGs, keyframes, presets and your own presets used, so it is complete on its own (only audio stays a separate file).
- **New Project** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `N` and **Open Project...** `Ctrl` + `O` ask first if there are unsaved changes. The title bar shows * when there are.
- **Auto-save** keeps a recovery copy every minute (change it in Preferences). It never overwrites your file.
- After a crash or power cut, Motionator offers **Recover project** on the next start. Choose Recover to continue, or Discard.

# 33 Tutorial: logo reveal with sound

Uses samples/logo.svg. Result: samples/logo.motionator.













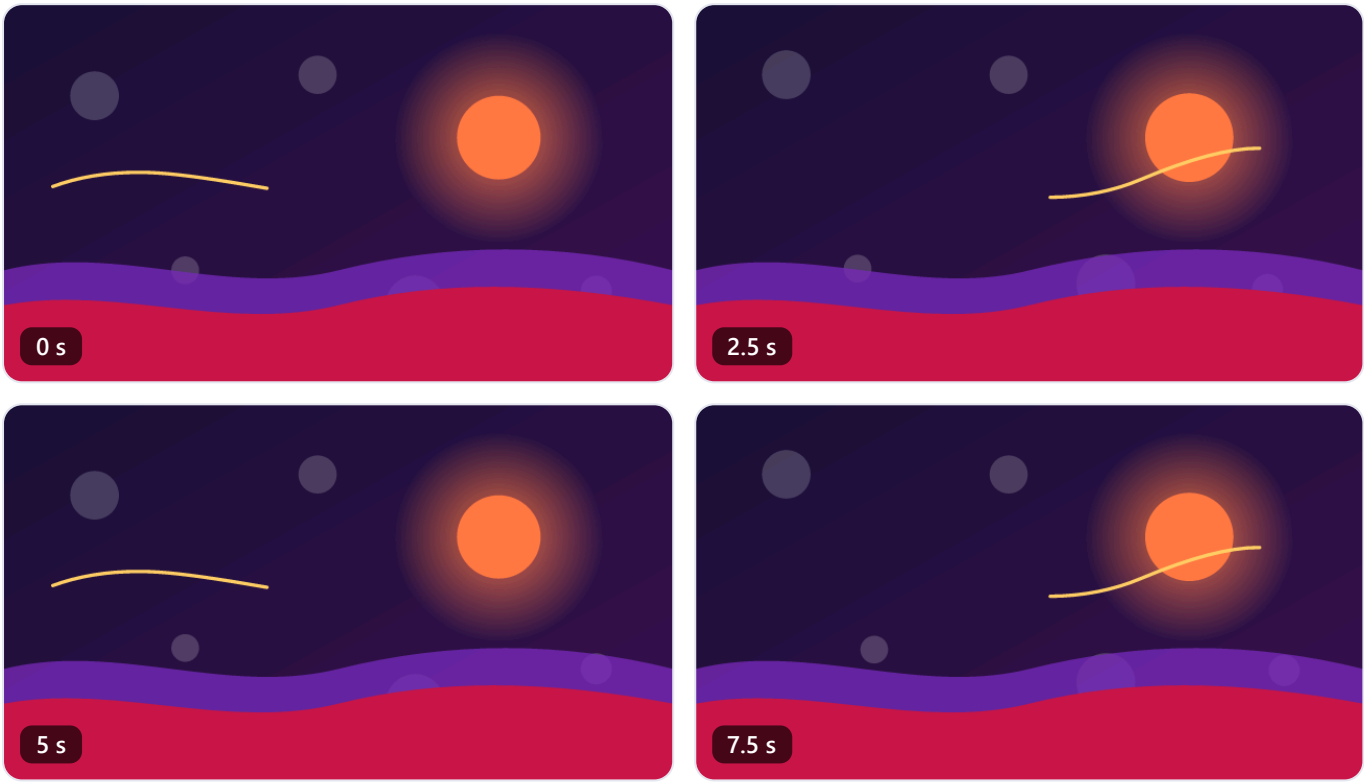
1. **New project.** Press `Ctrl` + `K`: 1920×1080, 30 fps, 4 s, white background.
2. **Import** `logo.svg` `Ctrl` + `I`. The layers are `Mark` (Ring, Wave, Dot), `Wordmark` (the letters) and `Underline`.
3. **Make it bigger.** Select the root layer `logo.svg` and set Scale to 210 %: vectors stay sharp.
4. **Draw the mark.** At 0 s select `Ring` and apply *Draw On*, then do the same for `Wave`. In the Properties panel set each Duration to 1.5 s.
5. **Write the letters one by one.** Tick *Stagger to child layers* with 0.125 s, In order. Move the playhead to 0.5 s, select `Wordmark` and apply *Draw On*: each letter draws a little after the previous one. Untick stagger afterwards.
6. **Pop the dot.** At 1.4 s select `Dot` and apply *Scale Pop*.
7. **Wipe the underline.** At 1.8 s select `Underline` and apply *Wipe In* (From the left).
8. **Accent.** At 3.0 s select `Mark` and apply *Pop*; lower Amount to 8 % for a subtle beat.
9. **Sound.** Import a short whoosh or chime with `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `I` and line it up with the Pop using the waveform.

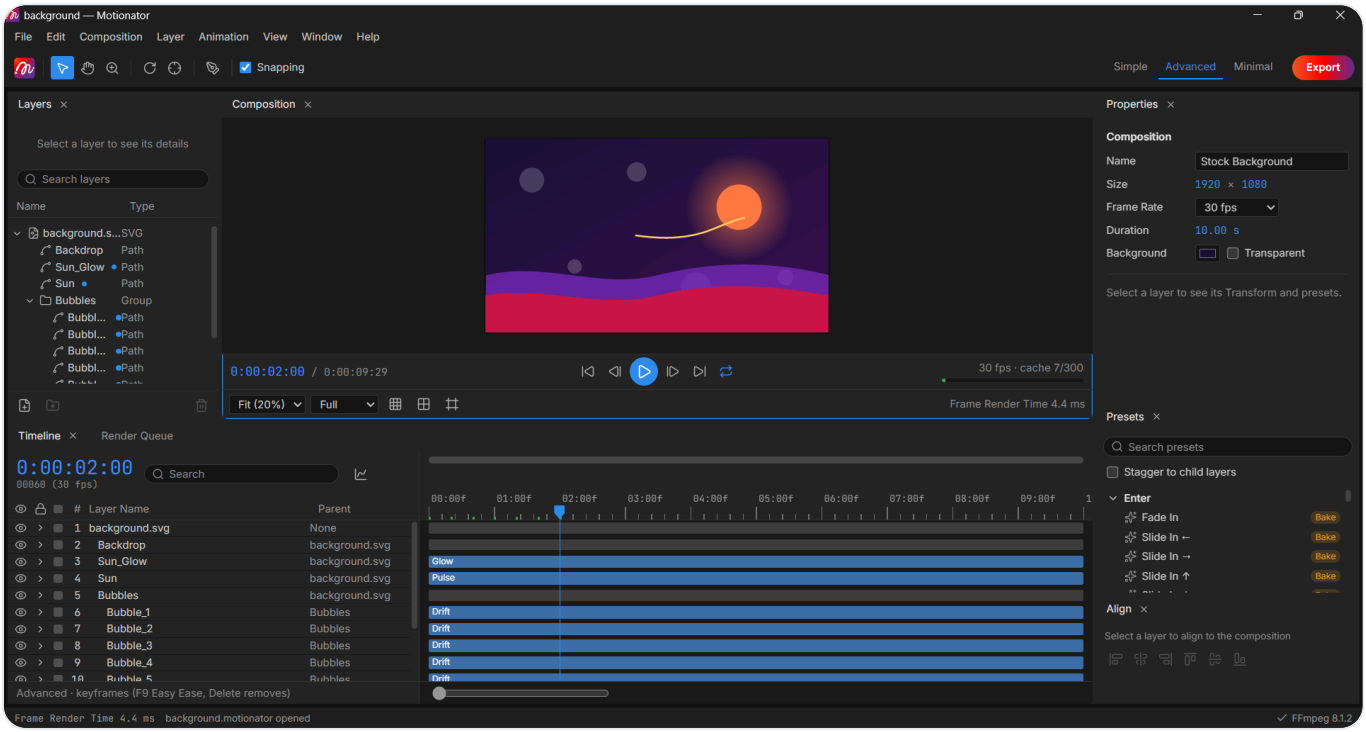
10 **Export.** MP4 for social media; for the website, **Export Animated SVG** without Loop so it stops on the finished logo.

> **TIP**
>
> Rotate or scale a logo part around its centre? Check where its anchor point is first: press `Y` and drag it, or use Layer ▸ Center Anchor Point.

# 34 Tutorial: seamless 4K stock background

Uses samples/background.svg and ambient.wav. Result: samples/background.motionator.




The background project: every layer uses Loop presets.

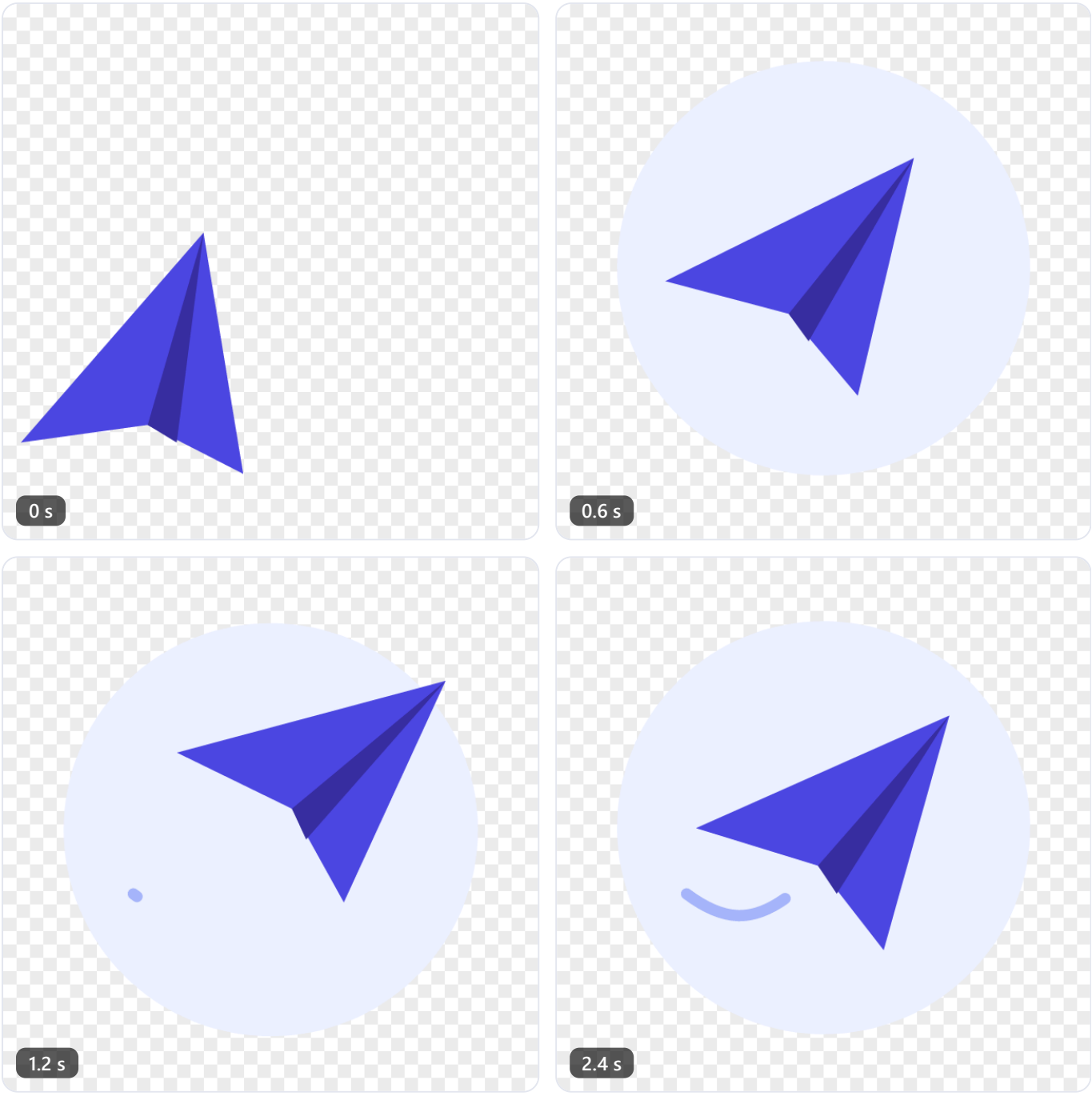
1. **Composition.** `Ctrl` + `K`: 3840×2160 (or 1920×1080, Motionator scales up sharply), 30 fps, **10 s**.
2. **Import** `background.svg`: Backdrop, Sun_Glow, Sun, Bubbles (Bubble_1–5), Wave_Back, Wave_Front, Ribbon.
3. **Use only Loop presets** so the end matches the start. The sample uses the settings in the table below.
4. **Make periods divide the duration.** In a 10 s clip, use periods of 10, 5, 2.5 or 2 s so every cycle completes exactly at the end. The bubbles use 5, 3.33 and 2.5 s so they never move in step (10 ÷ 3.33 = 3 cycles).
5. **Audio (optional).** Import `ambient.wav`; set Fade in and Fade out to 1 s. Many stock sites prefer clips without sound, so you can also mute it for the upload.
6. **Check the loop.** `Ctrl` + `M`, then **Check loop** in the Render Queue. It should say *Seamless*.
7. **Render.** Choose *Microstock 4K · H.264* and, if the site accepts it, *Microstock 4K · ProRes 422 HQ*. Fix any yellow warning, then Render.

| LAYER | PRESET | SETTINGS |
|---|---|---|
| Sun | Pulse | Amount 6 %, Period 5 s |
| Sun_Glow | Glow | Min 45 %, Period 2.5 s |
| Bubble_1 … Bubble_5 | Drift | Amplitude 40 px; Periods 5, 3.33, 2.5, 5, 3.33 s |
| Wave_Back | Sway | Angle 3°, Period 5 s |
| Wave_Front | Float | Amplitude 14 px, Period 2.5 s |
| Ribbon | Trace | Length 35 %, Period 5 s |

> **NOTE**
> Upload checklist: 5–60 s long, at least 1920×1080, standard frame rate, no logos or trademarks you do not own, a descriptive title and keywords. Mention “seamless loop” in the description.

# 35 Tutorial: animated icon for a website

Uses samples/icon.svg. Result: samples/icon.motionator.




1. **Composition** 1080×1080, 30 fps, 3 s, **Transparent** ticked. (Vectors scale, so a large composition costs nothing for Lottie or SVG.)
2. **Import** `icon.svg` : Badge, Plane (Plane_Body, Plane_Fold) and Trail. Set the root layer's Scale to 190 %.
3. **Badge.** At 0 s apply *Scale Pop* to `Badge` , and *Hover* (Loop) with Amplitude 6 px and Period 1.5 s so it keeps floating.

4. **Fly the plane with keyframes.** Select `Plane`. At 0 s, drag it about 140 px left and 120 px down, rotate it to −25° and turn on the Position and Rotation stopwatches. At 1 s, drag it past its place (up and right) and rotate to 10°. At 2 s, put it back in place at 0°.
5. **Curve the path.** Drag the handles of the motion path on the canvas so the plane swoops.
6. **Ease it.** Select all keyframes and press `F9`. Check the speed graph `Shift` + `F3`: smooth hills, no sharp corners.
7. **Trail.** At 1 s apply *Draw On* to `Trail` and set its Duration to 1 s.
8. **Export** both **Lottie** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `L` for the app and **Animated SVG** `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `G` for the website, and compare the sizes in the dialogs.

# 36 Tutorial: loading spinner for Lottie

Uses samples/spinner.svg. Result: samples/spinner.motionator.




A spinner must loop perfectly and stay tiny. The sample has a grey `Track`, a group `Arcs` with two opposite arcs, and a `Core` dot.

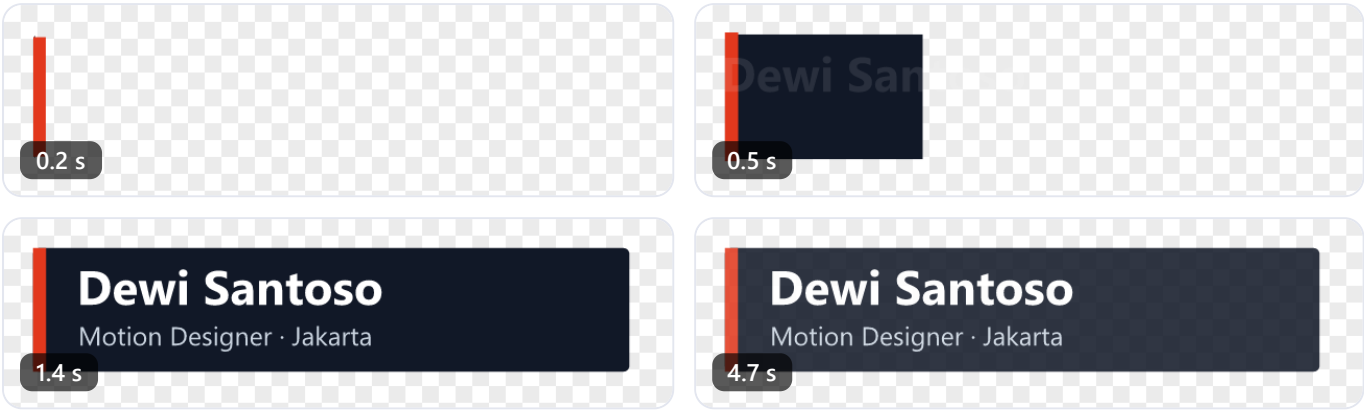
1. **Composition** 512×512, 30 fps, **2 s**, Transparent.
2. **Import** `spinner.svg`.
3. Select `Arcs` and apply *Spin* (Loop). Set *Period* to 1 s: two full turns in the 2 s clip.

4. Select `Core` and apply *Pulse* with Amount 10 % and Period 1 s.
5. **Check loop** in the Render Queue: it should be seamless.
6. **Export Lottie** with 2 decimals. Use it with `loop: true`.

> **TIP**
> Why two arcs in a group? A layer spins around its anchor point, which starts at the centre of its box. One arc alone has its box off-centre and would wobble; two opposite arcs make the box centred on the circle. With a single arc, move the anchor to the circle's centre with the Anchor Point tool `Y`.

# 37 Tutorial: lower third with transparency

Uses samples/lowerthird.svg. Result: samples/lowerthird.motionator.




A lower third is the name caption at the bottom of interviews and vlogs. It is delivered with transparency so editors can place it over any footage.

1. **Composition** 1920×1080, 30 fps, 5 s, **Transparent**. Turn on **View ▸ Safe Area** to keep the text inside title-safe.
2. **Import** `lowerthird.svg` : group `Lower_Third` with `Bar` , `Accent` , `Title` and `Subtitle` (text already outlined).
3. At 0 s: *Scale Pop* on `Accent` .
4. At 0.15 s: *Wipe In* on `Bar` , from the left.
5. At 0.45 s: *Slide In* ← on `Title` with Distance 80 px.
6. At 0.7 s: *Fade In* on `Subtitle` .
7. Select `Lower_Third` and apply *Fade Out*: as an Exit preset it is placed at the end automatically.
8. **Render** as **ProRes 4444 + alpha** (for Premiere, Resolve, Final Cut) or **VP9 + alpha** (for the web).

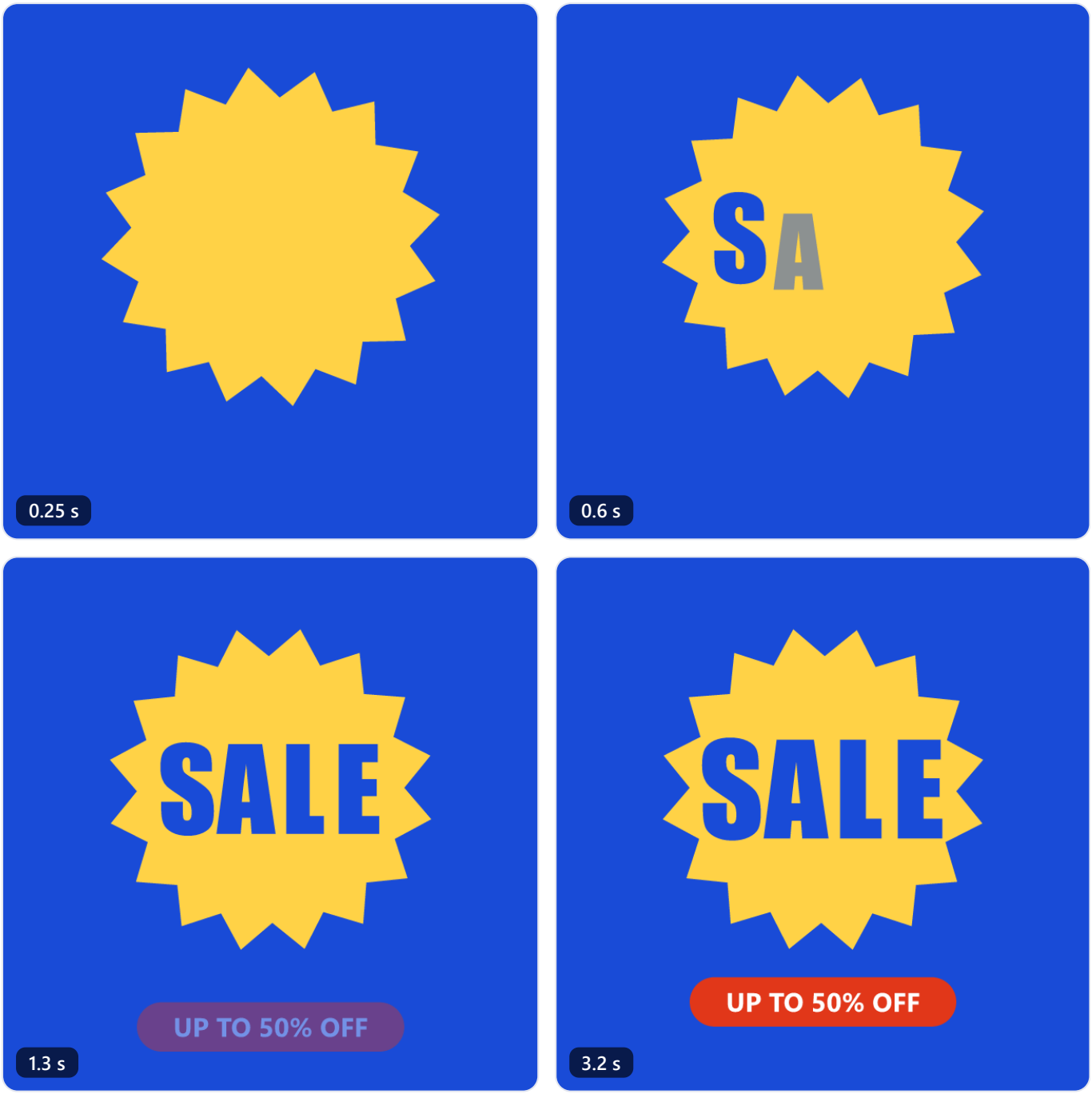
> **NOTE**
> Exit presets count from the end of the composition: in the Properties panel their first field is *Ends before the end* (0 s = ends exactly with the composition). If you lengthen the composition, the exit moves with the end, which is usually what you want for captions.

**TIP**

To reuse it for another person, duplicate the SVG in your design tool, change the text, outline it and import the new file into a copy of the project; the presets are on layers with the same names.

# 38 Tutorial: square social media post

Uses samples/social.svg. Result: samples/social.motionator.




1. **Composition** 1080×1080 (Instagram feed), 30 fps, 6 s.
2. **Import** `social.svg` : `Backdrop` , `Burst` , group `Headline` with `Letter_S/A/L/E` , group `Price_Tag` .
3. `Burst` : *Scale Pop* at 0 s, then *Spin* (Loop) with Period 12 s for a slow turn.
4. Tick *Stagger to child layers* (0.1 s, In order), select `Headline` at 0.4 s and apply *Pop Up*.

5. Untick stagger. At 1.1 s apply *Slide In ↑* to `Price_Tag` with Distance 120 px.
6. At 3 s apply *Heartbeat* to `Headline` to re-catch the eye.
7. **Render** H.264 at composition size; add music with Import Audio if the platform plays sound.

| PLATFORM | SIZE | NOTES |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Instagram / Facebook feed | 1080×1080, 1080×1350 | Square or 4:5 portrait |
| Reels, Stories, TikTok, Shorts | 1080×1920 | Keep text away from the top and bottom 250 px (UI overlays) |
| YouTube, LinkedIn | 1920×1080 | Landscape 16:9 |

> **TIP**
> Make a vertical version by changing the composition to 1080×1920 and moving the root layer: presets stay relative to each layer, so the animation adapts.

# 39 AI agents: Ask AI and the MCP server

Let Claude build and change animations, with your own subscription.

Motionator includes `motionator-mcp`, a server that gives AI agents its tools: create projects, import or write SVG, add text and generators, apply presets and keyframes, look at frames, check loops and stock rules, render, and write metadata. The intelligence comes from the agent you already use, such as Claude Code or opencode, logged in with your own account. Motionator stores no API keys.

## Ask AI inside the app

1. Install **Claude Code** from claude.com/claude-code and run `claude` once in a terminal to log in.
2. Open **Window** ▸ **Ask AI**.
3. Describe what you want, e.g. *Add confetti behind and a SALE text that drops and bounces*, and press **Send** (`Ctrl` + `Enter`).
4. Watch it work: each change appears in the open project at once, and the panel lists the tools it uses. Every change is one step in **Edit** ▸ **Undo**.

> **NOTE**
> You can keep editing while it works; it picks up your changes before each step. **Cancel** stops it. It does not save, render or export unless you ask.

## Using Motionator from Claude Code or opencode

1. Open **Help** ▸ **Connect AI (Claude Code, opencode)...**. Each agent shows whether it is installed and connected.
2. Click **Connect** next to the agent. Motionator registers its server for you: with Claude Code's own `claude mcp add`, and in opencode's global settings (a copy of the original file is kept as `opencode.jsonc.motionator-backup`).
3. Click **Open terminal** to start the agent in a new window, in your Documents folder, and ask away. **Disconnect** removes the registration again.

To register by hand instead: the installer puts the server next to Motionator, normally in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Motionator`.

```
claude mcp add motionator -- "%LOCALAPPDATA%\Motionator\motionator-mcp.exe"
```

For opencode, add it to `opencode.json`:

```
{
  "mcp": {
    "motionator": { "type": "local", "command":
["C:\\Users\\you\\AppData\\Local\\Motionator\\motionator-mcp.exe"], "enabled": true }
  }
}
```

Then ask in plain words, e.g. *Make 5 seamless 4K stock loops about Ramadan with Motionator, save them in D:|stock and write the CSVs*. The agent reads Motionator's guide and preset list, looks at preview frames to check its work, and queues renders in the background. To work on the project open in the app, ask it to *work on my open Motionator project*: it connects in live mode, like Ask AI.

| TOOLS | WHAT THE AGENT CAN DO |
|---|---|
| Project | New (with stock templates), open, save, info, canvas, undo, redo, live connect |
| Content | Import or write SVG, text layers and fonts, generators, layer properties and geometry |
| Animation | Preset catalogue, apply/update/remove presets with stagger, keyframes |
| Checking | Preview frames and contact sheets (it sees the result), loop check, stock check |
| Output | Render queue, batch variations, Lottie, animated SVG, stock metadata and CSVs |

> **NOTE**
> The server never runs commands and only writes Motionator's kinds of file (projects, videos, Lottie, SVG, CSV). Set `MOTIONATOR_MCP_ROOTS` to a list of folders separated by `;` to keep it inside them.

# 40 Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcuts follow After Effects where possible.

## File

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| New Project | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `N` |
| Open Project... | `Ctrl` + `O` |
| Save | `Ctrl` + `S` |
| Save As... | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S` |
| Import SVG... | `Ctrl` + `I` |
| Import Audio... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `I` |
| Export Animated SVG... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `G` |
| Export Lottie... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `L` |
| Exit | `Ctrl` + `Q` |

## Edit

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Undo | `Ctrl` + `Z` |
| Redo | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z` `Ctrl` + `Y` |
| Delete | `Delete` |
| Deselect All | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `A` |
| Preferences... | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `;` |

## Composition and layer

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Composition Settings... | `Ctrl` + `K` |
| Add to Render Queue | `Ctrl` + `M` |
| New Text | `Ctrl` + `T` |
| Center Anchor Point | `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Home` |

## Animation

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Easy Ease | `F9` |
| Easy Ease In | `Shift` + `F9` |
| Easy Ease Out | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `F9` |
| Previous Keyframe | `J` |
| Next Keyframe | `K` |
| Reveal Animated Properties | `U` |
| Graph Editor | `Shift` + `F3` |

## Time and playback

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Play / Pause | `Space` |
| Previous Frame | `Page Up` `←` |
| Next Frame | `Page Down` `→` |

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Back 10 Frames | `Shift` + `Page Up` `Shift` + `←` |
| Forward 10 Frames | `Shift` + `Page Down` `Shift` + `→` |
| Go to Start | `Home` |
| Go to End | `End` |

## View

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Grid | `Ctrl` + `'` |
| Snapping | `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `;` |
| Zoom In | `.` |
| Zoom Out | `,` |
| Actual Size (100%) | `/` |
| Fit to Panel | `Shift` + `/` |

## Workspaces

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Workspace: Simple | `Shift` + `F10` |
| Workspace: Advanced | `Shift` + `F11` |
| Workspace: Minimal | `Shift` + `F12` |

## Tools

| COMMAND | SHORTCUT |
| --- | --- |
| Selection Tool | `V` |
| Hand Tool | `H` |
| Zoom Tool | `Z` |
| Rotation Tool | `W` |
| Anchor Point Tool | `Y` |
| Pen Tool (motion path) | `G` |

| MOUSE | ACTION |
| --- | --- |
| Space + drag | Pan the canvas |
| Ctrl/Alt + wheel | Zoom the canvas around the pointer |
| Shift + drag | Move only horizontally/vertically; rotate in 45° steps |
| Ctrl + drag | Invert snapping for this drag (free move when Snapping is on) |
| Double-click a preset | Apply it to the selected layer |
| Esc while dragging a panel | Cancel the move |

# 41 Troubleshooting and FAQ

### My SVG imports as one layer.

The elements have no ids. Name the layers and groups in your design tool and export with ids (see Preparing SVG files).

### Text is missing.

Convert text to outlines before exporting the SVG.

### Draw On does nothing.

The paths have no stroke. Trim Paths only works on strokes; use Wipe In for filled shapes.

### Rotation swings around the wrong point.

Move the anchor point with the Anchor Point tool `Y` or centre it with `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Home`.

### A preset seems to have no effect.

Check the playhead: Enter presets start there, so the motion may be later in the timeline. Another Enter/Exit preset on the same property may also override it.

### Playback stutters.

Let the cache fill (green bar), lower the preview resolution to Half, or switch off blur while working.

### Export failed / FFmpeg not found.

Reinstall Motionator. Also check that the output folder is writable and the disk has space (ProRes 4K needs several GB per minute).

### “Width and height must be even”.

Pick a size preset or set an even composition size; H.264 and VP9 need even sizes.

### The Lottie looks different in my app.

Read the compatibility report; blur, filters and blend modes are not part of Lottie. Players also differ: test in the one you ship.

### A panel disappeared.

Open it from the Window menu, or use Window ▸ Reset Layout.

### The audio track says File missing.

The audio was moved. Click the track and use Replace to locate it.

### My layer jumps when I drag it slowly.

That is snapping: within 8 screen pixels of an edge or centre the layer sticks to it, and a magenta guide shows where. Hold `Ctrl` while dragging to move freely, or switch Snapping off in the toolbar.

### Can I animate text without outlining it?

Not yet: outline it in your design tool. Keep the editable original so you can change the wording later.

### How do I animate each letter separately?

Give each letter its own id inside a named group (the social sample shows this), then apply a preset to the group with Stagger to child layers.

### My Exit preset appears at the start.

Exit presets are placed from the end of the composition. Check the composition duration and *Ends before the end* in the Properties panel (0 s = at the very end).

### The layer spins around the wrong point in the export too.

The export uses the same anchor point as the preview. Fix the anchor with `Y` or Center Anchor Point.

### Can I change the composition size after animating?

Yes. Layers keep their positions in pixels from the top-left, so move or scale the root layer to re-centre. Presets adapt because they are relative.

### Rendering 4K is slow.

Motion blur multiplies render time by about 8. Blur effects and SVG filters are the most expensive; remove them where they do not show. Rendering runs in the background, so you can queue several items.

### The colours in my video look washed out.

Some players show H.264 with limited colour range. Compare in a different player (VLC, a browser); for colour-critical work deliver ProRes.

### Where are my own presets stored?

In Motionator's settings folder on this computer, and as a copy inside every project that uses them.

### Can I open a project on another computer?

Yes: the .motionator file contains the SVGs and presets. Copy the audio file next to it if the project has sound.

# 42 Glossary

**Additive (blend)**
How Loop and Emphasis presets combine: their motion is added on top of everything else.

**Alpha**
Transparency information in a video or image. ProRes 4444 and VP9 can carry it.

**Anchor point**
The pivot of a layer for rotation, scale and skew.

**Bake**
Turning presets into ordinary keyframes.

**Bezier handle**
The control points that shape a curve, in motion paths and easing curves.

**Cache**
Frames already rendered and kept in memory for smooth playback (green bar on the ruler).

**Codec**
The method used to compress video: H.264, ProRes, VP9.

**Composition**
The frame you animate in: size, frame rate, duration, background.

**CRF**
Constant Rate Factor: H.264/VP9 quality setting; lower is better quality and larger files.

**CTI / playhead**
The current time indicator, the blue line in the timeline.

**Easing**
How speed changes between two values: linear, ease in, ease out...

**Easy Ease**
After Effects' standard ease: slows into and out of a keyframe.

**FFmpeg**
The open-source program Motionator uses to encode video and audio.

**Frame rate (fps)**
Frames per second.

**Graph Editor**
The timeline view that shows animation as value or speed curves.

**Keyframe**
A value at a point in time; Motionator fills in the frames between keyframes.

**Layer**
An element of the SVG that can be animated: the root SVG, a group or a path with an id.

**Lottie**
A JSON format for vector animation, played by lottie-web and native libraries.

**Loop (seamless)**
A clip whose last frame flows into its first without a visible jump.

**Motion blur**
Blur along the direction of fast movement, as a camera would capture it.

**Motion path**
The path a layer follows between Position keyframes.

**Override (blend)**
How Enter and Exit presets combine: the later one replaces the value.

**Overshoot**
Going slightly past the final value before settling.

**Parent / child**
Layers inside a group are its children and follow its transform.

**Period**
The time one cycle of a Loop preset takes.

**Preset**
A ready-made motion applied to a layer as a bar in the timeline.

**ProRes**
Apple's high-quality editing codec; 422 HQ for masters, 4444 with alpha.

**Render Queue**
The list of video exports, rendered one after another.

**Rest pose**
How a layer looks in the original SVG.

**Reveal**
An effect that shows part of a layer, wiping from a side or as an iris.

**Safe area**
Margins inside which text and action stay visible on all screens.

**Snapping**
Dragged layers and anchor points jumping onto the composition's and other layers' edges and centres when they come close.

**Stagger**
Applying a preset to several layers with a delay between them.

**Stopwatch**
The clock icon that turns keyframes on for a property.

**Tint**
An effect that recolours a layer towards a chosen colour.

**Timecode**
Time written as hours:minutes:seconds:frames.

**Trim Paths**
Shows only part of each stroke: Start, End and Offset.

**viewBox**
The SVG attribute that sets the coordinate area of the drawing.

**Workspace**
A saved arrangement of panels: Simple, Advanced, Minimal.

# 43 About and licences

Motionator is built with Tauri, React and Rust; vector rendering uses resvg/tiny-skia. **Help ▸ About** lists the version and the open-source components.

FFmpeg is included as a separate program under the GPL v3 and is used only to encode video and audio. Your exported videos, Lottie files and SVGs are yours to use commercially, including on stock sites.

The sample files in `samples/` were made for this guide and may be used freely for practice.

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